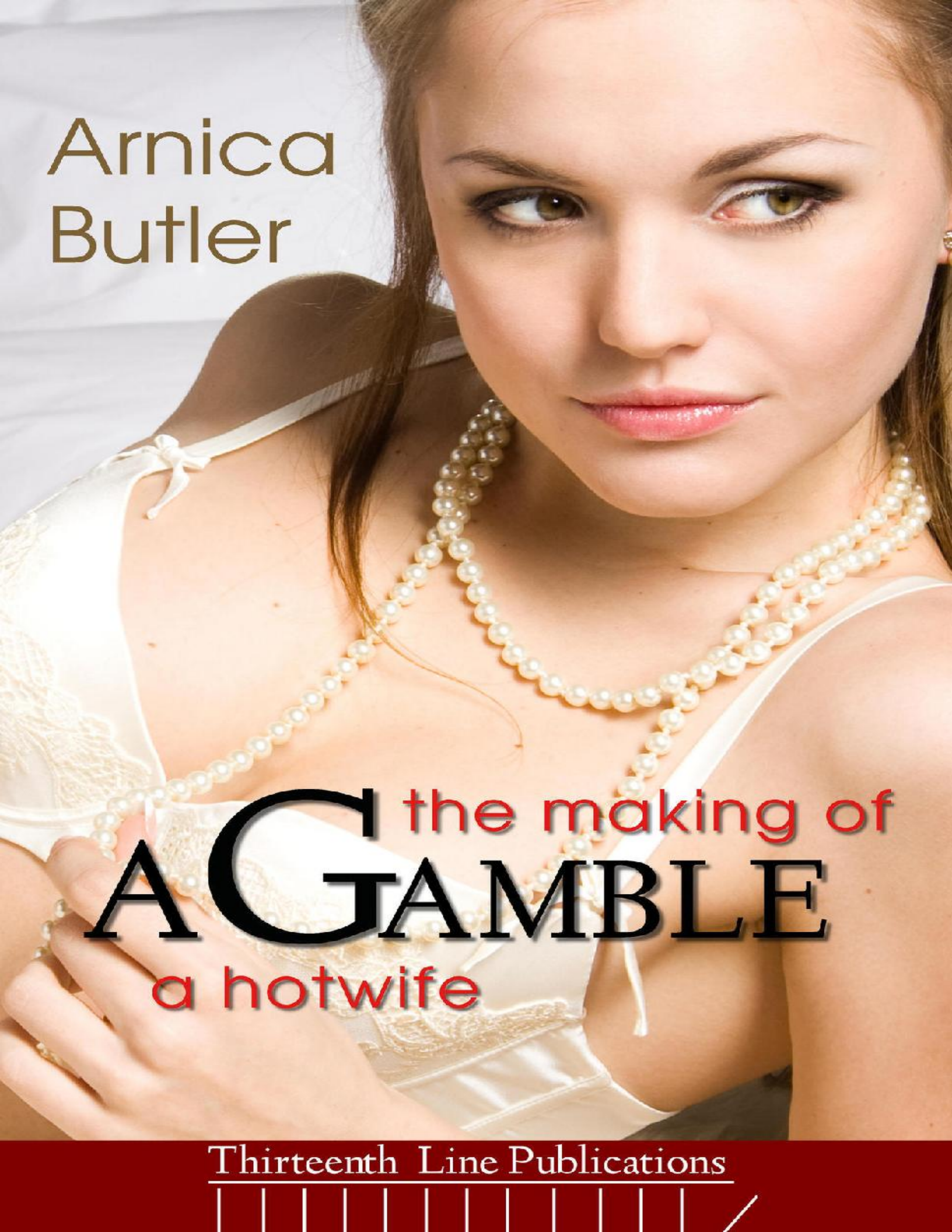




Arnica
Butler

the making of
A GAMBLE
a hotwife

Thirteenth Line Publications



A Gamble

The Making Of A Hotwife

By Arnica Butler

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Table of Contents

[Chapter 1](#)

[Chapter 2](#)

[Chapter 3](#)

[Chapter 4](#)

[Chapter 5](#)

[Chapter 6](#)

[Chapter 7](#)

[Chapter 8](#)

[Chapter 9](#)

[Chapter 10](#)

[Chapter 11](#)

[Chapter 12](#)

[Chapter 13](#)

[Chapter 14](#)

[Chapter 15](#)

[Chapter 16](#)

[*More from Arnica*](#)

CHAPTER 1

“Better luck next time, man.”

Brad Ulrich clapped me on the back and bit into an apple. He moved to the window of my tiny office and looked out into the parking lot. “You gotta push the PIP angle, I’m telling you.”

He crunched into his apple like an animal, and then, as he always did when he came to my office, he picked up a framed picture of my wife Victoria. He never said anything when he did this, but he didn’t really have to: his eyes were doing all the talking for him.

Other men *looked* at the picture when they came into my office. How could they not? But Brad always picked it up. I’d seen him, more than once, swipe a finger over it, as though Victoria were some lost love of his.

Not that I minded this kind of thing: Victoria was beautiful and this was particularly lovely photo of her. I put it there for a reason. She was at the beach on our first vacation together, sitting in the water, looking out to the horizon. Her dark blonde hair was sandy and stuck in places to her wet skin. A splash of temporary freckles dotted her nose. Her normally almond-colored eyes had picked up a hint of green from the water and held some private thought. She looked especially youthful, almost to the point that people were genuinely confused about her age and thought she might be a niece.

Of course, everyone also liked the rest of the picture. Her round breasts, encased in a white bikini, were given a perfect silhouette against the blue of the water. Her flat stomach disappeared tantalizingly below the surface, and her thighs emerged, tight and sculpted, half a foot away. In this way, Victoria’s best feature, her gloriously-shaped ass, was hiding under the water.

I knew that anyone who had met Victoria looked at the picture and wished they could see those hidden inches of her body. They all wanted to know what her perfect ass looked like in that white bikini.

And I enjoyed watching them try to hide their thoughts.

When Brad looked at the picture, though, it had a special quality to it. I sometimes entertained the idea that he was sleeping with Victoria behind my back. That he picked up the photo because he couldn’t help himself.

That if I just grabbed his fingers and smelled them, I would get a whiff of my wife's sweet, dark-honey scent.

"Okay, so, let's go," Brad said suddenly. His own dirty thoughts about what lay beneath the water in the picture evaporated. "I have two hours before I need to be an Glennbury."

Annoyed, I sat back in my chair and raised an eyebrow. "What, pray tell, could you possibly be hoping to sell to those people now?"

He crunched into his apple and shrugged. "Anything. Everything. They pick up more road kill there than any other hospital in the region."

"Is that true?"

Brad grinned. "It is. If no one checks it. Doesn't really matter."

Brad claimed that the whole secret to his success – and he was extremely successful – was to have come to LexPharm from the auto insurance industry. It gave him this extra sheen of confidence, as if he needed it, when he told hospital representatives that their CT machine would be paid for in twenty days by auto claims. And since he sold more medical equipment than the next two salesmen behind him combined, that sheen of confidence must have been effective.

I put my head in my hands.

I had big problems.

I had really been counting on a big sales order to a county hospital, and they had cut it in half at the last minute.

Which meant my commission was cut in half.

Which was going to mean, in about three months, I would have to cut my life in half, unless I came up with a big sale.

"I'll buy," Brad offered, returning to the topic of lunch. "I think I made 10K this *week*. It's the least I can do."

I looked up at him. Brad was really a bit of an ass, but I couldn't quite bring myself to hate him. I *wanted* to, because he was such an aggravating prick who said things like *I think I made \$10K this week*. And because he drove around in a new silver Lexus and had a hot Russian wife with an enormous diamond on her finger. And because he had a head of thick, jet-black hair, and radiated manliness out every stubble-oozing pore on his square jaw.

And because he was the epitome of professionalism with clients, and because he was one of those guys who just kind of glided through every room and every encounter with people.

Everyone wanted to hate Brad, but no one really could. He was *that guy*.

“Fine,” I agreed miserably.

Brad drove twenty miles an hour over the speed limit through the industrial park where our offices were located, but his Lexus moved like it was part of him and we sailed around the sharp corners like we were on a racetrack.

His mind was off the sales, and he was talking about his sailboat.

My mind was on the sales, and I was only half-listening.

In sales, I tried to play the same angle as Brad: there was no way to make money in this business without doing it. *Push the PIP*, that was the motto.

In our state, a no-fault, Personal Injury Protection state, each driver's own auto insurance had to pay for medical treatment in motor vehicle accidents, regardless of fault. As a bonus to all concerned, the car insurance company couldn't deny or even question any medical claims related to the accident if they were from the day of the accident. If you wanted to make money like Brad did, you marched into a hospital and sold them really expensive, shiny things. Then you told them to pay for it by imaging the hell out of car accident victims, whether they really needed it or not. *Presto dinero!*

I tried, believe me. But I couldn't sell it like Brad.

Everything I said was tinged with hesitation.

Ethics.

Lack of conviction.

Brad was hampered by none of these things, as was evident from his paycheck.

I didn't want to be Brad. I just wanted to make a living and keep Victoria happy. And most of the time, I did. But right now what was plaguing me was all the money I needed: the Montessori tuition, the mortgage payment, Victoria's student loans, the car payment, the credit card payment...

I tried to wrangle my thoughts back to Brad, off my troubles.

“...should really come out sometime. I'm selling the boat to get a racing boat, which Irena has no idea about, so keep it quiet – but this

weekend would be perfect. In *fact*, you'd really be doing me a solid, because it'll throw her off the track."

"Yeah," I murmured.

Monte-fucking-ssori. That was 13K I did not have. Frankly, it seemed like a lot to pay to have Gus taught by some unqualified older children, but Victoria insisted on it.

"Great," I murmured in response to something Brad said, without realizing it.

I watched building after building roll by, each one as fat and ugly as my many bills. Car payment one...car payment two...insurance...mortgage, with an ill-advised, balloon payment (my stomach twisted) due in one year...

But it was all for Victoria. Her sweet face materialized in my mind.

"Hello darlink."

The throaty, always-impassive voice of Brad's wife Irena filled the cabin of the car and shattered my image of Victoria. Obsessed with my problems, I hadn't heard the ring of the phone at all.

"Darlink," he imitated, and I could see Irena rolling her eyes on the other end of the line. "I have great news. You know Ryan? Him and Victoria are coming sailing with us on Saturday."

I opened my mouth. Had I agreed to this? I jerked my mind back into the conversation I had just been having with Brad, but I had no clue what we had even talked about.

"He and Victoria," Irena said, her tone dry as she corrected his grammar.

Brad swerved to avoid an unopened box in the road.

"Saturday I have spa," Irena's voice purred.

"Cancel it, sweetheart. We're getting out on the water."

Brad's wife terrified me. She was a tall, long-legged Russian with ice-blue eyes and dark hair pulled eternally into a perky pony-tail, with long bangs covering her forehead in a sleek, blood-brown fringe. The pony-tail would have given her the appearance of a cheerleader if not for her cool stare, and her straight-edged eyes that cut through all bullshit, and even non-bullshit.

So, instead, she looked like an assassin.

If I had a wife like Irena, I would not in a million years tell her to cancel anything in that tone of voice.

I imagined her eyes taking a big slice out of whatever she was looking at, which was probably the enormous diamond on her finger, and the air crackled with her silence.

“Like some kind of barbeque. On boat.”

Her voice was so incredibly sexy. Always unrevealing. Emotionless. I wondered if she fucked like that, and my cock twitched.

I had no *real* attraction for Irena: she was too thin, too scary, and just all-around not my type. Precisely for that reason, though, there was part of me that occasionally wondered about her. How she fucked (probably like an animal); what kind of things she said when she came (probably in Russian, which turned me on); what her snatch looked like (I guessed bare) and how she got it that way (maybe with an extra-sharp machete).

“Sure,” Brad said.

I tried to get his attention. Victoria hated when I made plans without asking her.

Brad's eyes were on oncoming traffic as he tried to cross a busy street. He ignored me.

“Ryan,” Irena repeated, as though taking attendance, and her voice coated my name like pussy juice on my cock.

I wasn't sure if I was supposed to say something.

Luckily, Irena saved me by saying suddenly: “I see. Then I cancel spa. Buy me this bread I like when you come home, darlink.”

“Gotcha.”

“Not Ukrainian.”

“Yep.”

“I hate this Ukrainian bread, Bradley.” Irena's voice took on the slightest tinge of panic, completely at odds with her personality.

“Bye.” Brad ended the call.

“She fucking freaks out about this goddam bread,” he muttered, flooring it to slip between a small gap in the traffic. A large truck blared its horn as it nearly took off the bumper. “I can't read the labels, I fucking tell her. I can't understand a goddam thing they say to me there. This bread store? It is *five minutes* from the house. She doesn't even *eat it*. She feeds it to the fucking mafia.”

Brad had a house in a peculiar neighborhood with a high concentration of extremely wealthy Russians. I had often heard Irena shrug

them off as mafia.

At more than one party, I had also heard her refer to herself with pride as a mail-order bride. It seemed very, very unlikely to be true, of course. For one thing, Brad hardly needed to mail-order anything to do with women. They flocked to his dark good looks and the calm confidence he radiated.

But no one had ever bothered to explain where Irena had come from, or why. Who knew?

I looked around. We were really delving into the slummier parts of the stretch of industrial warehouses that formed most of the area around our office.

“Where are we going?”

“Stagecoach, baby!” He slapped my knee. Hard. I tried not to wince.

Oh god. The trashy, run-down strip club, open only on weekdays for lunch hours for all the warehouse men, was the last place I wanted to be right now.

“I think I got food poisoning there,” I said.

I had been imagining, of all things, eating lunch at Applebee's. I needed some nice, ordinary chain-restaurant food.

“Why in the hell,” Brad shook his head, “Would you *eat* something at Stagecoach?”

Wait for it.

“Unless...”

In the corner of my eye I saw him holding his fingers in v-shape, and licking at the air between them.

CHAPTER 2

I was home by 3pm. I was way too discouraged after Stagecoach, and the sad strippers who worked there with almost no enthusiasm, to return to work. The fried cheese squares I had ordered on the basis of them being Most Likely To Be Sufficiently Cooked were too frightening to eat, and I was starving. (Brad, going back on his own advice, had ordered tacos because he found the item “hilarious.”)

“Whoa!” Victoria gasped, as I came through the door. “Home early! What a nice surprise.”

She was wearing a knee-length beige skirt and a gray top, looking every bit the suburban soccer mom. Except that Victoria, who was in her early thirties, looked like she was just graduating from university. Her face was fresh and flawless, and her figure untouched by her pregnancy. The skirt was not tight, and her toned curves hid beneath the shape of it. The grey sweater could not hide the two round swells of her breasts, though.

She pushed her straight, long blonde hair over her shoulder as she came to give me a kiss on the cheek. I loved that Victoria had not changed her hair, and still wore the wheat-blond, silky mane long, every day. Never in a bun.

“Okay...where have you been?” Victoria peeled herself away from me and wiped my cheek. She looked at her fingertip accusingly.

She showed me the hard evidence: a single fleck of pink glitter.

“It was Brad,” I said quickly. “I hate that place.”

“Ugh,” Victoria said. “So disgusting. I cannot believe you people do business like that.” She walked into the kitchen. I watched her ass moving beneath the conservative beige skirt, which couldn't quite hide the two hard spheres of her buttocks moving beneath the fabric.

“Like women wouldn't like to do business at a strip club,” I said, shaking and pounding my coat to make sure any remaining glitter ended up on the floor.

Victoria snorted.

“How do you know we don't?”

She returned from the kitchen with a beer in her hand. She had forgotten the bottle opener, but the gesture was still nice. I also figured she was just bracing me for whatever bad news or request – almost certainly

financial, in either case – she was about to deliver. I took the beer anyway.
“Thanks, hon.”

I went into the kitchen to get it while she slid onto the couch.

“So how was it?” I called.

“What's that?”

“The strip club,” I said. “Where you did your business.”

“Full of hot, sweaty men,” Victoria said, in her 'sexy-voice,' which she used whenever she talked about anything remotely related to sex because it made her a little sheepish, even after all these years of marriage and a child. Sexy-voice was childish and exaggerated, but she also dropped her voice a full octave and sounded like she smoked, so it turned me on in spite of how silly it was.

I knew this wasn't her intention, but...well, I'm a guy.

I took a sip of my beer. “Oh yeah? How sweaty?”

She folded her magazine over her chest and surprised me by saying: “All the big, hot men were dripping with sweat. It was running down their chiseled pecs, right into their...” she waved her finger around her crotch area and whistled. She was still using the same ridiculous voice, and she made herself laugh.

I gave her a smile, like I merely thought she was being adorable, but my cock was twitching more than a little. My mind was already painting a vivid picture of her in a roomful of men, her innocent face flushed and her eyes wide while she took in all of the big, huge cocks tucked away in tight thongs.

Like any guy, I went in for more.

“Oh yeah. And did you get any lap dances?”

She looked scandalized for a millisecond, and then played along. “Loads of lap dances.” She was half-embarrassed to say the phrase 'lap dances.'

“And what do these male strippers do when they give you a lap dance?”

I was fully expecting this to be the end of it, because she typically threw something in my face by the time a sex-joke went this far. She hid behind the magazine, but she growled, “They shake their big, hard, muscles in front of me, and then they *thrust, thrust, thrust* their huge package right into my face!” She burst apart into giggles, unable to take any more.

It was all silly, but one part of my mind had taken off with the image in all seriousness. I imagined a tight, oil-covered muscle man, thrusting his 'package' right near Victoria's face, while her mouth opened in surprise and delight at the size of his cock.

"Did they take their underwear off?" I probed, hoping to get more. If I could just get Victoria to say the word *cock*...

I slid onto the couch and started moving my hand up her calf.

She giggled again. "Oh, my god, Ryan!" She swatted at me with the magazine. "That's so..."

"Did they have thongs, or boxers?"

I moved my hand up her thigh, and she didn't swat me away.

In fact, she turned a little bit serious.

"Both," she said. She was still half-laughing but I could tell that I had somehow triggered the magical button. I moved my hand up, underneath her skirt, and she let me.

"Which one do you like better?"

"Oh my god," she laughed.

"Seriously. Which one?"

I was playing out my own fantasy now, and it was getting pretty out of control in my own mind. In it, Victoria was sandwiched between two muscular men, and her eyes were closed as their hands moved all over her, peeling her sweat-soaked underwear and bra away, swarming around her body, moving in on her with their mouths while she opened her mouth and laughed.

Victoria looked upward, as if something above her head would give her the answer. "HMMMMMM....boxers," she said. "Thongs are so...European."

She was being adorable, because that's what Victoria does, but I had other, dirtier things on my mind now. I moved my hand up, beneath her skirt, along her inner thigh. I was planning to go as far as I got, and fully expected her to tell me to stop – she had to leave in a few minutes to get Gus, she didn't want to mess up her hair, etc. - but instead, she let her leg fall open a little bit. My hand was on her underwear now, and I gently stroked her mound through the cotton fabric.

Here's the thing about Victoria: she's the kind of woman who wears cotton panties. She's the kind of woman who blushes when she had to confess that she has an appointment with the gynecologist, the kind of

woman who has taken ten years to get to where she can talk about strippers in this mild way as a joke. She's the kind of woman who feels guilty because she had one lover before me, and that was a long-time high-school boyfriend from church group and they probably had sex three times in four years and prayed about it afterward.

She wasn't religious anymore, but the guilt had pretty much stained her psyche forever.

And then, of course, there's me: rather than finding any of this off-putting, I found it hot, because there was an element of fucking a virgin almost every time we had sex. Which I loved.

I did. I do. I really do.

But there was another thing I liked doing, and that was imagining Victoria getting fucked all kinds of ways till Tuesday by a lot and a lot of enormous, ripped men.

I also knew a secret about Victoria (and of course I dubbed it, dorkily, 'Victoria's Secret' in my mind), and that was that she sometimes snuck onto the computer and watched porn. She didn't really have the best handle on covering her internet tracks, and I had never confronted her about it because, well, it turned me on. I discovered it when my own favorite porn website turned up all kinds of strange results and recently-watcheds, and it took me a while to put it all together.

And what did sweet, blushing Victoria watch?

Really hard, gang-banging, face-fucking, anal, spitroasting, BDSM.

This could, of course, be because that's what I watched, and she just surfed through whatever came up. But what I really liked imagining when I was at work late was Victoria, tucked away in the office, sinfully watching some woman getting fucked like rubber doll, with her fingers between her legs, stroking her soaking-wet clit until she came.

I had decided not to confront her about her secret, the same way she had decided not to tell me that she had found all of my porn sites on the computer and explored them. I think I was hoping that it was a way of sharing my fantasy of seeing her with another man (since fully half of my favorites were dedicated to wife-watching videos). That by not telling each other what we were watching, we were sort of giving each other permission to have a darker side to our fantasies, and saying it was okay between the two of us.

I slipped a finger under the cotton, and pushed my way through her downy blond hair to the soft gash, where she was a little wet, and I stroked her clit. She closed her eyes and her lips parted just a little.

Thinking about all of this: the porn, the strippers, other men fucking my wife, her secret habits, had gotten me really worked up. I reached down with my other hand and jerked her panties down, away from her mound.

"I have to go soon," she said, her eyes rattling open like a doll's.

"I'll be quick." I was read to get turned down, so I hadn't bothered unzipping my pants yet.

She gave a furtive glance to the window, which was a good distance from us, but was a large window and looked out onto the street.

I pulled her panties down to her knees.

"Okay," she said.

Really?

I wasted no time, in case she changed her mind, and slipped her underwear off. She left it hooked around one ankle, where it was caught on her sandals. I fumbled with my pants, not wanting to lose my chance.

Then I grasped her by the hips, and pulled her closer to me, so that I could play with her clit and get her warmed up. I was surprised that she was already so wet, and even more surprised when she reached out and pulled me to her by my cock. "Hurry," she said.

In my imagination, she said: *Just fuck me. Fuck me good and hard like fuck toy.*

I thrust myself inside of her, and she moaned. *Oh, your cock feels so good,* I imagined her saying.

Images of Victoria with a stripper on her lap, watching his thick cock moving closer and closer to her, filled my head as I began to fuck her gently, just like she liked, just like we always did. She bit her lip and closed her eyes, and I wondered if she was thinking of her favorite porn.

What was it that she liked best? The red-head who splayed her ass on a dirty mattress while five men slammed their load into her and she begged them for more? The thin blonde who licked cum off the floor while another girl sucked all the cum out of her ass? She replayed that one all the time.

I was near bursting so I tried to think of something else, but Victoria's face was so distant, so lost in thought with her eyes closed, that I knew I couldn't make it much longer. She was making me think too much about her mind being full of dirty thoughts about other men. I tried to slow down but

she moved her hips against mine, and I felt her pussy squeezing and her breath quickening as she came closer to coming – a real record for her.

My mind, never helpful, created a picture of the imaginary stripper stroking his cock all over her face, slapping it against her tongue, which she had extended flat just to take his abuse. It was over for me. “I’m coming,” I whispered, just so she would know to hurry up whatever she was thinking of.

She ground her hips into me, and I felt myself go over the edge. But just as I did, I could feel her spasm around me, and she scrunched up her face in delight as she shuddered with her own orgasm, and my cum burst inside of her.

“Whoa,” I said, rolling over and falling onto the floor. I lay there, panting and looking at the ceiling. “What was *that*?”

Victoria's golden hair popped into the scene. She was smiling. “I hate to be un-romantic,” she said. “But I have to go.”

She reached down and thrust her hand playfully underneath me, searching for her panties. They had slid off onto the floor.

“Can you think of something for dinner, as long as you're here?” she said, cutting through her playful mood. “And I have to stop by Mary Eaton's to get this stuff for next week's playgroup.”

I sighed and sat up, with her panties in my hand. As usual, fun-times were over. I watched Victoria slip her underwear up her legs, beneath her dress.

All of my problems, temporarily released, began to pound at the gates again.

“I made plans for Saturday,” I said.

“What plans? I think I have something.” She was in the small hall bathroom now. She shut the door. I folded my arms on my knees. All of my worries were crawling out of my subconscious. Debt, debt, failures, money, car payment, work, wife spending money...

The door opened and she came out, hurrying now so she wouldn't be late for pick-up, which seemed to cost seventy dollars a second at this school. “What did you want to do?”

“Brad invited us to go on his sailboat,” I said. “I can always cancel it.”

She seemed not have heard as she looked through her purse.

“No,” she said, surprising me. “No...whatever. We'll go. Sounds fun.”

She pushed a few things into her purse, blew me a kiss, and clacked away in her sandals, which she had never taken off.

I sat up, shaking my head. I was pleased, thinking of Victoria going to the Montessori school with her panties soaking up my cum, but I wasn't sure what to make of it.

It was so...unlike her.

Maybe her porn-watching had inspired her.

Maybe she was having an affair. I'd heard that women got hornier if they were sleeping with someone else.

I shivered, partially with excitement and partially because a cool breeze drifted through the window and breathed on my cock, still wet with Victoria's juices.

CHAPTER 3

“Take your pants off,” Brad said, smiling. His raven-black hair was shining in the sun and he wore a smug smile on his stubble-covered manly-jaw. “Get comfortable.”

Victoria, I knew, did not care for men who smugly told her to take her pants off, even in jest. Particularly in jest, in fact.

A lot of things made Victoria adorably uncomfortable, because, as I said, at the end of the day, she was best described as 'a little, to somewhat, prude.'

To my surprise, she didn't give any feminist lectures to anyone. She slid her cutoffs off, leaving only a white sheer shirt to cover her. It came to just below her light-pink bikini bottoms, so it was constantly revealing, and then covering up, the place where the swell of her bottom met her legs. And her sweet, pink-covered pussy. It dropped sexily off of one shoulder, revealing her soft skin and a strap of her bikini top. It was too opaque to see all the way through it, but the variation in shades of white just hinted at where her bikini was, and where it wasn't. I smiled. It was an unusually sexy choice for her.

She sat down next to me and smiled, then turned her face to the sun. Her blonde hair was slightly disheveled in the wind, and she looked a little like someone had just taken her to bed and really given it to her.

Typically, Victoria had every hair in place, and every part of her body that could be considered sexual neatly covered up by expensive clothing. You could still tell it was all under there, and it was nice to unwrap her and find her full breasts, her narrow waist, her perfect ass.

Unwrapping her expensive, expensive clothing...

The little teeth of all our debt began to gnaw at the back of my mind as I thought of her credit card bill, but I tried instead to focus on how lovely she looked, in the sun, her face turned up to the sky. Her shapely figure was attempting to show itself through the loose fabric of the cover-up, in two large swells on her chest. If she stood up, I would get a glimpse of her bottom.

I took a moment to appreciate what I had. Victoria was a real cheerleader-type. She had an hourglass figure compacted into a short frame, all of it well-toned. She was pale and angelic: light, all natural blonde hair;

a pretty, all-American face with a lovely smile full of straight, white teeth; light brown eyes that teared up easily for babies, animals, and nearly any charity campaign.

She looked a lot more like she belonged on a sailboat than Irena, who was balancing in the cabin with a martini glass in one hand, and a cigarette in her mouth. She was scraping a match against a matchbox and cursing in Russian. Her small breasts were loosely covered by a black string bikini, and she looked like she would spill out of it at any moment. Lamentably, she did not. The bottom half of her bikini was only a tiny triangle of black that was begging me constantly to steal a glance at it. In the right light, it looked like a patch of pubic hair. The strings were tied in little bows on her narrow hips, and my fingers were burning with a desire to reach out and pull on the loose end. I imagined the material slipping away from her skin, revealing whatever she was hiding under there...

Up until now, the sailboat trip had consisted of Brad barking orders at us. Irena had grown tired of her duties on the sailboat after being corrected for calling something a rope (*oh, I am so sorry that I fuck up this obscure fuckink word in your sailink-boy language*) and had disappeared into the cabin to make herself a martini. She was now refusing to speak English, answering in glib Russian if anyone spoke to her. I had almost gotten cracked in the head by the boom, and Victoria, being Victoria, had worked hard and diligently to pull in the fenders, once she knew what they were.

Finally, we were on the lake and clear of other boats, and we could “relax.”

Brad's boat was an enormous, 52-foot yacht with a single, impressive sail, which allowed him to pilot the boat without much help from any of us. “This way everyone can have a good time,” he had explained, while going over the boat in detail in the marina.

It was a good thing, because none of us knew what the hell he was saying.

To hear Irena muttering and cursing, I wasn't entirely clear why he thought she would care if he sold it and she never set foot on another sailboat again.

“Will you fuckink not do this tackink thing for one minute?!” Irena screeched from the cabin, breaking her vow to speak only Russian.

“Just the water, baby,” Brad assured her, a grin on his face as though he'd made a big joke for us all.

The slew of Russian that hissed out of Irena's mouth sounded very, very bad.

Victoria leaned back and looked up at the cloudless sky. "This is so beautiful," she said. "I can see why you love sailing so much."

I had a view of the cabin, where Irena had finally managed to light a match, and I saw her roll her eyes.

Brad, on the other hand, puffed up like a peacock.

"You wanna give it a whirl?" he said to Victoria.

"Oh, I...no...I don't know anything about boats," Victoria stammered.

"Nothin' to it," Brad said. "Come on," he said.

To my surprise, Victoria stood up.

I watched as Brad folded her into his grip on the wheel, so that Victoria had no choice but to stand with his muscled chest against her back. I wondered if she could feel him through her thin shirt, and if the obvious strength in his chest was a pleasing contrast to plain-old-me. I'm pretty proud of my slim physique – no beer belly – but Brad is *fit*. He has pecs and ab muscles. A sliver of jealousy spiked through me, right in my core. I felt my face flush a little.

"You have it?" Brad said, with his arms still on the wheel, just above Victoria's. He had changed his voice, I noticed, from the cocky, self-sure salesman to a gentle, fatherly, worm-inside-your-pants voice. "I'm going to let go, but I'll stand right here, okay?"

The smell of strong Russian cigarette smoke and fleeting haze of blue-gray alerted me to Irena's presence. She sat on the bench next to me and turned so that she could lean against the cabin wall and put her feet on the bench. She had managed to make herself a martini and not spill it, in spite of the heavy keel of the boat.

I had a hard time dividing my attention at this point: Victoria was gripping the wheel rudder and her face was flushed with excitement, and Brad was just half an inch from her, his hot body nearly against her full bottom. He could smell her hair, and if he looked down he could take in the view of her neck and her bare shoulder. Victoria was giggling like a schoolgirl.

"It's a big boat," Brad said. "But I bet you can handle it."

The line sounded like it had been cut from a cheap porno.

In the meantime, the dark Irena, with her tanned skin and her long legs, was practically naked next to me. I couldn't keep my eyes from

wandering to the lower half of her bikini, mostly because it was so tiny and yet not one single trace of a hair was visible near the edges of the fabric.

“He goes too fast,” Irena muttered in my general direction. “Then the boat is tippink – excuse me, *keelink* – and no one can relax because we are doing ab workout all day. 'Get a boat, let's get a sailboat,' he says to me, 'it will be so much fun and we can relax in sun and water.' I think, *okay*, and I say, *okay*. I like sun, I like relax. Now we are like this all day long, hanging on for life of deer.”

Irena's English really went to adorable shit when she was angry. I gave her a sympathetic smile, which obtained no response from her always-stoic face.

The boat began to pick up speed, and it really was keeling quite a bit. It was a state-of-the-art boat, Brad had explained to me, with all the lines hidden. I really had no idea what he was talking about, but apparently no one had to furl or trim the sails.

“You're a natural,” Brad said to Victoria. “You really have a feel for the wind. Do you want me to show you how to trim the sail?” He was close to her left ear now, her blond hair whipping in his face. If he leaned just a little closer, his lips would touch her skin...

Victoria, it seemed, was clueless.

Or maybe she liked it. Maybe she wasn't clueless at all. Brad's toned biceps were against her arms, and as the boat keeled they were naturally pressed against each other. Surely she wasn't oblivious to his huge muscles against her arms.

“Uh...okay, sure,” Victoria was saying.

What in the hell.

If there was one thing you could count on from Victoria, it was that she didn't like trying new things. She had still never eaten sushi because of that hang-up.

I looked to Irena, to see what she was making of her husband dry-humping my wife under the guise of sailing, and her face was absolutely neutral. There was no telling where her eyes were looking behind her dark sunglasses.

“Go make yourself drink,” Irena said, to the area in my direction. “Maybe put it in sippy cup, we are going all over lake now like fucking idiots.” She waved her hand over her martini.

I staggered toward the cabin after stealing a quick glance between Irena's long legs, hoping she didn't see me do it. But her eyes were hidden behind her immense sunglasses, and even when she was looking right at you, it was impossible to know whether she saw you or not.

I stood helplessly in the cabin, my legs spread to balance as the boat keeled heavily. I couldn't see anything for making drinks. Outside, in the cockpit, I heard Brad whoop. "There you go!" he yelled. "You've really got it now, sailor!"

I looked up to see him with his hands on Victoria's hand, "helping" her turn the wheel. He leaned very close to her, his back pressed against hers, and "showed" her something on the computer mounted next to the wheel.

Irena's legs extended from the bench to the side of the hatchway like a silhouette in a sexy movie, and then she dropped neatly into the cabin, skipping the ladder entirely. The boat lurched in a strange movement, and I heard Victoria yell, "Sorry!"

Irena fell toward me, but maintained her drink aloft and spilled nothing. Her hot, tanned skin pressed up against me and left a stamp of heat everywhere she touched me. She smelled, just very faintly, like an extremely expensive perfume. And cigarettes.

"Ready to tack!" Victoria yelled.

Irena rolled her eyes. "This means no drink for us right now. Hold on," she said, taking my hand and placing it on the counter-top. "READY!" she shrieked.

The boat made a very sudden change of course, tipped in the opposite direction, and Victoria squealed like Brad was licking her neck.

"I did it!" she shrieked. "Honey, I did it!"

Irena rolled her eyes. "Make drink quickly," she instructed, but it seemed to be for herself. "They do it again and again."

She had no sooner removed the vodka from a tiny cupboard than her prophecy came true. "Ready to tack!" Victoria yelled, and I could hear the smile in her face.

I had my eyes on Irena's small, round tits, and the shred of fabric that was sliding over them with promise after promise of falling off her slender body. She slapped two shot glasses on the table and held it all to the counter. "Okay," she said.

And again we heaved to one side.

“This is nothing,” she said. “He shows her jive..jibe...jive? Whatever. And we go sssswwwwwoot.” She made a circle with her finger and rolled her eyes again. “I hate this fucking boat.” She poured two shots quickly and held hers up to me.

I was feeling ill but I clinked my glass to hers.

“How do you say 'cheers' in Russian?” I asked.

She ratcheted her accent up. “Drink quickly,” she said, in answer.

“Ready to tack!”

“I'm getting sick,” I announced.

Irena reached for something above me, leaning forward and almost pressing herself against me. Almost, but not quite.

She shook a pepper packet in front of my face. “Put pepper in vodka,” she said dryly.

Then she neatly poured me another shot and dumped the small packet in on top of it.

Whatever, I thought. I looked over her head and saw Victoria's legs practically entwined with Brad's.

“Ready to tack!” Victoria laughed. “Hey, are you guys ready?”

“You tack. Then we anchor somewhere. I want to go for swim!” Irena bellowed, annoyed.

I heard Brad's voice, low and seductive, but not the words that made Victoria let out a light, carefree giggle.

The boat swayed and contorted, back the other direction.

Irena slammed her glass down. “One more.”

I reached for the bottle, even though I was a few minutes from vomiting. “Let me.”

She leaned against the bar and placed a well-manicured hand on her hip. She shrugged, and flung her other hand forward in a gesture that seemed to indicate she didn't trust me to pour vodka, but I might as well try.

My eyes lingered on her flat navel, lanky like a girl who had only recently turned into a woman, gave some thought to how old Irena could possibly be, and then tried to distract myself by pouring a shot of vodka as neatly as possible.

In the cockpit, Brad and my wife laughed and decided to tack again. I could see them through the narrow hatchway, and it almost looked like Victoria was leaning against Brad's back, turning her face up toward him, admiring the field of black stubble on his square jaw.

Irena held her shot glass up to me. “Bottom up,” she slurred, in her sexy voice.

It went on like that all afternoon, until I was good and toasted. I had one blurry eye on Irena's skin hanging out everywhere, and the other on Brad and Victoria, who sailed together, laughing and smiling, the whole time.

I was mildly seasick the whole afternoon, so I was relieved when I heard the sound of the motor and saw the docked boats in the marina gliding by through the windows in the cabin, where Irena was urging me to have one last drink.

When I set foot on land, the queasiness disappeared, and I was left only with the drunkenness. Irena was hopping all over the boat, nimble and quick like she hadn't had a single sip of booze in her life. She was tying knots like a sailor.

I rubbed my eyes.

“Oh god,” I said.

Victoria took the car keys I was holding and kissed me on the cheek. “Uh...yeah. I'll go ahead and drive, then.”

“You really seemed to have a lot of fun today,” I said, when we got in the car.

Victoria pulled the door closed and bounced a little in the seat. “Yeah,” she said, and she was breathless. “I'm surprised, it was really fun. You didn't want to try?” Her sheer shirt was hanging off her shoulder still, and she hadn't put her cutoffs back on.

I shook my head. I was really pretty drunk.

“Too busy talking to Irena,” she teased.

“Well,” I said. “My wife was so busy getting sailing lessons from 'Suave Brad,’” I began.

Victoria made a harrumphing noise. “Eeehhhh... 'Suave Brad,' huh?” She scrunched up her nose.

“What?”

“It's just a dumb nickname, that's all.”

“Why?”

“You're drunk, it wouldn't be fair to pick on you.” She looked over her shoulder to back up the car. She was in really high spirits.

“But you did think Brad was suave,” I said.

“Yep.” She popped the 'p.' “*Suave.*”

“Come on. A rich man with a yacht, raven-black hair, tall dark and handsome...”

“And ripped,” she offered.

Oh, Victoria.

I felt a little pang in my chest, and one in my cock, as her words both sliced through me and got me hot.

“Maybe you want Brad to give you some private sailing lessons.”

“Maybe I do.”

Her response was so unexpected, and so uncharacteristically delivered – in a neutral tone, that revealed nothing about whether or not she was joking – that the car fell silent. That particular kind of irritation that comes with being drunk while another person is sober overtook me and I started to pout.

I looked out the window and imagined Victoria asking Brad for sailing lessons. The two of them, out on the water. Anchoring in a small bay. Victoria deciding she needed to take in some sun (pure fantasy), slipping her white cover-up off to reveal her powder-pink bikini, her her creamy breasts pressing tight against the fabric, hovering over her flat stomach. Victoria, unbuttoning her jeans while Brad watches her from behind, admiring her high-rounded ass, and the way she slips a finger under the fabric to straighten out the bottom. Brad, leering at her full, fleshy ass just waiting to be grabbed. Victoria stretching out on the deck, her eyes closed. A shadow, covering her body, making her open her eyes and look up. Victoria smiling, giving the maker of the shadow a knowing grin, sitting up, reaching up for the khaki shorts, pulling them down with two hands, her mouth opening wide in a big, inviting smile, to take Brad's huge cock in her mouth...

Victoria put her hand on my knee. “Don't pout, Cranky-Man. After all, you seemed to be having fun with Irena.”

Irena's dark long legs, folding and unfolding, crossing and un-crossing, floated through my mind.

“No one has 'fun' *with* Irena,” I said.

But one could have an enjoyable time looking *at* Irena.

Victoria smiled. “It's true. She's so...cool. Maybe *you* want a girl like that. Serious. Dark.” She twisted her face into a hilarious expression, attempting to look pouty like Irena and looking silly instead.

I smiled in spite of my bad, alcoholic mood, which I was starting to forget the point of.

My eyes moved over Victoria's body.

"Maybe you and Brad should talk about swapping your wives."

"What?" I said sharply. Too sharply? I sounded like a fifth-grade boy who had just been accused of 'liking' a girl in his class.

"Isn't that a thing?" Victoria said. "Wife-swapping?" She was smiling coyly, and she even took her eyes off the road for a nanosecond to flash me a teasing look.

I looked out the window to take stock of things and make sure I wasn't dreaming. I could feel my cock coming to life, even through all the booze Irena had poured down my throat in the cabin.

"What are you talking about?" I said, without much conviction.

"Brad says it's a thing," she said. "Is that true?"

Now her voice was back to normal. Properly scandalized by a sexual fact that involved deviation.

"Oh, *Brad* says this does he? And when did *Brad* talk to you about wife-swapping?"

"No, not like that," Victoria laughed.

"Like what?"

"Not like, *oooooh, Victoria, I want to swap you with my wife...*" Victoria did her sexy-voice.

No? Too bad.

"It was like...oh never mind, I don't even know how it came up."

I turned in the seat toward her. Her shirt had slid completely off her shoulder, and her jean-shorts were pushed up high on her thighs. Her muscles moved under her skin as she moved her feet on the pedals.

"No, tell me," I said. "How did it come up?"

She flashed me another look and smiled.

"You and Irena were in the cabin," she began, and I knew she was taking me on another ride, but I loved that she was doing it. Even if she was telling the story with the same voice she would read a children's book in.

"And the sea started to get really rough," she went on. "The boat was tossing and turning..."

"Like the passion in your loins," I offered.

“Exactly like that,” she panted, leaning toward the steering wheel. “Then I fell, and Brad caught me in his big, strong arms, and I swooned -”

“I think you have to swoon before you get caught.” Inside my pants, though, my cock was taking everything much more seriously. My mind was imagining the story just as she told it, pressing forward to the good part, where Brad slipped his hand underneath her shirt, between the fabric of her bikini and her skin, rubbed a thumb over her nipple, which hardened beneath his touch...

“Really? Whatever...so I swooned,” Victoria continued, “and then I was like, 'this is inappropriate,' and Brad whispered in my ear, 'do you know, from the earliest times, men have shared their wives?'”

My cock pulsed.

“He did *not* say that.”

Victoria nodded, but she was close to busting out laughing. “He did. And then I was like, 'Oh, Brad!'”

She really squealed this last part, not knowing I would replay it in my mind, as though it weren't a joke, for nights to come. *Oh, Brad! Oh Brad! Oh, oh, oh, Brad!*

“Because his muscles were so hard they cut you,” I said.

“Exactly.”

Then there was a silence, one in which I felt sure we were both contemplating Brad's physique, because he really *was* cut.

“Pull over,” I said.

Victoria gave a quick look at me. “My driving is fine,” she objected. “And there is no way-”

“Right here, right here, go on this next road.”

“Why?”

But she did it.

I looked out the window. We were far outside of town, in cottage country, and I had no idea where any of these roads led. The road promptly turned to dirt. “Where are we going?”

But Victoria's voice was sultry. She had the right idea.

I looked out the window, and finally spotted a turn-off onto a road that was clearly not well-traveled. Weeds were growing unchecked in the tire-tracks, and branches hung low into the passage. A sign declared No Trespassing. “Here, here,” I said, maybe a little over-exuberantly.

I was feeling like a teenager, and I wanted to fuck my wife.

Victoria laughed. "No!"

But she slowed.

"Here?" She looked down the little road. "We'll get shot."

I reached over and turned the steering wheel. "Come on," I insisted.

"It will be fun."

She bit her lip.

"Just think of Brad."

She slapped me on the shoulder. "This is crazy. Let's just go home..."

I grabbed her hand and pulled it to my crotch, where my cock was rock-hard. "Come on," I said.

I wasn't, even at this late point, actually expecting her to do it. In fact, I was already consoling myself that we would have sex when we got home.

But Victoria surprised me again by turning off the main road and parking the car around a bend, out of sight of traffic.

She looked around.

It had been a long time since I'd fucked in a car. Victoria and I had done it once, but it had me who had pulled the car over, and me who had unbuckled myself and climbed awkwardly into her lap.

Now Victoria was the one who jumped, fairly gracefully, into the passenger seat and started to fumble around with my pants. She was unbuckling my belt faster than I could think about wanting her to do it.

My face was near her exposed shoulder, and I breathed in the smell of her skin. My hands moved up her thighs, underneath the skimpy cover-up.

Her fingers worked their way into my pants and found my cock. I was already hard, in spite of the shock – hard from thinking about her with Brad, replaying her sexy-voice saying *oh Brad, oh Brad!* She gripped my cock tightly and freed it from my pants.

My hands were at her pink bikini now, and I slipped them beneath the fabric. Her legs were spread wide and I had easy access to her pussy. My fingertips were wet before I even reached her hole. Her bikini bottom was damp and it was giving off her sweet scent.

Was she this worked up because of Brad?

My cock pulsed with the delicious thought. The painfully sweet thought of Victoria, staining her powder-pink panties with her own excitement because her back was against Brad's broad, muscled chest.

Getting wetter and wetter because she was daydreaming of him steering her like he steered his boat.

Victoria was squirming above me, smiling, trying to work her way into position over my cock in the crowded front seat.

She guided the tip of my cock to her dripping wet hole, and I had to bite my lip and my tongue to keep from asking her if she was all wet from thinking of Brad. We weren't quite there yet.

I looked at her face, though, and her eyes were closed. What was she picturing? Someone else? Brad? Her favorite porn?

Her pussy slid down my cock, and she managed, with a little squirming, to get all the way to the base. The zipper was in the way but I didn't give a shit: all I could feel was her tight, wet flesh, squeezing me as she thought of another man's cock inside of her.

She began to bounce up and down, her breathing heavy. Her eyes were still closed, and she was working me up to an orgasm faster than I could get control of myself. I could feel her pussy clenching around my cock and her abs tightening beneath her shirt.

This is probably why we didn't notice the car rolling.

I suppose I felt a sense of imbalance, but I just wasn't focused on it at the time. Victoria began to mewl, and she pumped even faster and harder on my cock. She closed her eyes tightly and her face contorted as she came, squeezing me tightly. Her pussy seemed to burst into warm liquid, and I looked at her parted lips. I was imagining them around Brad's cock, or next to his ear while he pummeled into her.

I was already going over the edge, my cum bursting through my cock, when I saw that the car was rolling. So I just watched the scene unfold in half-horror, half-ecstasy, too caught up in the moment to react to the scenery outside the window sliding slowly away. The car slammed, quite hard, into a fat tree at the bend in the road.

The impact was probably not hard, but it felt tremendous. Yet because it was too late for me to stop myself, I came at that exact moment, yelling as much from my orgasm as from the shock of the impact.

"What the fuck?" I yelled, ridiculously. It was as much about the sex as the car.

Victoria looked scared, shaken out of her lusty trance. She surveyed the situation, still on top of me, and by the time she pushed her hair out of her face she had a strange smile on her lips. She gave a half-embarrassed

giggle, the kind she gave to the punch lines of dirty jokes. “We hit a tree,” she said.

I reached over and felt the emergency brake. I pulled it tighter.

I looked around.

The car was pretty well smashed into the tree, and it didn't look like we were rolling anywhere.

We looked at each other, and Victoria raised her eyebrows.

Then we started to laugh.

Victoria leaned in to my shoulder, and covered me in her soft, blonde hair. “Oh my god,” she squawked. “How are you going to explain this to insurance?”

“I'll just tell them the truth,” I said, and I relished the fantasy in which I did actually tell them the truth: my car rolled into a tree because I was fucking my wife of eleven years in the car on an abandoned country road. I was so caught up thinking about my coworker's thick cock stretching her mouth open that I didn't notice we were rolling. And then, *bam*.

Victoria placed her lips close to mine. “You still have a lot of alcohol on your breath,” she said. “So I think I should drive.”

She hopped into the driver's seat in a complicated but graceful movement.

“Hope it starts.”

“That was hot,” I said.

She flipped her hair over her shoulder. “The accident?”

“No...yeah, well, kind of...just...you know...you just seemed really...” I searched for a word that wouldn't make her squeamish. “Randy.”

She scrunched up her nose. “Randy? Oh god.”

A bad choice.

She started the car. “Oh good.” She gripped the steering wheel with two hands. “Ready?”

I released the emergency brake.

The engine roared and the clutch ground to oblivion as she jerked the car away from the tree. She slammed on the brakes and looked back. “Still have the bumper.”

“What were you thinking about?”

Victoria looked down at the steering wheel, the odometer, the radio, as if I were asking a question about the car. “Whadya mean?” But her eyes were glinting.

Weren't they? Glinting with a little bit of seductive mischief?

"No...while we were..."

She let the car roll back as she turned it so we were facing the right direction to head down the road. I looked at the tree to my right: it seemed perfectly fine.

"I only think of you, darling," she said, in a breathy imitation of sexy-voice.

"Come on."

She looked at me pointedly.

"Were *you* thinking of something else?"

I hesitated.

"Basketball?" she cooed.

I was silent.

"Or...Irena?"

It seemed like a good time to confess. Just to get it out there, maybe have her take it seriously. We seemed to be circling my fantasy, and everything I'd ever read about it indicated that sometimes you just had to seize the moment, take the plunge. Tell your wife you really wanted to see her with another man. It was possible she already knew, or had guessed. I mean, she *was* watching my porn, wasn't she? And she *was* playing along with my fantasies a little more.

I took a deep breath.

"No. *I* was thinking of Brad..." I wasn't sure how to finish the sentence.

Victoria, though, took this to be another joke. A finished thought. She slapped me playfully, rolled her eyes, and started down the hill.

CHAPTER 4

This was it, for a while. I sustained myself on my memories of Brad touching my wife all afternoon, and also with an elaborate fantasy I created. In it, Irena and I fell out of the boat and Brad and Victoria didn't notice. Irena clung to me as I heroically swam to the boat, where we found Brad and Victoria sprawled on the deck, fucking like rabbits. So Irena gave me a blowjob to cheer me up, while I watched my wife moan and squirm underneath Brad's muscular body.

Or some variation of this.

Brad appeared one afternoon in my office. Unexpectedly, as he usually did, walking in as though he were an older brother, crunching on an apple and lifting files on my desk to see what was underneath.

"You taking the wife?" he said, without greeting me.

"I...what?"

"To Vegas. You taking Victoria?"

I had almost forgotten about the convention in Vegas.

"You should. I'll bring Irena. She lived in Vegas for a while, she can show us where to go, off the tourist track. The good stuff."

"I..."

I hadn't even asked Victoria if she wanted to come to the convention in Vegas. She hated places like Vegas: they weren't her style and she didn't like to do anything that Vegas had to offer.

And then there was Gus, the cost of the ticket, the headaches..

Brad bit a full half of the apple away in a single bite and destroyed it in his mouth.

"It'd be more fun if you bring her. Man she's really a little hottie. All of us together, rolling the dice..." He shook his fist just above his crotch, so intentionally or not, it looked like he was jerking himself off. "Come on. Irena really hopes she'll come."

I raised my eyebrows.

It was very hard imagining Irena wanting much of anything enough to open her mouth and say so, except for vodka, and possibly her non-Ukrainian bread.

"She does," Brad told my skeptical brow. "Irena really likes her."

"Uh..."

“Do it.”

“I have to tell her..I mean, she has stuff to do..”

Brad pulled his phone from his pocket and, with the apple in his mouth, swiped at it with surprising adeptness, considering the size of his hands.

“Hawts er own nunner?”

“Huh?”

“Gimme er own nunner.”

Give me her phone number.

“Oh, I don't think...”

“It's fine. I'll have Irena call her, and then you're home free. *We're* home free, because then the broads can go...do whatever they do...and we can have some fun.”

I stared at him, thinking that it was both a magnificent idea and a terrible one.

“Uhhn...” He let the apple drop from his mouth into a waiting palm. “I have it here, for some reason...” He turned and left my office, typing a text message, without saying goodbye.

I looked at his retreating figure.

I was so caught up in the hijacking to Vegas that I didn't even think of the more pressing question until I was halfway home:

Why did Brad have my wife's phone number?

Victoria opened the door for me.

“I talked to Irena,” she said, before I was even through the door. Her voice had that tricky tone that meant she was either about to admonish me or say something lovely.

“How *did* Irena have your number?”

She shrugged. “Brad maybe. Anyway, I know it's kind of a lot of money, but I already talked to my mom and she can watch Gus, so...I want to go. I found a ticket, on a later flight than yours, but we can be on the same flight home. What do you think?”

I blinked. Slowly.

“And why did Brad have your number?”

Victoria looked at me like I was handing her a fetus in a jar. She waved her hand at me, like she was refusing it. “What?” She broke into a grin. “Are you being a jealous husband?”

“Why then?”

I wasn't sure what I was being.

It was actually pretty hot.

Victoria squinted, and then she decided to have fun. “I'll tell you,” she said, using sexy-voice, “if you say I can go with you to Vegas.”

She was coming toward me, making a fairly awkward imitation of a hooker or a femme fatale, twisting her hips, but not really given over to the whole thing. She grabbed my tie.

She bit her lip.

After all, I *did* really want her to go to Vegas. I hadn't expected her to *want* to go.

“Okay,” I said. “You can go to Vegas. Now tell me all about it.”

I was turned on, and she seemed to know it. What's more, she seemed to *like* it. She pulled me close to her, pulling me by the tie, and looked me up and down, still biting her lip.

You have to understand, this was very unlike my wife.

I could feel my cock getting hard.

That was all I was expecting to get, before she cracked up.

Instead, she said, in a voice that was actually sexy, and not a goofy knock-off of sexiness:

“Well, the reason Brad had my number...” she played with my tie, and fluttered her eyes. She teased me with her fingers on my chest. “Is because...well...I maybe shouldn't say.”

I pressed my lips together.

Did Victoria know how much this was turning me on? Was this her way of saying it was okay?

What was she doing?

She leaned closer to me, letting me think for a good long while about whatever illicit reason there was for Brad having her number that she maybe shouldn't tell me.

She placed her hand on the back of my head, and raked her fingers through my hair. My cock twitched to life. She nuzzled my neck and placed her lips close to my ear. Her breath and the vibrations of her whisper sent a shudder through me that went straight to my cock. “See, the reason he has it, is because...well...Brad was...”

She was really dragging it out, and now her other hand was trailing a light tickle down my chest. “He was,” she whispered, and I could tell by the way her skin moved on her cheek that she was smiling, “giving me something.”

“Oh yeah,” I murmured. “What was that?”

Say, 'his thick, hard cock,' Victoria. I would give anything for you to say that.

“Do you remember,” she breathed, and her hot breath was really spiking through me now. I had an erection and I knew she could feel it against her leg. Her hand was traveling down to my belt, over it, down to my inner thigh. “When Brad told me...I could call him anytime if I wanted to....you know...”

Get fucked harder than I ever had in my life?

I just panted, as she flicked a finger over the tip of my cock through my pants.

“If I wanted him to give me...”

I sucked in my breath as she rubbed the very tip of me lightly through the fabric.

“Sailing lessons.”

She managed to blink, very genuinely, as if she had just confessed an actual secret.

Then she broke into a peal of laughter as I grabbed her and threw her on the couch. “No! You can't remember because you were too drunk!” she screamed playfully. She batted me away with a pillow as I fell on top of her and tried to get my hands inside of her shirt. “Stop it! Rogue! Gus is right there!” she shrieked.

I turned to see my son blinking at us.

Victoria laughed and pushed me onto the floor. Then she scrambled up and turned back to me. “To be continued,” she promised. “Later. Come on sweetie, let's get dinner.”

CHAPTER 5

I had a red eye flight to Vegas, and Victoria was coming on a late afternoon flight the next day. I checked in at the hotel and resisted the urge to start gambling.

I have a bit of a gambling problem. I'm fine if I don't get started, but like all vices, once I start I always do far too much of it. I had been to Vegas before I met Victoria, and lost all the money I had. This was back in university, so luckily there hadn't been much to lose.

I like blackjack. The odds are bad and there's no real skill involved, so I'm fully aware it's the worst thing I could like. But that's the way with addictive things.

The tables started calling to me right away: the flick-flick of the crisp cards, the clatter of chips, the expanses of green and red and black, slot payouts ringing in the background, roulette balls rolling nearby.

I could just change one hundred dollars. Make it my limit.

I turned and headed out to the air-conditioned mall that connects all the major casinos, where I couldn't get tricked into spending money as easily. I sat down at a bar and ordered a beer – another vice I needed to keep under control. Victoria sent me a text that she was on the plane, taking off.

I ordered another beer and watched people.

“You should not drink so much beer.”

The Russian accent identified Irena before her slim figure plopped into the seat across from me.

“Switch to whiskey. Better for your...” she patted her flat stomach.

She was dressed in a pair of jean shorts, and striped stockings came up to the middle of her thigh. A sparkling black shirt barely covered her top.

The effect: she looked like a teenager. It was an unusual look for her. I wondered if she had gotten dressed up like that just because she was in Vegas.

The waitress carded her when she ordered two shots of vodka, which Irena seemed to expect, because she flicked her driver's license out of her purse with an easy motion. The purse was fuzzy and pink, like her very high-heeled, stripper shoes.

Irena was nothing like the women I was normally attracted to. But there was something very alluring about her. Maybe it was the fact that she

was so lean and young-looking, so dark-haired, such a chain-smoking, drinking, pouty-lipped girl-woman.

I was at a loss of what to say to her. I looked around for Brad. He had been gone all day and I hadn't see him on my flight, so I had no idea when he was arriving.

“*Uf*. This place is so tacky,” Irena commented, as if she had no idea what she herself was wearing. Then she turned to me. “You have plans until they come?”

“Uh...who...I'm waiting for Victoria.”

“Yes.” She paused as the waitress set two vodka shots down on the table. She placed one in front of me, and I was about to refuse it when Irena slid her long fingers forward and scooted it to her side of the table. “You are waiting for Victoria. And I am waiting for Brad.”

She seemed to wink as she lifted her shot of vodka.

“Brad's not here?”

“I need cigarette. Come with me, outside.” She slammed her second shot and looked at me expectantly.

Where in the fuck was this little girl putting all of that alcohol?

I slammed my beer. I wanted her to answer my question, because a bad feeling (and at the same time, a twisted, good feeling) was squirming in my chest. But Irena had such an icy stare, such a combative, Russian way of communicating, that I didn't dare repeat it.

She rose when I set my beer down, and I left too much money on the table to ensure the bill was covered so that I didn't lose sight of her as she walked, without looking back, into a casino.

She lit up next to an ash tray, apparently having decided she preferred to be inside.

“So where's Brad?” I asked, trying to sound as neutral as possible.

She blew smoke to one side of her mouth.

“On plane. With Victoria.”

She said this like I was an idiot. Then she looked me up and down.

“You did not know this?”

My mind was still at: *On plane. With Victoria.*

“They have same flight.”

I shook my head. “Why...why is that?”

It wasn't making sense. And why was Irena here?

“Why are *you* here?”

Irena shrugged. “Brad had work. Let's go play something. I like free drinks. What do you play?”

She delivered all of this in an actuary's voice.

What the hell was Brad up to?

I let an image of Victoria and Brad, bodies pressed against each other, joining the mile high club, Brad's huge arms pressed up against the wall as he thrust into Victoria's open legs. My eyes fell down to Irena's bright pink shoes. The sight of them turned me on in a weird way – a much different way than the idea of Brad and my wife together on the plane.

“Did Brad change his flight?” I asked.

Irena pulled her cigarette from her mouth and squinted at me like I had just asked her of the earth revolved around the sun. “I am going now to craps.” She turned and walked away sassily on her long legs and hooker shoes.

I stood at the entrance to the casino. This was all very bad. Irena's pink shoes and extra-long legs disappeared like the Cheshire cat, and all around me the cigarette smoke and the quick snaps of card and chips beckoned like sex.

And then there was Victoria, laughing with a plastic wine glass in her hand on a plane with Brad.

I shoved my hands in my pockets, like I had seen a women do with her kid in a candy store.

No touching.

Then I made an about-face, and walked out of the casino.

I was very proud of myself, and I sat down on the edge of the bed to watch TV, for a full thirty minutes. I didn't really even see the screen: my mind was filling with images. Images of Brad and Victoria, images of Victoria's mouth around his cock, images of Irena's striped stockings and pink shoes bent at awkward angles while she waved her bare ass in the air just inches from the tip of my wet dick.

I was experiencing a strange mixture of jealousy and excitement thinking about Brad and Victoria. The strange coincidences that had happened: the phone number, the same flight. And they were just that, surely. Coincidences. But a cool snake of pleasure twisted in my stomach if

I thought about the two of them, plotting and scheming, sneaking around behind my back, and then smiling to my face.

I was also turned on in the most bizarre way by Irena.

Layered over all of these sentiments was the casino itself. Calling to me. And this is why I say I have a problem: the urge to gamble was almost as loud as all the sexy thoughts that were swimming around in my mind.

So instead of jerking off, thinking about my wife and Brad, I wandered downstairs, in a trance.

I took \$100 out of the ATM.

And, like every idiot who loses money in Vegas, I walked into the casino telling myself that \$100 was my limit.

Knowing, in the back of my mind, it wasn't, really.

Irena's striped and candy-colored legs appeared, the same way they had disappeared earlier, and burned through my field of vision. She was back at our hotel casino now, her legs neatly crossed like a dancer's. She was playing craps, rolling the dice to the delight of the middle-aged men who had flocked to her table.

I stared at her legs, and her silky, black-cherry ponytail, bouncing with her cool enthusiasm as she apparently rolled and won, rolled and won.

I blinked her away, and sat down at a blackjack table.

Just like that, I was up \$1200.

Well, after losing \$100 and taking out another \$500 and nearly losing it all. I won a string of hands, all \$100 bets, one after another. Each one of them filling my head with a high, making my pulse race, urging me on.

I forgot all about the time, all about Victoria and Brad, all about Irena.

And then Irena's voice, like a black cat soaked in whiskey, cut through my gambler's fog. Her body slipped into the empty chair next to me, and her long fingers flicked a chip onto the table. "You win a lot," she said. Or asked. It was hard to tell with Irena. "Play last hand. Spouses are here."

It took me a moment to sort through her accent to understand what she meant. Another moment to tear myself from the grip of blackjack.

Finally, I looked over my shoulder.

And there they were. Brad and Victoria. Brad was telling Victoria something and making her smile.

I almost forgot about my hand, and Irena tapped me on the arm with a flick of her middle finger. "You hit or stay." She jerked her head in the

direction of the dealer.

“Stay,” I said, absent-mindedly. My eyes were on Victoria.

Did she look different?

Her mouth broke open in a wide smile just then, and she placed a hand on Brad's arm. He was telling some kind of animated story. I imagined it was *hilarious*. He must have been doing that the whole flight here.

And all women loved a man with a sense of humor.

Especially a dark, tall man like Brad, whose chest was hard as the side of a cliff.

“You lose all your money.”

I snapped back to the table, where the dealer was clearing away the cards and my chips.

“I had a three,” I said, confused.

“That was stupid bet,” Irena snorted, with some amusement in her voice for once. She took me by the arm and we walked toward Brad and Victoria.

Victoria smiled at me and leaned forward to kiss me on the cheek. “Hi sweetie. You'll never guess who was on my flight!”

She turned her hand toward Brad, as though introducing him.

“Brad?” I said, eying him with suspicion.

“Crazy, right?”

I wondered if it was. I wondered how many flights there were to Vegas each day. Each night. And why Brad had *really* changed his flight.

“Thought you were coming this morning,” I said to Brad.

He shrugged. “I hate all that conference shit, the first day.”

I looked at the three of them. There were still so many unanswered questions, but no one seemed to be bothered by it except me.

I decided to give up on my inquisition.

I pulled Victoria closer for a hug. I sniffed her neck, her skin, her hair, trying to find some trace of too-close contact with a man.

With Brad.

But she just smelled like Victoria- sweet like honey. She had a scent of her own, that she never covered up with scented shampoos or perfume, and I could only smell it with my nose next to her neck. It was reminiscent of honey, but there was something else in it, too.

Victoria laughed and pushed me away. “You're tickling me,” she said, bringing her hand to her neck.

“What do you say, we all go to Trifecta?” Brad boomed, slapping his hands together. “Irena worked there for a while, we can get VIP service.”

I looked at Victoria. She didn't have to know much to know that Trifecta was a strip club. She was shaking her head ever-so-slightly, and looking from me to Irena to Brad, unsure what to do.

“Oh god,” Irena drawled, in her thick accent, so it sounded more like *gohtttt*. She rolled her eyes. She removed a cigarette from a silver case and lit it up. Then she took a long drag of it. She offered no clues as to what her comment meant, or who she was rolling her eyes at.

“Is that a...it's not a casino, is it?” Victoria's voice was small and stepped out of her mouth in hesitant jerks.

Brad slapped his hands together. “Victoria is *not* into it!” he declared. “Victoria, let's go where you want to go, we'll have some drinks, and then maybe I can sell it to you.”

Irena blew smoke in everyone's general direction, but her face remained unchanged. Her opinion on everything that was taking place was, like her opinion about everything else, utterly unknown.

In the meantime, every time Irena moved inside of her draped, tiny top, I thought about fucking her. I didn't want to think about it. I just did.

I looked back at Victoria.

She had her luggage in both hands and the bags were heavy, and I knew what she really wanted to do was suggest that we go to a magic show, or something cheerful like Cirque du Soleil.

I wanted to help her, I really did. I knew I should do just that.

But I was high on the energy of the place. That wonderful peak of drunkenness was coming on. And maybe it was true, maybe they were pumping oxygen in here, because I was soaring.

The high of winning a few hands was going to my head. The blackjack tables were calling to me. I wanted to smoke cigars and bet large amounts of money surrounded by pretty women at a craps table, and get lap dances from feathery, glittering women.

I wanted to really *soak* in everything Vegas.

Also, who didn't want to see where Irena had worked? As a stripper? Who didn't want to see if Irena would strip, for old time's sake?

Victoria probably did not want this. But there was no sense in not even *trying* to convince her.

Maybe she just needed a little push.

“Come on, sweetie. Let's go play some roulette or something fun you like. Have some drinks. Then we'll decide what to do. I have some extra cash from blackjack.”

“I have these...” she said helplessly, lifting her bags.

Brad stepped forward gallantly. “Never fear, m'lady,” he quipped. “Vegas does not want you to have to leave the casino, ever.” He took her bags and danced away.

Victoria turned to watch him skipping away, and then she whirled back around to me. She gave a shrug and tried to put on a brave face. This is another thing that I loved about Victoria: she tried to make the best of everything.

“You like roulette,” Irena said dryly, flicking her ash onto the floor. Like so many things she said, it was neither a question nor a statement.

“You don't?” I said, trying to get the conversation going so Victoria wouldn't have to stand there feeling uncomfortable.

Irena shrugged. “Bad odds. I always bet red.”

She let these unconnected thoughts linger in the air for a moment and then reached for Victoria's hand. “Let's go. You have to be standing at a table to get these free drinks.”

I had my eyes on her hand, holding my wife's hand, and my mind began to wander to dirty places.

Irena placed her other hand on her hip and jutted her jaw at me.

“You're coming too,” she told me. “You're having all this money.”

Irena had the same effect on Victoria as she had on everyone else, which was that she said everything in such an uncompromising tone that people just did what she said.

Victoria followed her, but I could tell she was still uncomfortable.

My concerns about her, however, disappeared as soon as we reached the roulette table. Just seeing the chips piling up on the felt triggered the same rush I had felt at the blackjack tables. I touched the chips in my pocket.

Irena stood away from the table and produced a small trinket from her purse which opened up into an ashtray. She tapped her ashes into it and

looked over the bets on the table with an expert eye. She lifted her gaze to me.

I sought out a ten-dollar chip and gave it Victoria. "Why don't you bet on something. Come on, it's fun."

She looked at the chip. "This is ten dollars, Ryan," she said flatly. "I'll probably just lose it."

I was so glad Victoria had no idea how much money I had been throwing around here.

"I made loads of money playing blackjack. Really."

"Really," Irena said, again in one of her half-question, half statement tones. She blew smoke up into the air.

"I...don't know," Victoria said, turning the chip in her hand.

"You just put the chip on table, and they spin little wheel, and they take chip away from you. In Russia this is go shopping," Irena drolled.

I gave her a smile in appreciation of her joke. I attained no response whatsoever.

Victoria twisted the chip and looked at the table. Then she lunged. With what plan in mind, I could only guess.

Irena had her arm extended, calmly, across Victoria's chest before she managed to get to the table. Thank god, because the dolly was still down.

"Not yet," Irena told her.

"What should I bet?" Victoria said, watching the quick movements of the croupier paying out the bets. A nervous bald man was making inside bets and rubbing his hands together. He had a fevered gambler's look.

"Bet on red. Chances are you will win or lose that way," Irena quipped.

Victoria ignored Irena and looked at me earnestly. "What do I do?"

Oh, sweet Victoria. She almost certainly felt moderately sinful even standing on the casino floor.

At the same time, it was all I could do not to leave for the blackjack tables. I could feel the desire to go over there creeping up on me the way a desire to have a drag of Irena's endless chains of cigarettes had begun to creep up on me. I touched the chips in my pocket.

I was up \$1500, by my drunken calculations, and I could feel it eating away at my reasoning. I was on a roll, I was going to win. I was going to win all the money I had lost in that sale to Hampton General, and then some.

“Bet black,” I told Victoria.

Irena brought her cigarette to her lips and took another drag of it as though I hadn't said anything.

“I have a feeling,” I said, to encourage Victoria.

If it was black, I should keep playing.

If it was black, I was going to win.

Victoria smiled. “But..*what do I do?*”

Irena lost her patience, and took the chip from her hand and slapped it on the table.

Victoria regarded the chip. “That's it?”

Irena blew more smoke.

“How do they know who to pay out at the end?” she said, watching the chips pile up all over the table. It was a pretty busy table: the bald man had evidently been making some money and putting on a show, because people were coming over to the table like interested dogs.

“I was croupier,” Irena said, but she ended the sentence in a tone that let us know she was giving no more information about that, or what it meant. Her attention was pulled away by a drinks waitress.

The ball dropped.

I looked at Victoria. She was fixated on the roulette table, and when the ball dropped on 33 she clapped her hands together. “I won!” she squealed, and Irena put her arm out again to stop her from reaching for the table and collecting her chip before the dolly was picked up.

The croupier was a stern, fit black man who was literally all business, but when Irena, arm across Victoria's chest, looked up at him, the corner of his mouth turned up a little.

I looked at Irena's face. She met his eyes, and her own eyes were filled with unadulterated mischief.

Or perhaps more appropriately: adulterous mischief.

There was no mistaking the way her features changed, her mouth moved just slightly into a smile, her body shifted somehow toward him. It was a look of invitation. She was subtly and not subtly flirting with him.

Probably, I should have been scandalized, or felt sorry for Brad, or looked the other way. Instead I just kept staring at her, watching the minute changes in her face and body, all of them screaming somehow at the croupier that she wanted him to fuck her.

It was hot as hell.

“Ryan!” Victoria's voice was shrill, the voice she used when I didn't listen to her the first time she spoke. “How much did that guy make? What kind of bet was that?”

The croupier was paying out a ton of chips to the bald man, and a crowd was growing on his side of the table. I shook my head, and focused on keeping my eyes off Irena.

Victoria was released by Irena to collect her winnings, and I could see that she was excited.

“You want to bet again? You're up.”

She bit her lip, and nodded. Then she placed a chip on black again. Her eyes were scanning the table now, watching the bald man bet. It was strange seeing her so into gambling, or anything, for that matter, that was considered a vice.

Irena had her eyes on the croupier, and I had my eyes on Irena.

Brad appeared suddenly behind Irena, and pushed her hair up to kiss her very erotically on the neck. Irena smiled but she kept her eyes on the croupier. Just blatantly. Brad whispered something in her ear, and his eyes went to the croupier as well. Irena just smiled more. Wickedly, sexily, unapologetically.

I wasn't sure what was going on there, and I wanted to know, but there was no sense getting caught staring at the two of them like a street dog looking for a meal. I tore my eyes away from the scene and tried to put it out of my mind.

The easiest way to do this was by letting the blackjack tables call to me.

Victoria squealed gleefully again and squeezed my arms. She bounced a few times. “I won! I won again!”

Her eyes had changed a little, and her skin was acquiring a light flush.

I was surprised, actually, that it was only two wins to suck her in. Victoria was normally so rational. I had fully expected her to stand around rolling her eyes, telling everyone what the odds were, and then quitting after a single win to ensure she didn't lose.

Instead, she had the fever. Without asking me or turning to anyone for approval, she placed two chips on red.

The drinks came, and I watched in fascination as Victoria sucked hers up through the straw in a few seconds.

“Red 30.”

The bald man, who was evidently betting something complicated, was overjoyed, and a few people who understood what he had bet gasped. Apparently some big payout was coming his way. The dolly went on the table, and Victoria started to reach for her winnings as soon as they were paid out. I pulled her back and she laughed. "Oh my god, this is so exciting," she said. "I just won again!"

The energy crinkling in her, with Brad and Irena writhing in the background, was going to my head like a line of coke.

"These drinks are watery shit," Irena spat suddenly. "I have to go to bar."

She lingered, though, to run her eyes all over the croupier while her hands ran all over Brad.

When she flicked her eyes in my direction, I was still looking at her. She gave her head a jerk in the direction of the bar. "Come on," she said. "Brad will take care of Victoria." She turned back to Brad. "This one, she grabs money before dolly lifts."

She walked past me toward the bar, touching me on the arm as she passed.

"Okay?" I asked Victoria, but she was already eying the table, rubbing her chips together, sucked in to her next bet.

Brad had a smug expression on his face. He was amused. He nodded to me and gave me a mock salute. He would keep my wife from getting us all kicked out of the casino by snatching up her winnings too fast.

He would stand right by her, making sure she got what she needed. Tell her some more jokes. Make her laugh.

Big, strong, handsome Brad.

Irena leaned against the bar with one foot on the bronze footrest, and so gave a lovely shape to her slender thigh. She had almost no bottom, which ordinarily is not my thing, but something about her boyish figure complemented her personality and had a definite allure.

She turned toward me when I made it to the bar. Somehow in the few seconds I had lingered at the roulette table to make sure Brad would take care of my wife, Irena had ordered her drink, located an ashtray, and started smoking a new cigarette. She looked as if she had been there all day.

"I ordered you vodka," she said, as the bartender set down the perplexing number of three shots in front of us. She pushed one of them

toward me and picked up the first of what apparently were her two shots. “Na zdroyie.”

Her sparkling, low-cut blouse slid around on her torso as she moved, and promised constantly to slip away from either one of the two creamy mounds of her chest and reveal the color of her areolas – pink, or maybe caramel, or was she more milk-chocolate? – but the shirt never delivered. She had the smooth, flawless skin of a teenager between her tits.

Irena's age was an utter mystery. Her resume grew every time I saw her, now to include croupier and stripper, yet she looked like jail-bait.

She turned and placed her elbows on the bar, so I followed suit, looking out over the casino floor. It was clear that she had her eyes on the croupier, and her faint smile was returning.

I looked at Victoria.

She was cute, still, my wife: she had a very conservative pair of jeans on, and a shirt that fell over her ass. I wondered if she understood exactly what an asset her ass was. She often let her clothes cover it up, except for those rare occasions she wore a black, form-fitting dress to a formal occasion. Then everyone in the room had their eyes on it.

From across the room, she almost looked like another woman. She bounced when she won. She seemed to be winning often, if her excitement and smiles were anything to go by. She was fluttering around Brad like butterfly.

Brad was dutifully placing a hand on her shoulder when she reached for her winnings before the croupier cleared the dolly, something she seemed to have a hard time controlling. His big hand covered her shoulder, and I thought I saw him slide his thumb over her skin. It was the same gesture he used for her photo.

Something stirred inside of me as I watched Brad touch my wife. My mind wandered to a micro-fantasy, where they *were* a couple, and a shiver of delight went through me as he leaned over to whisper in her ear. Only a sliver of the profile of her face was visible, but Brad's lips were just a few centimeters from her ear, and I saw her cheekbones stretch with the movement of a smile. Her head inclined slightly, moving closer to him.

I wondered if his proximity sent shivers of excitement through her. If it traveled over her skin, turning it bumpy with gooseflesh.

Irena interrupted my fantasy by extending one of her long legs in front of her. Her bright pink shoe made a lovely shape of her foot, and she

moved it around like it was another woman, gyrating for money. She knew exactly what she was doing, even though she had a distant expression on her face.

I watched as she kicked this sexy shoe in front of her and crossed it at the ankle over her other leg. My attention was drawn back to her lithe figure, her dark hair, her angular, Eastern eyes.

Between the thoughts about Brad and my wife, and Irena, I was getting hard. I could feel it. I turned to face the bar.

“You have time,” she said, and for a moment I thought it was another cryptic message from her.

Sensing my confusion, she sighed. “To go play this blackjack. Your wife is winning but she bets like woman. It will be long time before she loses all this money.”

She was rubbing her foot along her leg and smiling in the direction of the roulette table as she said this. Her smile was sexed, and there was no mistaking that whatever thoughts were slipping around in that stunning head of hers, they were about fucking.

The only thing that was difficult to know was who, exactly, she was thinking about.

My cock was hard as a rock for my friend's wife, and for my friend putting the moves on my wife. “Jesus,” I muttered under my breath, took the shot, and walked away toward the blackjack tables.

Vegas, what a place. Where it was actually the most sensible thing to do to go gamble.

Victoria was good and drunk, and laughing, and Brad was massaging her shoulders lightly as the three of them gathered around me at the table maybe an hour later. I looked at Brad's thick fingers on her shoulders, kneading them, and I was sucked away from the table by thoughts of his hands on her ass the same way: kneading, pounding, grasping her flesh.

But my mind went immediately back to the cards.

I was up 5K now, and now I was starting to get a little crazy.

I had told myself to walk away three or four times. Ten minutes ago I had been up \$7500. I was betting huge, and I was starting to lose.

“How much you down, old buddy?” Brad said to me.

“I'm up.” My tone was annoyed: an addict's tone.

Irena looked at the table as though it were a bus schedule and then began to look around for a drinks waitress.

Brad collapsed in the chair next to me and put a few chips down.
I had a ten and a two. Dealer with a jack.

Dealer stays.

“Hit me.”

Two.

Hit me, I signaled.

Three.

I had \$400 on this hand.

I looked over at Victoria, who was now watching the blackjack tables with interest but not alarm, which meant she had no idea how much money was on the table. She was tipsy and smiling in her childlike way.

Brad stayed.

I was terribly drunk.

Oh fuck it.

Fuck it.

Hit me.

Brad let out a whistle of appreciation.

The dealer flipped the cards with neat little movements of his hand.

I stayed.

Dealer with a nine.

My last card was a three.

It was so beautiful. So seductive, winning like that.

Brad clapped his hand on my back. “Better quit while you're ahead,” he said.

\$5400. I was back in, back rising up. I felt the gnawing of gambling fever inside of me, like an animal inside my chest.

I wanted to keep going.

But Brad was right.

“Victoria has agreed to accompany us to Trifecta,” Brad announced.

The table seemed to acquire a face. It smiled at me, and batted its eyes. *Stay here*, it said, seductively. *Stay here and win all the money you lost in sales.*

I closed my eyes.

“Okay,” I said. “Let's go.”

CHAPTER 6

Trifecta was on the old strip, so we piled into a cab. I ended up in the front, with the two women on either side of Brad. Irena wound her body around him, and looked through the windshield with little interest, while Brad asked Victoria all kinds of questions. I couldn't hear very well because their voices dropped lower and lower, and only occasionally did a quick laugh rattle up to the front of the cab. When I looked in the side mirror, I could only see Victoria's face, her hand on her cheek, a smile on her lips.

I was probably just drunk, I told myself.

When we arrived, Brad kept Victoria busy with his questions and funny stories. I realized he was probably just trying to make her feel comfortable, keep her mind off the fact that she was going to a strip club. My mood swung back to elation.

Irena walked in and sat down at the bar without giving anything a second look. She leaned forward to order from the bartender as she rose up on her stool to sit down, crossing one leg underneath her and giving the whole room a nice view of her tilted ass in the jean shorts.

I noticed that a lot of people were looking at Irena: she wasn't the most beautiful woman in the world, but something about her Stalin-may-care expression combined with her straight, Slavic features sucked men in.

She surveyed the scene, spun around and put her elbow on the bar to rest her head on it, looking at Victoria.

Victoria seemed hesitant to look anywhere, and so she was busy looking down, or at her purse, or at the seat she was taking next to Irena.

I should have been helpful to her, because I knew that she had never been a place even remotely like this, and she got wildly uncomfortable in new situations. She was just drunk enough, however, to offer a weak smile to Irena when Irena's long arm extended over her shoulder and scooted her closer to the bar. Brad leaned in to tell Irena something and beckoned me to follow him. It looked as though the girls would stay at the bar. I decided Victoria would be fine, and I followed.

The Trifecta had a very trashy, strip-club feel to it: the stage was black and so were the walls, with only suggestive red lights, like what you find in a red light district, lighting the place permanently. Booths

surrounded the stages, except for a line of stools next to a bar where the lustier men could get right up close.

It was all pretty typical strip-club scenery, except for the women. These girls were just a cut above average: all of them had tremendous bodies, for one thing; and big, well-rounded, surgically enhanced breasts abounded. Unlike at Stagecoach, where pretty much any girl with the day free could work.

These girls also seemed to have a great deal more dancing talent, because the one on the small stage in front of us had one arm pointed downward and one hanging on to the pole above her spinning, glittering body. She seemed to have pieces of glass glued to her, everywhere but where her bathing suit should be.

I stared in deep appreciation of the acrobatic feat she was accomplishing.

“Wow.” I said.

Brad was ordering a drink from the waitress.

I stole a glance at the bar as I sat down, to see how Victoria was doing. She had a drink now and she was squashing herself together, as though she could disappear by doing so, but she didn't seem ready to run away yet. Irena seemed to be talking to her and making her crack a smile.

“Was Irena a waitress here..or...”

Brad shook his head. “I met Irena here!” he shouted, because the music seemed to have gone up ten decibels.

He left my main question unanswered, though. What I really wanted to know was if she could do what this extraordinary girl on the pole was doing.

But I also wanted to hear this story about Irena and Brad meeting.

“I thought she was a mail-order bride!”

He smiled. “Nah. She just likes to say that.”

“But she worked here.”

He nodded, as if that was all there was to say about it.

I sat back, looking at Irena, who was practically climbing now, all over the barstool.

“As a stripper?” I shouted.

Brad leaned in toward me. At that moment the waitress brought our drinks – Brad had apparently taken it upon himself to order me a whiskey,

double, straight. I took it gratefully – the drinks in the casino had been watered down to oblivion and my buzz was wearing off.

“She needed a green card,” Brad shouted at me. “It was a pretty typical story.”

“And you're okay with that?”

Brad made a sound, sort of like he couldn't believe I was asking such a question. “She's perfect for me. It's was kind of nice having something over her for a while. I like watching her fuck other men, so it works out fine.”

I couldn't quite believe what I'd heard. I almost choked on my drink.

I decided Brad was just fucking with me. He was almost challenging me with his expression.

“Oh yeah,” I said.

Brad set his drink down. His salesman confidence was bubbling up. He placed his hands behind his head. “You think I'm joking.”

I shrugged. I wasn't going to get taken in by some practical joke of Brad's. They were always obvious, rarely funny, and frankly, starting to get annoying.

He leaned forward on his knees. “Look,” he confided. “If I told Irena, right now, you wanted to fuck her, she would do it.”

I smiled. I was fondling a \$100 chip in my fingers, twisting it. “Oh yeah?” I said. I put my arms up over the booth and looked at the very talented stripper on the center stage, who had wrapped her legs around the pole and was hanging upside down. It was an impressive feat, but her silicone breasts had not moved with the force of gravity and the effect was unsettling more than erotic. “How does that work? You say, Irena, my friend wants his cock sucked, and she's like, *goot, begause I am loving to suck cock?*”

But just saying the words, in my bad imitation of Irena's accent, got me more than just a little turned on. An image of Irena on her knees, saying that exact thing, with her mouth open for my cock, filled my head.

“Pretty much,” Brad said.

“How wonderful,” I muttered.

“You still don't believe me.” He shrugged, leaning back into the booth. “We have an open marriage, friend. And Irena...phhhhht. She is one whoreish, slutty, nasty little Russian tiger. The things she does...”

I felt myself getting sucked in to the idea, because I wanted it to be true, and an image of Irena covered in cum flashed briefly through my mind. But at the last second I broke into a disbelieving smile. "Right. I thought marriage was a sacred institution for Russian women."

I was basing this on the first two paragraphs of a *New York Times* article I had read six years ago.

Brad sort of snorted as he took a huge gulp of his drink. "Buddy. Do you think *anything* is sacred to Irena? That's what I fucking love about her."

Brad's eyes were on the bar. I followed his gaze. Irena was on her knees on a barstool and doing something that required her to be very close to the bartender, and so we had a lovely view of her tiny ass atop her long, thin legs. Her mouth was seductively close to the bartender's mouth, but she appeared to be talking to him. Victoria was stirring her drink with her eyes glued to the liquid like she was doing an experiment in a lab.

"Sometimes, though, I like a girl who is a little more... pure." Brad said.

He said it so quietly, I wasn't sure if I just imagined hearing it.

When I snapped back to his face, he was smiling at me and there was no way to know.

The conversation was essentially over, because a new set of music had started and a new set of girls were coming onto the stage, and Irena came shimmering and slithering over to our booth with Victoria in tow like a lost toddler.

She set a bottle of champagne down. "It's not on house," she declared. "But no mark-up." She turned back to the bar and blew a kiss at the bartender. "So much appreciation. What a fucking asshole. I go back for glasses."

Victoria slid into the booth next to me with her eyes wide. She was holding her drink with two hands.

"You okay?" I said. "If you want we can just go back to the hotel."

And the blackjack tables.

As much I was enjoying this whole scene playing out, I was also itching to get back to winning.

Victoria shook her head. She was uncomfortable, but I could see that she was also amused. Since she had won all that money playing roulette,

and had a few drinks, her appetite for sinfulness seemed to be increasing. She was still doe-eyed and cautious, but she was curious.

She had her eyes on the stage now, where a girl who looked a great deal like her – pale skin, blonde hair, full figure – was handcuffed to another girl, and they were doing marvelous things around the pole in spite of their handicap.

Brad had his arms spread over the booth in a typical alpha-male pose, taking up all the space he could, and he was watching the two girls with great interest. Every now and then, though, he stole a glance at Victoria.

I could actually feel his eyes peeling her clothing away with every look. Popping one button, then a second.

I heard Irena's laugh, which was a terrifying sound, cackling in the booth next to us. I looked over to see her sitting on a man's lap, her head tossed back as she let out her tinkling, devilish giggle. She pushed her long bangs away from her eyes and made a perfectly lewd gesture with her mouth. Her tongue ran all along her upper lip, like she was slurping something off of it.

My jaw dropped as the man slipped a folded bill into her shirt, looking for her bra. She grasped it with her hand and leaned in to tell him, I guessed, that she wasn't wearing a bra.

I looked anxiously at Brad, who was watching the scene with amusement.

I wondered what it was like to fuck Irena. What it was like to have a wife who was so surly, who had so much adolescent energy. A wife who was so thin it was as though she had just reached puberty, whose sullen sexiness was so business-like.

"I don't work here," I heard Irena say, and then her narrow hips were swaying as she sashayed between the chairs and the booth with our champagne glasses.

Then men at the booth watched her, appreciating her even more now that they knew she wasn't an employee, that she had made off with a tip for doing...whatever she had done. I heard someone let out a low whistle.

Yes, that whole table of men were all so sucked in, they weren't watching the duo on the stage at all, even though now the two of them had removed each other's tops with their teeth and were sliding up and down the pole with their hard nipples together, the big shiny pole between them like a giant phallus.

Brad chuckled as Irena slipped in next to him. She gave him the same treatment, sitting on his lap, whispering in his ear, making him smile. Now that I thought about it, Irena must have been drunk. She was no longer too bored to be bored, but boredly hyper-sexualized instead.

She looked at the stage. "These girls are so boring," she said.

She looked over at Victoria. "You know how to dance?"

Victoria had her finger on her straw. For a second I felt a pang of guilt for bringing such a nice young lady to a strip club. She blushed and shook her head.

Irena shrugged. "Look at these two, moving around like sack of potatoes, all you need is nice tits."

Everyone sat for a moment in a strange silence as we appreciated the fact that Victoria had very nice tits. Including Victoria, who shifted uncomfortably, but looked down at her own rack.

"I want to do some coke," Irena declared suddenly. She stood up and went back to the bar.

Victoria watched her, wide-eyed, and then turned to me. She hadn't taken the straw out of her mouth, and she was sinking into the booth like she wanted to disappear. She mouthed, "Coke?"

I shrugged, trying to be cool.

This was definitely going to be too far for Victoria.

She looked over her shoulder, where Irena was chatting with the bartender again. Close up, her hands on his face. Her pouty lips just inches from his ear.

I looked at Brad.

Brad was watching Victoria, and he flicked his eyes over to me. Then he grinned, and sort of nodded in Victoria's direction, like: *ain't that cute?*

Sometimes, though, I like a girl who is a little more... pure.

Victoria's eyes grew wide as she saw Irena tuck something into her shorts pocket.

She sputtered as she choked on her drink. She covered her face as she coughed.

"You okay?"

She waved her hand in front of her face. "Fine..oh my god...I...I'm fine...I just....now I get it." She looked at me and mouthed: *coooooocaine.*

Irena returned. "Okay. He says very good, not full of..." she waved her hand in the air.

Victoria was staring at her shorts.

"Not cut," I offered.

"That. Okay...let's go back to backroom. We can use one for girls, not this bathroom covered in TDS's."

She stood up and moved her narrow hips again, very neatly, through the increasing crowd of men. Someone grabbed her ass as she walked by and she slapped it away but laughed at him. "You have to pay, sweetie," she purred.

Brad followed her.

I looked at Victoria.

She was still holding her straw between her fingers.

"So whadya say. Ready to go get coked up?" I joked.

She set her drink down. "I've never done any drugs," she yelled over the music. Her mouth was twisted into a strange smile, one I had never seen on her before.

I stared at her, unsure what to do.

I looked back at the stage.

I felt her hand on my arm. She scooted closer to me.

"I think I want to do it!"

My brain refused to listen.

"What?"

"I said, I think I want to try it!"

I leaned away from her. "You. Want to try coke?"

She looked behind her, to where Victoria and Brad were disappearing into a dark hallway.

I expected her to turn back to me, but instead, she hopped out of the booth and hurried after them.

No one tried to grab Victoria's ass on her way to the back, because it was obvious – whereas for Irena it was not – that Victoria was no stripper. But I saw a lot of men peel her clothes away in their minds. In fact, a girl like Victoria was almost more alluring in a place like this, where all of the women had everything in your face. It made you wonder what she was doing there, how wild she might get, what might be hiding under her clothes...

I jogged after her. "Victoria!" I said.

The music was too loud for her to hear me, though, and she disappeared into the hallway through a swinging door.

By the time I reached the doorway there was no one in the hall. It was lit by an eerie red light, and I swung around, looking for where Brad, his crazy wife Irena, and Victoria – who apparently wanted to do a line of coke – had disappeared to.

Then I heard Irena's laugh, skipping through a cheap wood door halfway down the hallway, tucked in beneath a break in the music, which was blaring even in the hallway.

The door was unlocked, and when I opened it it let in to a strange and unexpectedly large room, bathed in the same prostitution-red light. Irena was perched on a large desk like a model in Guess ad from the eighties, black and white and lightly blurred by the crimson light. She flashed me a quick smile and went back to chopping her coke up on the glass table-top cover.

Brad was sprawled on a seedy-looking couch that appeared to be black – but everything was either black or red in the room. He had his arms over the leather back and an expression of near-boredom, as though snorting coke with his wife was one thing in a series of chores he had to get out of the way before moving on to the rest of his evening.

Victoria looked utterly out of place - her soccer-momliness oozed gently from her wardrobe – until she turned around. The red light gave her eyes a strange, over-makeup'd shadow, and her lips a darkness that they never had. She looked a little bit...

Trashy.

I stood behind her and put my hands on her arms. “Victoria,” I whispered in her ear.

I had been prepared to say, *what are you doing?* But I couldn't really summon the words now. I sort of wanted her to do it. The red light, the dark lips, the blaring music, Irena's long legs swinging over the desk in their childlike way while she chopped up lines of coke...it was all going to my head. I wanted to see Victoria rub her nose, see her pupils dilate and see what happened to her.

I watched Irena chopping, pulling the white powder into neat little lines with a revealing ease.

Irena made four lines and left a small pile – there was *a lot* of coke on her table – next to them. Then she sat on the table with her legs dangling and busied herself rolling up a bill.

I moved to stand next to Victoria so I could see her face.

Her eyes were wide and fixated on what Irena was doing. She almost looked high already. The same minute changes that had happened to her at the casino were happening now.

“Vic,” I said.

Irena extended her hand to Victoria, who stared at the rolled-up bill and didn't take it.

“Don't tell me this is virgin time,” Irena said.

Victoria nodded.

Brad leaned forward now and drew my attention to him. His eyes were on Victoria, suddenly much more interested. Much more interested in a much more lecherous way.

“You know what to do, darlin'?” he growled.

Victoria shrugged. “I mean...I've seen it in movies, right?”

Brad smiled, absorbed by Victoria's sheen of girlish ignorance, and how he was about to be a part of washing it away.

“Well, let me help you out there,” he said.

His eyes went to mine, almost as if he were daring me to stop him. But I didn't. I just watched as he placed his hand reassuringly on the small of Victoria's back, and pushed her gently toward the desk.

An expression of amusement crossed Irena's face, and she scooted away to make room for them. Brad pulled a rolling chair over and sat in it.

Then he patted his lap.

Victoria gave me only the briefest glance, before she went over and sat on Brad's leg.

Irena did not miss a beat. She handed Brad the rolled bill with the precision of a surgical assistant. She moved a little for Brad to have room to lean over the lines and smile at Victoria. “Do you want me to show you how to do it?”

Meanwhile, Irena looked up at me. She grinned.

Did her eyes travel down to my crotch? If they did, they must have encountered my growing erection – thankfully, it wasn't as obvious as it could have been if I were some huge guy like Brad surely was.

Brad leaned in with the bill to his nostril. He gave a sharp sniff and moved along the line, sucking it up in one easy snort.

He whooped. "Shit. Shit! That is some good shit. Here, baby doll, we need to give you a smaller line."

By 'baby doll,' I could only assume he meant Victoria.

I looked at Victoria, who was seated like a child on the lap of a very dirty Santa, her hands folded and her attention on what he was doing. Brad gave the bill back to his assistant Irena, took a razor blade from her, sliced up Victoria's line. The bill and the razor blade were exchanged between him and Victoria with the same practiced ease, and then Brad handed the bill to my wife.

Victoria glanced up at me, and then she leaned over the coke. "Like this?" she asked Brad.

"That's it. Now just press your nose here," he took her hand and directed it to her other nostril. "And then inhale while you move it. Nothin' to it."

"Is it going to hurt?" Victoria asked earnestly.

"Is anesthesia," Irena said, in what must have been her reassuring voice. It was identical to all of her other voices.

My mouth was open and I think I might have forgotten to breathe.

Victoria was hesitant, lining her bill up exactly and doing things with the adorable nitpicking of a newbie. I was reminded of when I had taught her to play golf. She spent 15 minutes getting ready to swing on the driving range.

And then, in one huge sniff, my wife Victoria snorted up a line of coke.

She sat up.

"Nice," Brad said.

"You are natural," Irena contributed.

"What happens now?" Victoria said.

"Wait and see how that hits you," Brad told her. "Let's give it a few seconds, darlin'."

Irena reached over to the pile of coke after licking her finger, and then she leaned in between Brad and Victoria. She took Victoria's face in hers and sort of pried Victoria's mouth open.

My cock filled up to rock hard so fast I thought it might spring off. Irena rubbed the coke around in Victoria's mouth, while Victoria stared at

her, perplexed.

“Feels nice. I like taste, too,” Irena drawled. She left her fingers on Victoria's lips just a little longer than necessary, and smiled mischievously.

Then she placed her same finger into her own mouth and sucked it off with a loud pop.

Brad spun the chair so that both he and Victoria were facing me. He had the bill in his hand.

“Ry?”

I watched Victoria as the high rose up inside of her.

What the hell.

I leaned over the table, and away we went.

It was good stuff. I had done a few lines in university, and it had been pretty crappy. Enough to make me like it but not get me hooked. It was probably almost entirely cornstarch.

But this. This was good.

When we pushed through the door and stepped out into the seedy club, I was taller, faster, a better dancer, a brilliant salesman, a man with a super-hot wife, a great blackjack player, a real winner.

We sat in our same seats, and Victoria was clearly vibrating on a different plane than she had ever been on. She sat differently, propping a leg up on the booth and tucking it behind the table. She watched the girls without looking away. She moved really close to me, and then I felt her hand on my thigh, sliding around it and right between my legs where my cock was hard and waiting.

“Oh my god,” she whispered in my ear. “Is this stuff supposed to make you so...” She moved her hand over my cock and grabbed at it. Her breath sent a shiver through me.

I couldn't help but smile: it was having the same effect on me. I nodded.

I looked down at Victoria, and saw that, while her lips were close to my neck, her eyes were on the other side of the table. Her mouth was slightly parted, her breath was quick, her pulse was probably racing.

My cock was hard and now I could feel that the tip of it was getting wet with precum.

I followed Victoria's gaze across the table, and there was Irena, curled up on the chair with a stripper. She had her mouth next to her ear like she was telling her a secret, and then she kissed her.

But not just a brief kiss. A long, wet, tongue-inside-the mouth, real kiss. Irena's hand came up to the other girl's face. Then they pulled apart and smiled, placing their foreheads together and talking about something.

I looked at Brad. He was watching, incredibly, the stage, and not his wife kissing a woman.

I looked down at Victoria. She was watching the two of the girls together. Her eyes were not shying away: she was staring.

I watched as the two of them laughed on the chair, and the stripper stood up over Irena, gyrating her hips and her large breasts in front of her. Giving her a lap dance, while Irena soaked it up with her eyes. She placed her hands on the girl's thighs, moving them up along the inside, closer and closer to the tiny patch of bikini that covered the stripper's snatch.

I supposed the rule about no touching did not apply to women.

Brad had also turned his attention to the girls, as had half the men in the club.

I heard Victoria's voice in my ear.

"I want to get out of here," she purred. But it wasn't like, *I want to get out of here, this is disgusting.*

It was more like, *I've had my first line of coke and I want to get out of here so we can fuck.*

I looked down at her. She smiled at me, but with a lot of naughtiness behind her expression. She squeezed my cock, and looked over my shoulder toward the door.

The message in her eyes was clear.

I stood up and leaned over to Brad. "Gotta go!" I yelled.

Brad tore his eyes away from his wife, who was now fully making out with the stripper, and squinted as if he didn't understand. Then his eyes flicked quickly to Victoria, and he broke into a knowing smile. He raised his glass and nodded.

In the cab, Victoria was almost obscene. She began by kissing, but turned toward me and unbuckled my pants, her hand pushing into the material, searching for my cock.

"Victoria," I said. I was panting and my tone was not 100% resistant. "Just wait,"

"I just feel so...I really have never felt like this," she said. Her fingers kept working down, and her short fingernails grazed my cock. I tried, meekly, to push her away.

In the rear-view mirror, I caught the cabbie's semi-bored expression. He had probably seen it all before.

"Save it..Victoria, jeez," I laughed. I buckled my pants so that we wouldn't look indecent going into the hotel.

But she was not really stoppable. Her hands kept exploring, kept grabbing for me through my pants. She squeezed my cock hard, and placed her mouth over mine. She teased me for a moment with her lips, then licked my lips with her tongue.

She was being unusual. Very unusual.

But I wasn't complaining.

When we arrived at the hotel, she took me by the hand and pulled me toward the elevator. We stood waiting, both of us as horny as teenagers. The elevator was slow as hell. She looked around, and then pulled me by the hand toward a stair entrance. "We're on four, right?"

We went into the stairwell, and I was so shocked for a moment that I didn't say anything. She skipped up one flight of stairs, looked out a window to the hallway, and skipped up another.

She waited for me, swinging her hips invitingly.

I charged at her and slammed her into the wall, kissing her almost violently on the mouth.

Victoria was so hot, so hyped-up, that she responded by gripping me in her hands. Her fingers moved down to my belt again, jerking it away. I clawed at her shirt, pushing it up so I could get a handful of her sensible lace bra and her soft, full breasts.

She bit into my lip as I squeezed her nipples. The pain only made me hungrier, and the taste of my own blood turned me on.

"Oh yeah?" I said. I spun her around and held her arms up to the wall. I jerked her jeans down, taking her panties with them.

I pushed my fingers between her legs, and they were instantly coated in her juices. She was dripping wet, so much that even the insides of her thighs were wet. She pushed her ass back toward me, and I took my cock in my hand and guided it to her dripping hole.

The whole evening, and everything I had seen and everything I had only imagined, filled my mind: Irena's pouty Slavic mouth sucking on the lips of the stripper, Brad's smug smile as he touched Victoria by the roulette table, their pounding, throbbing, imaginary fuck in the airplane. Victoria's

wet, pink flesh was tight and hot around my cock, and I felt myself going over the edge after only a few hard, punishing thrusts against her.

But I also felt her muscles squeeze around me, and a hot liquid burst, signaling her own climax. She was just as heated up as I was. She moaned and hung her head as she spasmed around my cock, and I slammed myself into her as deep as I could go before I filled her with my cum.

She laughed as she squirmed away from me. She reached down to pull up her pants. "We better go back to the room," she whispered, and then we both laughed at how silly it was to whisper at this point.

She took my hand, and we climbed the rest of the stairs.

But once in the room, it was clear Victoria wasn't finished with me.

She strutted to the bed and sat down. She pulled her shirt over her head.

Then she looked at me.

Brad's words about Irena, *one whoreish, slutty, nasty little Russian tiger*, radiated from Victoria's expression and into my mind. She had a look on her face that was like none I had ever seen before. Maybe because her eyes had turned to dark black saucers, which gave her a kind of cartoon-slut look; maybe because her mouth was open and her jaw was shifting, beckoning.

I was hard again, already.

I moved close to her, and she remained on the bed and grabbed my belt buckle. She pulled me close to her.

She looked up at me and grinned. This was a real rarity with Victoria. Actually, a blowjob was a real rarity, but her looking at me with her sexy eyes was even rarer than that.

She shook my pants down to my knees, taking my boxers with them, and pulled my cock out. She gripped it with her hand and stroked it, and her eyes dropped to look at it.

My own eyes were on her mouth. It was hovering near the tip of my cock, promising to touch me.

Then she looked back up at me.

"Let's pretend I'm a hooker," she said.

I kind of laughed, truthfully a little scandalized in spite of the coke racing through my system, and the heat between us. "What?"

"Pretend. I'm a hooker. Tell me what to do."

A few thoughts went through my head, and I was about to start talking. But Victoria gave me this look. And nearly everything we could have talked about was delivered in this look: she wanted me to fuck her like a dirty whore. She didn't want to talk about it.

I grabbed her by the hair, and pushed her onto my cock.

It felt incredible, pushing Victoria's head down on me like that. I always let her take her time, invite herself, and I took what I could get. But there had been so many times that I had just wanted to do exactly what I was doing, and grab her by the head, push my cock into her throat, and jerk her mouth up and down my shaft like she was a bargain sex toy.

I'm a pretty average-sized guy, but I was still surprised that Victoria took my cock all the way into the back of her throat.

Her eyes opened, and she looked up at me.

I sucked in my breath. The act was so submissive, even more so than allowing me to jerk her head back and forth as she gagged, that I almost came right then and there. But I wanted to enjoy a little more of Victoria's mouth.

And then I surprised myself by saying:

“That's it. Take it all.”

Her eyes were starting to water.

I yanked her head away from my cock, so that I didn't come. She panted with her mouth open, spit dribbling down her chin.

I took my cock in my hand and rubbed it over her lips and her mouth, without putting it in.

“You're being very naughty, Victoria,” I breathed. “I wonder what's gotten into you.”

I wanted to say, *every time we see Brad, you fuck like a little whore.*

I was working up the courage for it, but I noticed at that moment that Victoria had slid her hand between her legs, and she was stroking herself with her pretty little fingers. I couldn't help but think of her on the plane with Brad. Maybe he had taught her all of this?

I moved so I could watch her, and when I saw her eyes getting distant, fading to her own fantasy, or just pulling away to her own climax, I grasped her by the head and pushed her over my cock again. This time I held her, suspended by the hair, and I rammed my cock all the way to the back of her throat. I didn't warn her, and there was really no way to – but I didn't even try. I just filled her throat with my cum. I heard her give a muffled moan as

she came, and she gagged a little because my cock was still spewing cum inside of her.

But she sucked my shaft, from base to tip, as she pulled her mouth from me.

The whole time, looking up.

“Jesus,” I panted, when I could finally breathe.

Victoria wiped the corners of her mouth. “Oh my god,” she said, pressing her hand to her chest. “I can see why people like this stuff, but I feel like I'm going to have a heart attack.”

My feelings turned suddenly to concern. “Really?”

“I mean, no – not really, *really* – but Jesus, I think my pulse is like...500 or something.”

Victoria, who exercised by walking and swimming playfully, had no idea what she was saying.

“You okay, though? Seriously?”

She grinned. “Yeah. That was kind of fun.”

We were both still high as kites.

“You want to go play skeeball at Circus-Circus?” I offered. “I can't sleep right now.”

My mind was already returning to the blackjack tables. I had a wild thought that if I took Victoria with me to do something juvenile, I would burn off my energy safely. Also, I was feeling a strange kind of tenderness for her right now.

Her face brightened – even more than it already was. She seemed grateful for the return to a more wholesome activity, even if she had just asked to be fucked like a whore, and even if we only needed to do it to get the coke out of our systems.

I pulled my pants up, and I noticed that the small packet of coke Irena had slipped to me, as we had left the backroom at Trifecta, fell to the floor. At the time, I hadn't even wondered why she had given it to me.

I picked it up, and Victoria didn't notice it. She had her shirt halfway over her head.

We walked to Circus-Circus with our arms linked together. It was almost one in the morning now, and it was finally an agreeable temperature outside. We played skeeball for an hour, and Victoria won tons of tickets and squealed, delighted.

But after about forty-five minutes, she started to crash. The line she had done was much smaller, and the energy evaporated from her quickly. Dark circles appeared almost instantaneously, and she went quiet, leaning on a chair as she waited for her turn.

I hugged her and picked her up, like a bride. I was still high, so I made it a few feet before I had to set her down. "Let's get you home, tiger," I said.

"Oh god, I'm so tired now," she said.

She leaned on my shoulder, and even though it was only a few blocks, I hailed a cab.

I tucked Victoria into bed, and she was almost immediately asleep. She had a smile on her face, and she looked like a princess again. I kissed her forehead. I sat on the edge of the bed.

I thought about taking my shoes off.

Go to bed, Ryan.

Instead I went to the bathroom. My high was starting to fade, but I didn't want the night to be over.

We had walked through the casino to get to the elevators. And the sounds of it had gone to my head. It was calling me now. The dropping roulette balls, the flicking cards, the smoke, the women, the late-night desperation and elation.

I used a credit card to line up the small pile of coke I dumped onto the bathroom counter.

I rolled a bill.

I could do a line, go back down to the table I had so much luck at, get my money back, and solve all my problems.

Don't be stupid.

I snorted the line.

I looked up at the mirror.

I was Ryan Fucking White. I was the world's best salesman, I was a fucking pro. I was not bad-looking, not at all, in fact, I looked pretty fucking hot for my age. I had a hot fucking wife. I was a good blackjack player. I knew when to call it quits. I was a man who could play things cool. I was Ryan Fucking White. I had a system, and I had good luck.

I sniffed. Wiped a trace of white powder from the edge of my nose. Folded up the tiny amount of coke left.

I smiled at myself, because now I was so high I thought I could count cards.

I was Ryan Fucking White.

CHAPTER 7

I don't remember the details of everything that happened after that.

Did the elevator doors open on the first floor to reveal Brad's smug face, and Irena, wrapped like a snake around the black croupier from earlier in the evening? Did she move like a boa, slow and deadly, tighter and tighter around that man as the elevator doors closed on my shocked face? Was her face hard to see because the man's enormous hand held her whole face in it? And did Brad shrug, and *wink* at me as I stood, dumbfounded, staring at them while the elevator doors closed?

It could have been part of a dream.

I was winning at first. I was up, at one point, over ten thousand dollars. I had to exchange my chips, they were falling out of my pockets.

Or maybe that was a dream, too.

I felt as clear as ice all that time.

I don't remember when I started to lose more than I won. Far more hands than I was winning.

I started to place insane bets on the table. I won a hand with \$1K on it and I walked away, out to the lobby, where I sat on a bench and went over the numbers in my mind. I tried to talk myself back upstairs at that point.

But I was somehow so far down, even after that win.

And didn't it mean, winning \$1K on a hand, that I was up? That I was back in the game?

I remember slapping myself. I was sitting there, drunk, still high, full of shit on a bench and telling myself I was going to beat the house.

Somehow I went back in.

I took money out of savings.

I took more money out of savings.

I bet bigger, bigger and bigger, every time reminding myself of that \$1K hand.

And then it was all gone. I went bust with my last \$500 on the table.

I went upstairs and began to rifle through my pockets for change. I would start out on the roulette table. Win my money back, move back up to blackjack.

It was five in the morning. Victoria was asleep in the bed.

I couldn't find enough money for a cup of coffee.

But I did find the last tiny bit of coke, folded up in the scrap of paper in my pocket.

Oh well. I sat on the toilet and stared at it, before I swiped it up with my finger (because I didn't have a single bill left) and snorted it through my left nostril.

Up until that point, I had been good. I was out of control, and I had blown through my savings account and my checking account, but I hadn't gotten out the credit card. Something had tethered me to reality enough to stop me from doing that.

It was just a tiny bit of coke, but it went to my head.

And then I was downstairs again, all the lights blinking, all the bleary-eyed late-night gamblers still gnawing away at their games in the floor. New dealers, new waitresses, still serving drinks. It was 5:45. Decent people were just waking up.

I could win all the money back by 7am, have a nice cup of coffee with my breakfast in an all-you-can-eat buffet place with Victoria, go home on the 2pm flight and never gamble again.

I was only down \$4K.

Okay, more like \$4500 because I blew through checking.

I had to do something.

I could have all the money back in my account, and pay off the credit card by this evening.

I imagined it all. I remember the woman who counted out my chips for me. I was in line with another man, also sweating, also desperate, also holding the receipt from the cash advance machine with trembling fingers.

I was up, only for a moment, and then it all began to spiral out of control.

Until the last of my chips was swept away, and my heart went cold and black.

I looked at the time. 7am.

I couldn't hear anything. I went deaf for a moment, deaf as I walked through the floor and out into the sunny lobby. Deaf as I watched a man walk by with a giggling hooker. Deaf as I looked at a family, dressed for the sun, heading to the pool. The man had zinc on his nose.

I had withdrawn \$10K.

My pulse was racing so fast I thought – and maybe I hoped – I would have a heart attack and die right there on the marble floor.

I stepped into the elevator.

I got out on the wrong floor and had to wait next a maid to go back up. I wandered the halls, unsure if my room was 415 or 451, until I had the sense to look at the key. I could barely read the numbers. My eyes felt like someone had layered them in gauze.

It took me several tries to open the door. I tried to be quiet but I must have been making quite a racket.

The room was dark, blacked out by the curtains. Victoria propped herself up on her elbows. "What time is it?" she said.

I froze. "I was just putting the do-not disturb sign on," I said. Victoria was wrecked.

She collapsed in the bed. "Oh thank god. I thought we had to get up."

"It's early," I said. "I could use like ten more hours' sleep."

Victoria mumbled something, but she was already drifting off.

I collapsed on the bed. I tried to close my eyes, but every time I nearly drifted off to sleep, my heart slammed against my chest as the thought of all the money I had lost surfaced, again and again.

I was so fucked.

So. Very. Fucked.

CHAPTER 8

I locked myself in the office the day we returned, claiming to have work to do. I didn't elaborate when Victoria looked at me strangely, but she shrugged and went to her mother's to collect Gus. She was not entirely recovered from her own hangover still, and perhaps that's why she didn't question me as to what I could be getting done in sales on a Sunday.

I determined the size and extent of the damage.

I had withdrawn all of our savings but \$23.78. All of our checking to \$17.13.

I wasn't expecting a paycheck until Friday.

The credit card was worse. Far worse. So unimaginably worse.

I checked the accounts hundreds of times, staring at the numbers as though something would change them.

The mortgage payment was going to hit in three days.

"God. Fuck. What the fuck am I going to do?" I whispered.

One part of my brain explained it all to me: I needed to tell Victoria everything, now. I needed to come clean and then she and I would borrow money from someone under some other excuse, and then...

You fucking loser, some other part of my brain piped up.

That's what I was. A fucking loser, a deadbeat loser who had *fucking gambled away a mortgage payment and everything else*.

Montessori.

Oh Jesus fuck.

Victoria's face, as I had never seen it, flashed in front of me. It was just what I imagined she would look like, shaking her head, hating me.

Calling me a loser.

So that is probably why I did what I did next. I needed time, I rationalized. Time to find a solution. Time to find a way that Victoria didn't ever need to know about any of this.

Yes! Some idiotic area of my brain cheered. And then it was all downhill from there.

I raided the emergency fund, which had already been raided several times over, and drove in bare feet to the bank to deposit the money. Why bare feet? I was so crazy I forgot to put my shoes on.

It was only \$500, but it would ensure that Victoria didn't see what had happened as long as she didn't look at the balance. Which she almost never did.

I lay awake all night, scanning my mind for whoever could help me.

And in the morning, after talking a big game to myself about how I was driven now, to sell the way Brad did, and how I was going to make more money in commissions in the next week than I had all year, and after one stupid thought after another, I drove myself:

To Payday Loans.

Think what you want. It all made sense at the time. It made sense because if Victoria's eyes welled up with tears, it was way worse than selling a kidney. Which was plan B.

The plan worked for a few weeks. I got the money into the checking account before Victoria took money out.

But then everything began to snowball.

Victoria needed money for Montessori tuition. She bought something for \$100 here, \$200 there. Before I knew it she had gone through the entire loan. My paycheck was gone before I even received it. I would be back at zero after I paid the interest to Payday Loans, and I still had the loan.

So I did what any good citizen would do. I found Payday's competitor.

I actually did this. I actually drove to seedy part of town and got *another loan* to pay the interest on the Payday loan.

That way, I could keep everything floating until I made a great commission.

I just needed time to cover it all up.

I would sell the fuck out of CT scanners. I would get a huge commission and not tell Victoria. I would pay everything off and replenish the checking account. I would hide the credit card bills until I made another commission.

I would use every dirty, underhanded trick in the book.

I had to. I had no choice.

But as luck would have it – and I don't really know what I was expecting to happen other than this – Victoria chose that particular week to check on the bank statement.

“I need to know what the heck this is all about!”

Victoria's voice was yelling before I even had the door all the way opened.

Her face was flushed with anger. I knew why, and even as guilt stabbed at me and my stomach tied itself in a knot, my cock took a moment to remark to me that she looked hot when she was angry.

She waved a piece of paper – almost certainly a bank statement – in front of my face.

“What in the fuck did you take out \$5,000 dollars for in Vegas! Where is it! Why didn't you tell me!” she was hysterical now. She threw the paper at me and stomped into the kitchen.

I looked into the living room, where Gus was staring, wide-eyed, at me. “Hey buddy. It's okay,” I assured him. “We're just doing a puppet show.”

Victoria let out a holler of rage from the kitchen.

“Victoria,” I said, walking into the kitchen meekly. “I...look, I fucked up..” I tried to think through the numbers. Surely there was still money in the account. What could I tell her to cover it up?

“Don't cuss in front of Gus,” she snapped.

“You did.”

“Really? Really?! *Really?! This is what you have to say?!*”

Her hair was getting wild. She was panting now, like an animal.

She looked skyward, as though trying to meditate, and took a deep breath.

“I am so. Angry. At You. Right Now.”

“Victoria, I put most of the money back...”

My voice trailed off. She blinked. “You realize that isn't the point,” she said. Her voice was still and cold.

It also wasn't true. I snapped my mouth closed.

“I want you to get out. Go stay with a buddy or something. I can't even – I just can't look at you right now.”

“Victoria...”

“*Get out!*” Her sudden anger was in stark contrast to the calm she had just feigned.

“I'm not leaving my own house-”

“Then I will.”

“You're being ridiculous. Just let me explain -”

“Explain what? What? That you gambled five *thousand* dollars? And then *didn't tell me*? What's to explain? Am I missing something? Go!” She took another breath, and closed her eyes, trying to calm herself down. “I need. To calm down.”

She paused, and I noticed that her hand was shaking.

“Please,” she said quietly. Her eyes were still closed tightly. “Just...go see Brad or something.”

Gus started crying at that exact moment.

“You're always telling me we should talk when we're calm!” she shrieked, as if I had said something.

True enough.

I turned, meekly, and went out to the car.

CHAPTER 9

“So what's troubling you, buddy?” Brad said, setting a beer down in front of me. It was so hot that a ring of water formed immediately on the table.

He sat down in the chair and gulped his own beer. He was in only his swimming trunks, and his stomach was tight, without an ounce of fat on it.

How in the fuck did he drink so much beer and get away with that?

I shook my head.

“It must be bad, man, if you got kicked out of the house.”

I ran my fingers through my hair.

“I lost about \$15K in Vegas,” I said.

Brad set his beer down. “No shit.” He shook his head.

“I took out \$10K as a cash withdrawal on my credit card.”

“And Victoria just found out about it,” he said, in a Sherlock-esque voice.

I didn't say anything.

“Well,” he said squinting. “You kind of deserve it.”

I took a sip of my beer.

“She doesn't really know about it all. She thinks the money is back. She's just mad about the gambling itself. I haven't told her about the credit card yet.”

Brad raised his eyebrows. “How's that?”

I shook my head and covered my face with both hands for a moment. When I pulled them down over my skin, they got wet with sweat.

“I took out a Payday loan,” I said, with my fingers in my mouth.

The screen door slid open, and Irena's long legs emerged from it. They seemed almost tangled in another girl's legs – a similarly thin, Russian-looking girl, who had the same unknowable age as Irena, and probably was *only just* legal to fuck.

The girls moved, all legs, closer to our table, giggling in low voices. They were both clad in one-piece swimsuits that were criss-crossed by slices of their tan flesh, across the middle, along their hips, over the top of their small breasts.

Irena waved her fingers at me. “Hello Ryan,” she said, and dove into the water, her long body like a knife. She barely splashed, and she moved quickly to the other side of the pool.

Brad watched her emerge on the other side of the pool, with satisfaction all over his face.

And why wouldn't he be satisfied? He was a hot man, with a hot wife who fucked dealers in Vegas, and he himself was not an idiot who got fucked by dealers in Vegas and then cried because he lost \$15K.

\$15K was probably a joke to Brad anyway.

“Payday loan,” Brad repeated.

I just stared up at the umbrella. It was so hot I was starting to feel faint. Irena's friend sat down on the side of the pool and swing her legs around in the water. She had light brown hair, very long, and the same sullen sexiness as Irena. Her lips were large but sort of flat, and her lower lip was much larger than her upper.

Irena was under the water again, and her head emerged right in front of her friend's feet.

“That's bad,” Brad said.

Irena placed her hand on her friend's feet and pulled them apart. More giggling.

She looked at me and gave me a mischievous smile.

“Did I see you guys getting into the elevator?” I said, transfixed by Irena and pulled away from my Payday problem for a moment.

Brad squinted. “Where?”

She was moving closer, now, talking to her friend, who tipped her head back and let out a low giggle, her shiny hair swinging like a curtain of silk ropes, the bottom of it swishing against her lower back, right where her ass started.

“Oh, Vegas,” Brad said. Then he made a sound that was something like, *huhn*, and smiled to himself. He grabbed a handful of chips and stuffed them into his mouth. “That was fun,” he commented.

I let my mind wander away to my plane fantasy.

He swept his hands together to get rid of the crumbs.

Both of us had our eyes on the two girls, because now Irena had her hands on the outsides of her friend's thighs, and she was teasing her boyishly. She was moving her hand ever-inward. Up and over her thigh, inward to her inner thigh, fingers stroking her skin in a very friendly way.

Very friendly.

"You know, Ryan," Brad said. "I'd be willing to make a little bet with you."

I closed my eyes. "No more bets," I said.

"You can't lose this one."

Irena's head, her hair black with water, her eyes fierce now like she wanted something, was moving closer and closer to her friend. Her mouth was moving but her voice was low and I couldn't hear what she was saying.

"What if you bet me, say, \$15K, that I can sleep with your wife before you sleep with mine?"

His words had to make several rounds through my mind.

I snapped my eyes back to him. "What?" I hissed.

"If I sleep with Victoria before you sleep with Irena, I'll *pay you* \$15K. Of course, vice versa."

What the fuck kind of bet was that?

He picked up his beer and shrugged at my confusion. "Like I said, you can't lose."

"You're not serious."

"I'm not?" His eyes were still on Irena, who was now coming out of the pool, one svelte, sexy inch at a time. Her friend was spinning on her small bottom to pull her legs out the pool. Evidently they were headed somewhere.

I let some air out between my teeth. "So, really, you're paying me to fuck my wife, in that scenario."

Brad closed his eyes, calculating.

"Kind of. Yeah, I guess. Unless you fuck my wife first. In which case, *you* would be paying *me* to fuck my wife."

"Why on earth would you do such a thing?" I said, in a whisper, but my voice was unconvincing. Because in truth, I was already steps ahead of him, imagining him with Victoria. Imagining his cock teasing the outer lips of her pussy right before he plunged in.

Brad set his beer down. "Fun. I want to fuck your wife. I want to help you out. I have some extra cash. Who cares?" He shrugged, as if this were the simplest thing in the world. "Now all *you* need to do is get Victoria on board with it. That's where the fun comes in. She's a little prude, after all, isn't she?" He was almost winking at me from across the table.

“You coming?” Irena asked. She was drying her hair with the towel, and her tanned skin was glistening with droplets of water from the pool. When it was wet her hair looked black like her swimsuit, and it set off the pale-blue of her eyes to the point that she looked almost unreal.

I mean there actually was no way to keep her eyes out of my head. Half-smiling eyes, hovering over her stretched lips that were around my cock...I started to wander away to another fantasy.

The friend, who had propped her leg up on a chair to smear some kind of lotion over her tight muscles in long, sexy strokes, smiled in our direction.

I felt like someone had put a fist through my stomach to reach down and grab my balls and cock.

“And...not fuck my wife before I fuck yours,” Brad added, as if I had any idea what he was talking about anymore. “Coming?”

He stood up, trotting over to Irena's friend, and scooping her up. She was a tiny little thing and she flopped like a rag doll in his arms. A beautiful, wet rag doll with yards of silky hair. She squealed, and Brad ran with her to the sliding door.

Irena had been moving dangerously closer every moment and was now standing next to me, her sparkling thigh so close I could have licked it, so close that I could see a ripple of goosebumps that had spread over her skin. She leaned over and picked up her cigarettes, and her small but perfect breasts nearly grazed my face as she did. She looked at me.

“Coming?” she said, but on her face I could see that she knew I wasn't. She was amused by that, and she seemed amused by the whole thing.

She turned without giving me much time to answer, and shrugged as she headed into the house.

She left the door open.

My head was spinning.

The water in the pool was still moving in small waves, back and forth. From inside the house, I could hear the peals of laughter from Irena's friend.

I felt like I was being led by that same fist through my stomach, like it had grasped onto my cock to lead me around, as I stood up, and walked in a trance to the house.

They were in another room by the time I stepped into the cool kitchen. I closed the door behind me. The air was so cold it sent a shiver

over my skin. I heard their voices, coming from where I knew the master bedroom to be: a large room that jutted over a ravine and was made almost entirely of glass.

I felt like I was walking through syrup.

I wanted, more than anything – well, more than almost anything – to have Irena and her lovely friend suck my cock, alternating, their brown hair shimmering in waves as they bobbed up and down on me. I wanted to see if those two girls would lick each other up and down.

But the sensible thing, I thought, would be to leave.

I was walking down the hallway as I was thinking all of this. I stopped when I got close to the bedroom itself.

Turn around, I told myself.

“Oh Ryan!” the two girls called, as if they were children asking for a bedtime story. Their accents were thick and coated their call with a layer of extra-sexiness.

I told myself to go home, and I stepped into the room.

Irena and her friend were tangled in the sheets and giggling on the bed, and they clapped when they saw me.

Both of them. Clapping excitedly.

“Oh Ryan,” Irena said, pulling the sheet away from her naked body, which sucked me immediately to the bare skin between her legs, where her snatch was nothing but a light-pink slit in her smooth, tanned skin. A white triangle of skin, protected from tanning by her tiny bikini, faded away to her legs. Her long torso was smooth and adolescent, flat as a washboard, without a trace of fat, all the way to her small breasts.

Her nipples were the color of a dark lager.

Now I knew.

She pretended to pout.

“I know you have bet. You can still watch,” she teased me. “And win bet.”

“Anna isn't part of the bet.” It was Brad's voice. Luring me in.

“But Ryan doesn't like Anna as much as he likes Irena,” Irena pouted more. “Isn't that true?”

I stood in the doorway, frozen in disbelief. I was still staring at Irena's naked body. She slid the sheets off of Anna, and gave me a last, enthralling glance, before she put her arm around Anna's shoulder, and brought her lips to Anna's.

I had watched a lot of lesbian videos in my lifetime, but seeing the two of them, in real life, three-dimensional and still damp from the pool, was almost too much for me to take.

Irena smiled at me as she moved her tongue down Anna's body: from her neck to her nipples, where she stopped and lingered, making swirl after swirl with her bright pink tongue against the light coffee-color areola of Anna's breast, while Anna's nipple hardened to a tiny little piece of toffee in the center. Then she bit into it lightly, as though she were advertising a delicious snack, and she lifted her ice-blue eyes to smile at me. Then she moved on, down her body. Anna giggled as she reached her navel, and then she fell back onto the sheets so that Irena could get better access to her snatch. She was not completely shaved, but neatly trimmed, into a tiny strip of light brown hair.

I watched, so utterly sucked in by the two women that I didn't notice Brad coming out of the bathroom. I watched as Irena used her left hand, her big fat diamond weighing down her ring finger, to hold Anna's thigh to the bed while she moved in, closer to her pussy. I didn't have the greatest view, so I only saw snippets: her tongue against Anna's thigh; her tongue against her soft brown hair. Anna giggled and her left leg waved erratically in the air. Irena slapped it down with her other arm, and showing incredible strength for such a small girl, she pushed Anna down so that she could go to work between her legs.

I stood in the doorway, unable to move or even breathe.

I had a view of Irena's ass now, hiked into the air, her pink slit shiny with her own excitement, her almost-nothing bottom serving only to hold her two lovely holes in place in midair. Her black, wet hair was bobbing up and down, deep between the two long and struggling legs of Anna, who was moaning into a pillow and screaming something in Russian.

I could hear the sticky sound of Irena's mouth working on Anna's dripping cunt, a slapping, wet noise that went on and on. She could have been a metronome, she had such rhythm, and she was tireless. I noticed Brad now, looking on, his cock, unlike mine, freed to the open air and pointed at the two gorgeous women in his bed.

I tried not to stare, but his cock was enormous. Fully erect, it was too heavy to point straight out. He had a hand on it and even as large as his hands were, they were full of his own meaty cock, and barely made it around the circumference of the thing.

Naturally, I let the image of his cock filling my wife's pussy simmer in my mind.

Anna was screaming differently now, and I turned back to her. Her toes curled as she came, pressing up against Irena's fierce grip, and Irena's nails dug into her flesh.

Irena sat up on her knees, and Brad moved into the picture now. He gave me a look as he walked toward the bed, but I managed to shake my head in spite of how much I wanted to join in. Partly, because I didn't really believe in the scene happening right in front of me, and partly because I was starting to believe that Brad was utterly serious about his bet, and that this was part of the game, and that I would be \$15K in the hole if I let myself give in to my cock.

There was also the fact...and true enough, this was getting pushed way to the back of my mind at this point... but also the fact that I was married, and if Victoria saw this scene she'd murder me with her tears.

Brad took Irena in his arms and whispered something in her ear, something which made her laugh wickedly and say something in Russian. Then she fell forward on her hands and knees, and I licked my lips with the excitement of seeing Irena take that huge cock inside of her.

But I was surprised that instead, Brad grabbed Anna's legs and twisted her around, and then Irena told her to do something in Russian.

Presumably, what she instructed her to do was to get on her hands and knees.

Now the scene in front of me was of Irena's glistening cunt between her legs, and her tiny asshole above it, her back arched and her hair flung over her shoulder as she looked back at me with mischief in her eyes. Then Brad, his hand moving to his right, to Anna's sopping wet, engorged slit. She was so wet from whatever Irena had done to her that it was coating the insides of her thighs, and I could smell either her pussy or the two of them from across the room now. Like an overripe melon. I closed my eyes.

"No, Ryan, darlink, don't close your eyes. You miss best part," Irena's cat-like voice mewled.

I opened my eyes.

Irena smiled at me over my view of her ass. She was working her fingers up to her own clit now, but it was what Brad was doing that really caught my attention. His big, blunt finger was pulling lines of Anna's sweet juices, up to her dull pink anus, where he was making seductive circles.

He wasn't going to?

He pushed a thumb inside of her, and she howled, low and sexual. I watched his thumb move in and out, pushing against the tight ring of her ass for a few moments. Then he moved – but in such a way as to allow me to have a good view still – and placed a second thumb inside of her. He pried her open as she moaned and twisted, likely in some pain. He used his other fingers to swipe up some of her own cum, like he was filling a hole in the sand at the beach. I stared at her open ass, all of the pink flesh inside of her that was begging me to come fuck it.

And then he placed his big fat cock at the entrance to her most intimate hole.

I sucked in my breath. His cock was so big, and her asshole was so tiny.

She screamed as the first inch of him went in. It was clearly tight, his cock almost bent with the force he had to exert. Anna threw her face into the pillows and yelled, but after a few seconds she seemed to open up, and Brad's cock disappeared inside of her.

It was at this point that Brad's plan of temptation became to clear to me. Irena flipped her hair again, to call attention to herself, and when my eyes flicked over to her, she was looking right at me. Her fingers were fanned out: one in her ass, one in her pussy, one rubbing her clit.

“Ohhhhh,” she cooed sadly. “Who will fuck Irena?”

It did seem like such a waste.

My cock, now, was so hard that I felt like I was going to fall over. I shook my head, and I looked around the room quickly. My eyes fell on a chair, covered in clothes, and I fell into it. I should have left but I just couldn't.

Irena flipped onto her back, onto the pillows at the head of the bed, and spread open her legs in an athletic move that likely hailed from her days as a stripper. She kept looking at me, inviting me. Her eyes glinted with malevolent invitation.

I held my hand up to her.

Meanwhile Brad was ramming his cock into Anna as hard as he could. I envisioned Victoria, her blonde hair splayed on the bed like Anna's was now, her full ass tilted up for Brad, his cock stretching her ass open while she howled into the pillows.

“I'm gonna fill you full of cum, little girl,” Brad growled. “That's what I'm going to tell your wife, Ryan.”

I looked up at the ceiling. My cock had to be purple now, it was in so much pain.

When I looked back at the scene, Irena winked at me. Her fingers were on her clit, making slow, lazy circles. “Such willpower,” she said, and her words were like hard slaps on my already pained cock.

I closed my eyes again, but I couldn't shut out the sounds of Brad's cock moving in and out of Anna's ass, or the slap of his thighs against her buttocks.

Remember the...

The what?

Irena's spread legs seemed to burn right through my eyelids.

That's what I'm going to tell your wife, Ryan.

I heard Brad groan as he thrust even harder into Anna, and I imagined his cum filling her up, filling my wife up, spilling out over the sheets of my own bed.

“Fuck,” I said.

When he pulled out of Anna's ass, it was pulsing and spewing his cum with each throb. “You should get in there,” he advised me. “Feel what it's like to get in there second, imagine what it'll be like when I fuck your wife.”

I stared at Anna's gaped asshole, but I managed to shake my head.

“Maybe just hand-job,” Irena said, folding herself up neatly like some kind of magical barbie doll, and moving toward me in all of her long, lean, nakedness.

My cock was screaming for anyone to touch it.

But I managed to shake my head.

“The bet,” I said, stupidly.

Brad grinned.

“Anna,” I whispered hoarsely.

Anna slid from the bed, and crawled toward me. I was unbuckling my pants.

Irena had turned to Brad, and drawn him close to her. No one, after all, had taken care of Irena. I watched as he tossed her onto the bed and she laughed her frightening laugh, her legs flying in all directions on the bed.

Anna had her mouth open when I looked back to her, and it took everything I had to stop her. “No,” I breathed. “No, sorry...just...can you

just give me a..hand job. Or something. Don't do...anything else.”

She shrugged, and took my cock firmly in her hand. She did it with such an air of professional boredom that I realized at that moment that Anna was a prostitute. Strangely, it only added to the excitement as I watched Brad turn Irena over on her stomach and fuck her with most of his hand.

Irena opened her eyes, and looked directly at me, and I was gone.

My cum erupted without warning and I yelled loudly. I looked down to see it spraying in the air and landing all over Anna's face, as she opened her mouth and tried to catch it. I shuddered as she kept pumping it out until I was completely drained.

Irena waved Anna over, her ponytail wrapped in Brad's hand and her body moving with the force of his fisting.

I remained where I was, breathing heavily on the chair. I wanted to tear myself away, but I could barely move. And then I was glued to the chair as I watched Anna sit next to Irena, and let her lick my cum from the corners of her mouth, then her cheeks, then her neck...

I could feel my cock, almost impossibly, getting hard again.

“I have to go,” I said, my voice strangled and hoarse.

Irena looked at me with amusement as I left the room, holding up my pants, fumbling to get my car keys as fast as I could.

CHAPTER 10

I justified to myself, on the way home, what I had just participated in. I had participated minimally, I told myself.

A hand job, from a hooker I wasn't even paying, was the least-worst thing I could have done in that situation.

It wasn't really cheating.

I couldn't get a disease from it.

Really, it wasn't all that different from watching porn and jerking myself off.

But I knew that if Victoria found out, she would not see it that way.

I didn't like all the things that I had to keep secret from Victoria now. The money, and the lies to cover up the money, and now this.

My stomach was starting to hurt.

Not to mention that my cock had done nothing but swell, and my balls were aching and blue, because all I could see when I blinked was Irena's teasing face, or her tongue licking cum from Anna's lips...

"Fuck," I muttered.

I had to make a payment on my Payday loan today, and I had no idea where I was going to get the money from. Things were mounting up; I was digging a hole I couldn't get out of.

Unless.

Unless I could get my hands on \$15K.

The house was quiet when I got home. Lights out except upstairs.

I shut the door quietly behind me and almost immediately I heard the soft pad of Victoria's feet. She looked down at me from halfway up the stairs, and then nearly ran down.

"You scared me," she said.

And then she surprised me by hugging me.

"I was too mad to call you," she said. "But I'm glad you came home."

I put my hand in her hair. "Victoria, I'm so sorry. I really am."

I wasn't sure which thing I was apologizing for: certainly the money, but also the hand-job.

She pressed her forehead into my chest. "It's just...it's so much money and-"

"I know," I said. "Believe me, I know, it's why I didn't tell you."

She was about to start crying, I could tell. I could hear her breath breaking up into the beginnings of a sob.

"It could have happened to anyone," she said. "I was unfair."

What? Really?

I put my hand on her head.

I had no idea what to say.

"You were just getting egged on by Brad...we both...we all did some naughty things in Vegas. Let's just..leave it. I don't...I don't want to fight with you." She sighed. "It's a lot of money, but it's...it's not the end of the world. I'm just glad you didn't lose that much of it."

Now was the time, I realized. Now was the time to tell her everything.

Tell. Her. About. The money. The moans. The credit card, my conscience urged. Tell her about your lost sales, that we're broke, that you need to take Gus out of Montessori...

But in some other part of my mind, a bad little part of my brain was formulating a plan.

I could keep the credit card bill away from her. I paid it, she never looked at it.

Everything else was out in the open. I could tell her about the Payday loans, I could pay them off, and I could keep everything else a secret until I got the money.

Brad's money.

All I had to do was convince her to sleep with Brad.

All I had to do was tell her about a fantasy I'd wanted to tell her about anyway. A fantasy she'd been toying around with, teasing me with, anyway.

And then, because she seemed to like Brad, because she seemed to be hot for him anyway, everything would fall neatly into place and this nightmare could end.

"Victoria, I have to tell you the truth," I said.

Her face went three shades paler.

"I lost a lot of the money."

She searched the floor for an answer. "Then how...?"

"I wanted to cover it up. I did something stupid and I..."

Her face was changing, getting ready to burst into tears.

Always give a little bit of truth with a lie, said some random voice from the past in my mind. Who had said that? Probably Brad.

"I took out a loan to pay it."

"Oh god."

I plunged in. "It's a Payday loan."

"Oh Ryan." Her voice was small and quiet. She covered her face.

Then she surprised me by removing her hands from her face. She was not crying.

"I need a drink," she said. She moved quietly down the stairs, and brushed past me to go into the kitchen. But she turned and placed her hand on my chest. "We'll figure it out," she said. "There's no point being mad about it."

"I have an idea," I said. It was late now and we were a little too drunk and too tired to be planning anything serious. Victoria had surprised me even further by having several drinks and letting me reassure her and make her laugh about the money. We had started out brainstorming solutions seriously in the kitchen, but as we had more drinks, the conversation had gotten sillier.

It was almost fun at this point.

"Not sheep farming. I already thought of that and the start-up is too high," Victoria quipped.

I laughed through my nose.

I looked at my wife. If anything, she seemed *more relaxed* now that we had this problem. She was on the couch, her shirt open and revealing one full breast almost to the nipple. She was drinking and popping snacks into her mouth, both things that she never did.

She was cracking jokes, even while she was talking about our financial ruin.

Except for her, it wasn't ruin. She didn't know the extent of it, did she? Would she be so fun if she did?

"No," I said.

She put her chin on her hands. "What is it, then?"

She had a gleam in her eye, like she was ready to hear a whopper.

"Well..what if I told you...I know a certain gentleman who would pay a lot of money for your favors."

“Like *Indecent Proposal*,” she said, matter-of-factly. She popped a piece of popcorn into her mouth. “Yeah, that happens to me all the time. I just say no because...well...” she held up her hand and waved her ring around.

“It wouldn't be indecent without that,” I countered.

Then she smiled at me, unfazed. “Do I know this 'gentleman?’”

“Yep.”

“And what does he want me to do?”

Her eyes were shining.

“I think...probably a lot of dirty things.”

Victoria bit her lip. “Like what? Doggy-style?”

I laughed. “Dirtier.”

She fell onto her back. “I don't really know how to do any *really dirty* things, though, Ryan.”

I was formulating my next move, when she propped herself back up on her elbow. “Maybe you could tell me about them,” she said.

Fuck. Could I ever.

“Uh...well most men will probably want you to...”

“Suck their cock?”

“Yes.”

“But probably with some kind of twist, right? Like I need to lie down on the bed backwards and let him just...what is that called?”

“Throatfucking,” I said, my mouth dry.

She laughed. “Yeah, that.”

Her eyes were on mine. She was not using sexy-voice. Her voice seemed serious now.

“What else?” she prodded.

I unbuttoned her shirt.

“Anal?”

I nodded.

“I've never done that before.”

I nodded.

“But...I'm not really into this stuff,” she said. “So...I'm not going to start doing it with you just because I do it with this gentleman. This is only a debt payment.”

I shuddered.

“No. Certainly not.”

“Won't you get jealous?”

I pushed her onto the couch. I pulled her shirt all the way open. My cock was hard against her stomach and she smiled when she felt it. “I kind of like the idea,” I said.

“Oh you do?” she purred.

She felt my cock through my pants. “You do, don't you?”

“What else do you think this gentleman might want to do to you?”

“How should I know?” she said, shrugging. “I'm just a soccer mom in training.”

I wondered, but only for a second, how Victoria could have the exact right words on her lips at that moment. But the blood was rushing to my groin and I didn't think about it long. I slid my fingers into her jeans, into her panties, and down, searching for her slit.

She was wet. She was drenched. My fingers sank into the warm honey between her thighs and a jolt of pleasure went through me.

“Tell me,” I instructed her. “Tell me what he'll make you do.”

My voice was insistent, and Victoria changed her smiling, joking tone as I pulled her pants down.

Victoria was not a dirty talker. Other than her coke-fueled request in Vegas, she never said anything more than *fuck me*, or *that feels good*. So when she opened her mouth, as sexily as she was doing it, I did not expect to hear:

“Well, after he fucks my face, until I'm covered in spit and gagging, and I swallow his cum, I think he'll probably need just a little bit of time to get hard again. And that's when he can tease me just a little. Maybe get me worked up and ready, maybe lick me where he wants to fuck me.”

Jesus.

“And where does he want to fuck you?” I said. My voice sounded like I was in the last stages of my climax. I sounded like a filthy old man.

I was unbuckling my pants.

Victoria smiled. “He'll want to fuck me in the ass, I'm guessing. And...if he's paying for it, I suppose I should let him.”

“Won't it hurt?”

“Oh yes. Especially because his cock is so much bigger than yours. That's...if we're talking about who I think we are.”

Were we? God, I hoped so.

I had my cock out now and I was moving my hand along my shaft.

“Will you let me watch?”

“Maybe. It might be hard to arrange.”

“What else?”

“Well...what else can happen after that? He'll pound my ass full of his cum, and then he'll have come twice by then...I don't know. Do you think he'll want more?”

“Yes.”

“So what will I do? Do you think I should let him fuck me in every hole?”

I teased the sopping wet opening of her pussy with my cock. I was dripping precum, and she stared at me. From the expression on her face she seemed to like what she saw. I didn't answer her question, just moved my head a little in the direction of *yes*.

“Hmmm,” she said. “Well...in that case I suppose I should...”

She looked sheepish again, for just a second, which only further fueled my hard-on, which by now was almost painful. Then she dropped her voice to say:

“I should probably get him all cleaned off before he fucks me again.”

“And how...would you do that?” I was practically out of breath, I was so excited.

Victoria brought her finger to her lips and traced them. Then she put her finger in her mouth and sucked on it. She moved her finger back and forth between her lips, like a cock. Like Brad's cock, that she would lick clean, tasting her own ass and his dirty cum, until he was hard enough to fill her pussy up.

I grasped her by the thighs, and jerked her pussy up and onto my cock.

I was so worked up that I just used her body the way I wanted: I used her thighs to push and pull her up and down my shaft, pumping fast, pounding her good while I thought about what she would look like while Brad fucked her. About the noises she would make when his cock stretched her open and he made her come, over and over again.

My orgasm snuck up on me and exploded. I yelled and looked up at the ceiling.

“Fuck,” I whispered.

Victoria smiled. She pulled me close to her and kissed me.

“Whatever happens,” she said. “We'll work it out but I -” she interrupted herself with a yawn. “I am so tired. I'm so...drunk,” she said. She slid away from me and headed to the stairs. “See you upstairs.”

I watched her retreat, and leaned back against the couch. Where I fell asleep, wondering if what had just happened was what I thought it was.

It wasn't clear, the next day, how serious Victoria had been. Or if she even knew who I had been referring to as a 'gentleman.' It had seemed, that night, like she was really on board with the whole idea, and like we were sharing our little secrets together.

The next morning, though, I gave her a kiss on the neck while she was making her lunch. “That was hot last night,” I said.

She gave me a little smile, but it could have meant anything. She hurried around the kitchen.

I tried again by the refrigerator. “I really liked our... game last night.”

It occurred to me that I shouldn't have used the word *game*.

She kissed me on the cheek and held my head to her lips, whispering in my ear. “We can play it again, if that's what you like.”

But was it a game to her? Or maybe *she* didn't want it to be a game, and only thought it was a game to me because I stupidly said it was.

Then she confused me further, by pulling away and winking at me.

“But don't forget,” she said, and her expression was almost impossible to read. “We have that gala thingy...at the art museum.” She opened a carton of milk and started to pour it into a cup. Then she shrugged. “Maybe some gentleman will be there, though.”

She looked up and smiled at me.

Was she serious? Or playing with me? I had no idea.

“I look forward to it, then,” I said, stupidly.

“You're meeting me there, don't forget. You need to take your suit to work.”

“I have a new dress,” she said. “Maybe I can attract an indecent proposal that way.”

She winked again, and as I drove to work I analyzed every second of our conversation, searching for an answer to my question:

Was Victoria serious? Or was she kidding? And if she was kidding, was it just because she didn't know I was serious?

CHAPTER 11

I had forgotten all about the fundraiser. It was for a documentary about medical supplies in South Sudan, and LexPharm had joined the campaign almost entirely as a PR move. Victoria was excited about it and had taken a lot of personal interest in it, as she always did with humanitarian causes. She was going early to meet the documentarians.

I had to work late, and I didn't arrive until about 9pm. I wandered around the art museum, which appeared to have been entirely given over to the cause. I saw a lot of LexPharm guys and guys from other vendors. There was also a healthy sprinkling of artsy-looking people. I made my way slowly through the crowd, stopped by every other Tom, Dick, and Harry.

I wanted to see my wife's new dress.

Victoria was sitting on a bench in a photograph collection exhibit, looking at a black and white from the early 1900's. Her blond hair swept across her shoulders, beneath which the dip in the back of her new black dress revealed an unusually large amount of skin for her. The dress hugged her figure, and she was leaning on one arm so her narrow waist poured into the curve of her ass. She looked incredibly sexy.

She was lost in thought.

I held back, admiring her figure, her crossed ankles, her smooth neck. Every now and then, I needed to see Victoria at a moment like this, to be reminded of how stunning she really was. I always appreciated her, of course, but at a moment like this I saw her as a stranger. She turned heads. She would turn my head.

I was across the room, and so I didn't hear what was said, but a voice made her turn toward it. Her lips were bright red, an unusual choice for her – and for a moment I thought I had mistaken another woman for my wife. She smiled, and reached out to take a glass of wine from a man, as though she knew him very well, as though he got a glass of wine for her all the time.

The familiarity of her smile, the way her fingers closed around the glass, sent a spike of jealousy through me. I moved my eyes to the man, who was turning to the photograph and lifting a glass to his lips.

A cool, sickening feeling crept over me as I took in his thick black hair, his stubble-flecked square jaw.

Brad.

Then he sat.

There is a subtle thing about the distance between two people, when they sit down someplace like a museum. It is a matter of centimeters, of just a breath of distance to close or too far, that indicates a couple who is fighting; a couple who has been married too long; a non-couple; a pair who wish to be a couple.

And a distance, as well, for two people who should *not* be a couple. But are.

When Brad sat down, Victoria turned to him again and said something inaudible with another wide smile. She was being witty, making a joke.

Did she lean toward him as she did this? Was he gravitating slightly closer to her?

Brad's guffaw, over-appreciative – flirtatious, then, because whatever Victoria had said it could not have possibly been so funny – echoed in the half-empty room. He slapped his thigh.

Victoria looked down at her lap.

Blushing?

They were not far apart at all. Not touching, just inclining. Just sitting the distance apart for heat to crinkle in the air between them. Close enough to smell a whiff of someone's soap or aftershave. Close enough to know when the other person moved, to hear a whisper.

Too close, for a married woman and a man who was not her husband.

My face was getting hot. My pulse was racing.

I couldn't tear my eyes away from them.

No. I was being crazy. They were inches apart from each other and the bench was not big enough for anyone to reasonably sit further apart than that.

Or was it?

Victoria's hair slid over her shoulders like silk as she turned to Brad again, and she tucked a strand of her hair behind her ear – now she was definitely leaning in. Her mouth moved, and Brad turned to her.

Now they were with their heads nearly together.

Victoria seemed to be explaining something. Her eyes were down, and from where I was they seemed closed.

But Brad's eyes were on her face. Moving all over her face, watching her mouth as it moved. Probably thinking about her mouth opening up for him.

My hand shook.

Maybe she had been serious.

Maybe this had been her way of telling me she wanted the same thing I did.

Irena's dark presence occupied the space next to me and disturbed the air around us. She had a glass of wine in her hands and brought it to her lips. She was barely covered by a layer of black lace with large patches of fine mesh between them. The material was so thin it could probably have been folded up and placed in a coat pocket for storage.

The dress was long, which only made it sexier. It dipped very low in the back, and the way she was standing I could see its tantalizing end: right above the place where the two small hills of her ass would come together in a tiny valley.

She leaned on the door-frame. "Brad tells me about bet," she said. "Seems like good idea." She looked at me. Her blue eyes were strangely dark, maybe from the light, maybe from her mood. Maybe her bangs were casting a shadow onto them. They were the color of a northern lake now, and she narrowed the straight lines of them even more as she looked at me. "Good bet," she said, and it seemed like she gave the words a good suck as they left her mouth. She bit her thumb, and sucked me in with her eyes. She knew, as well as I did, that I was picturing her mouth on my cock right now. "Everyone wins."

She turned, and walked into the room then, giving me a great view of her long dress, clinging to her tiny bottom. The dress exaggerated the length of her legs, so that she had the appearance of a foal. The dress clung, barely, to the very outer edge of her shoulders, before it plunged again in the front. The black lace encased her long arms and flared at the wrists. As she moved, the whole thing slithered over her skin, and the shape of her body seemed to rise, like a figure coming out of the water, before submerging again and again in the fabric.

Win-win.

If only I could keep myself from fucking Irena, and find out what it was like to have those long legs wrapped around me, to have those ice blue eyes cutting through me while her mouth performed untold miracles on my cock.

I only had to wait until Brad could fuck my wife. Which I wanted. Didn't I?

Victoria looked up and smiled at Irena, then looked past her to me.

She looked lovely. Something about her *was* different, something besides the red-orange lipstick. Her mouth was a plump, inviting shape, but the smile was what was different.

There was something naughty behind it.

Wasn't there?

I gulped my wine, held up a finger to indicate that I would return, and headed for the bar.

I left Victoria alone, I hoped with Brad, as much as I possibly could that evening. It wasn't hard: there was a never-ending fountain of people with whom to dispense meaningless handshakes and chit-chat from the business. We compared a lot of consumer goods and talked about sports.

At 10:30 Victoria entered the room where I was standing – near the gift shop (and the bar). The men in the room changed the moment she came in. Ears perked, eyes wandered. I knew a beautiful woman had come through the door, and then I felt her finger on my shoulder.

She was kind of *slinking* in that black dress. It was cut low over her bosom, something I hadn't noticed when I first saw her. It was tight on her body, and she was all big, round curves in inky black. She put her hand on the back of my neck and whispered in my ear that she needed to go home.

Her face was a little flushed. She seemed slightly drunk.

I looked at her mouth. Her lipstick had worn off, and she hadn't bothered to refresh it. Had it been smeared in a dark corner by Bard's lips?

Her eyes were glittering. She clutched my arm and whispered in my ear flirtatiously. "Come on. I'm tired."

"You'll excuse me," I said, to the group I had been talking to. They were trying to carry on their conversation, but it was dripping out of them like a faucet that had been turned off. And why?

Because my wife was so fucking hot.

"So?" I said, in the car.

“So...” she said. I looked over at her, She had her hands crossed on her knee and was genuinely curious as to what I was talking about. She was also being adorably flirtatious, smiling and touching her neck, putting her hand on my knee.

“That's a lovely dress.”

She looked down at the wide curve cut from the top of it. The dress revealed a good but classy portion of her cleavage, in an uneven sweep across her chest.

“A bit sexier than usual,” I said.

She shrugged. “Is it?”

I couldn't tell, for the life of me, if she was teasing or serious.

“You had a nice time?” I asked her.

“Yeah,” she said vaguely.

“I saw you flirting with your man.”

“My man?”

Now her tone was definitely...something was definitely up with it.

“Didn't I see you with your gentleman?”

“What?” she rounded off the word with a big laugh.

But was it a laugh to egg me on, or a confused laugh?

Victoria was not typically a player of games, or a teaser, or in any way coy. It was what I had most liked about her when we first started dating: what you saw was what you got, which was refreshing. She was just, really, *that sweet*.

But now, she seemed to have some kind of edge to her. A little bit of dirty film on her, ever since Vegas. My veins filled up with an icy-hot desire just thinking of her, sitting on Brad's lap, snorting coke in the red light of the strip club.

Maybe she didn't have an edge.

Maybe I just wanted her to.

“Didn't I see you flirting with Brad?”

She put her fingers to her lips and tapped them. “Flirting with Brad...” she said, mysteriously.

“I thought maybe you were getting to work on our plan. Moving fast.”

Victoria's mood changed suddenly. She turned and pressed herself against the door, her face screwed up in an accusatory expression.

“Okay...what are you talking about. Seriously?”

But was she serious? Serious in her shock?

I pressed on.

"I'm talking about Brad. I'm talking about Brad's... 'indecent proposal.'"

"Oh. Oh, yeah. That. Yes, we were just talking all about that." She waved her fingers in the air. The gesture was one she never made. It was impossible to tell what it meant.

I looked over at her. Her eyes were the color of honey and her pretty lips were twitching with a smile.

There was a silence.

"Wait. You're not serious are you?"

I raised my eyebrows. "Noooo," I said, my voice dripping with sarcasm.

She opened her mouth and looked around outside the car, like she had an audience and wanted them to feel her shock.

"But what about Irena?"

"Uh...Irena is fine with it, if that's the question."

"What do you mean, fine with it?"

"They're swingers, Victoria. It's part of their marriage."

Her mouth opened even more.

"Oh my god." Victoria was shaking her head.

"What?" I decided to be brave. "I thought you were into it."

"They do *not* really do that, do they?"

I was getting a sinking feeling of two kinds: one, of disappointment, and the other, of desperation.

I had been so thrilled, only an hour or so ago, that I was possibly going to collect my debt money, that I was going to pay off the credit card, that I was going to have Victoria tell me how much she enjoyed fucking another man.

Now it was all getting crushed by Victoria's sensibilities.

Reality.

"They do," I answered, annoyed.

She opened her mouth wide again and made a theatrical face of shock and awe. But when she closed her mouth, she was smiling a little.

"Wow," she said. She shook her head again.

"I thought you were into it," I complained.

“Wait,” she said. She turned to me. “You thought I was *serious*? You were *serious*?”

Then she laughed and flopped back in the seat. “You’re fucking with me,” she said, pulling a brochure out of her purse.

I looked at the road. I gripped the steering wheel.

Just shut up, Ryan.

But it was Victoria who went back to the topic.

“But they really do it?” she mused.

The streets were slick with rain. I was starting to see double. I really shouldn’t have been driving.

“How do you know for sure?” Victoria said suddenly.

“What?”

“How do you know? How do you know they really do it, and it’s not just some game they play?”

I tightened my hands on the steering wheel. “Just what Brad says.”

Victoria pulled the mirror down and twisted a stick of lipstick.

“You don’t think he’s lying?”

I got annoyed. “Why would he lie?”

“I mean, beats me...I don’t even understand what...like he really gets off, on his wife with another man? Like, does he *watch* her, or what?”

I said nothing and switched lanes, slowly and deliberately, using my blinker.

“It’s a common fantasy,” I said finally.

Victoria turned to me again, her lipstick still in the air near her lips. She had detected something, and she was perked up like a rabbit.

“Oh really?”

Now she sounded like she was fucking with me again. Playing innocent, when she wasn’t exactly. Because it had been Victoria, all this time, who had turned up the volume on our game-playing, as mild as it was. Victoria who had opened the door to even the merest discussion of it.

“You know it is. What the hell have you been doing when you talk about it with me? It obviously turns *you* on, too.”

I looked down at her crotch to give her an idea of what I meant.

I sounded angrier than I meant to and regretted it immediately.

I knew, from stories online, that the key to getting your wife interested in this kind of thing – really doing it – was patience, and I was

losing mine.

Because of the fucking money.

"I'm sorry. I'm just... Yes, it's a common fantasy."

There was a silence in the car, and the rainy streets roared through it.

"*Your* fantasy?"

"Yes," I hissed. "My fantasy too."

She dropped her lipstick and began to look for it.

She plopped backward in the seat and looked out the window, saying nothing.

"And Brad really made this proposal to you," she said, at last.

I sighed.

"Forget it."

"You just don't have to get all testy with me!" she snapped. "Sorry. Sorry I didn't realize you wanted to whore out your wife."

"It's not -"

I left the sentence unfinished. It *wasn't* like that, not the fantasy.

But technically speaking, it had become precisely that.

My cock was getting hard just thinking about it.

I stared at the road.

I tried to remember things I had read about how to talk your wife into hotwifing.

"It's not..listen, it's not about that. It's like...it's hard to explain," I began.

Her head whipped toward me so fast I thought it would fall off.

"You're *serious!*" she shrieked. "You're completely frackin' serious! Oh. My. God!"

She bit into her knuckles and stared out the window again.

"You know what," I said calmly. "This isn't a good time or place to talk about it. I was...I'm really sorry, I thought you were on board before..."

She held up a hand.

I shut my mouth with a snap.

We drove in silence all the way home.

I supposed I had misjudged Victoria. *Of course you have, idiot*, my inner voice told me. I had been lucky to get Victoria to talk the way she did

while we were having sex, and I was a fool for thinking a wife like mine was going to take something like this to the next level.

I parked in the driveway and we both looked at the garage door for a while.

“I’ll pay the sitter,” Victoria said, and got out of the car.

I still couldn’t get a real read on her mood.

I sat in the car and pretended to be on the phone when Amber, the babysitter, came out a few minutes later. She waved at me and crossed the street to her car.

After she drove off I went inside.

Victoria was waiting for me, her hand on the couch. She gave her long, straight hair a toss over her shoulder, and opened her mouth a few times, unable to say anything.

“Victoria -”

“Just. Okay...listen, I have to tell you something.”

I felt something turn in my stomach. It went through me to the center of my crotch, but it was the kind of icy, sick feeling that could be sexual or could be fear.

It felt like the moment of silence between that sentence and her next lasted forever. I looked at my wife: her curves filling the black dress, spilling over it. Her fresh face, her wheat-colored eyes. I knew something would change when she next spoke. The danger and the promise of it crackled in the air.

“I’ve been...” She rolled her eyes up to the ceiling. It wasn’t easy to say for her. “I’ve been thinking-”

“Look,” she said, interrupting herself. “I didn’t get mad just now about the...you know, about the idea. Itself. Like, you’re right, okay? I’ve thought about it. I...well, you know I found your...”

She looked toward the office, where the computer was, so I knew she was talking about my porn. She brought her finger to her face, just below her nose, as though she were covering up an indiscretion.

It was cute, and I couldn’t help myself. A light laugh erupted from my chest and came out of my nose.

She looked up at me quickly and then also laughed.

“I know. It’s silly.”

I waited for her to pick back up where she had been in her thoughts. I was tingling with excitement now. I couldn’t even quite believe I had heard

what I'd heard so far.

"I...so my problem was not so much...the *idea*." Her eyes meant mine for a moment and held me in their seductive gaze.

"It was that there was money involved," she whispered.
I was paralyzed where I was standing.

She looked around the room, as though maybe there were a script somewhere to help her. She scrunched up her nose and put her hand to her face again. This time she covered it. "I mean, maybe it wasn't even that there was money...so much as...it was just such a... *paltry* sum of money."

She uncovered her eyes and looked at me. "Is that...?"

The next thing I did, I have no idea why I did it. I think because with Victoria standing there, confessing her real desires and the truth about how she felt. I couldn't lie to her for even one more moment.

"Victoria. I can't lie to you for even one more second," I said.
"This...it's everything I wanted, I really want this. But the thing with Brad. I have to tell you. It's..."

My voice trailed off and I looked at the floor. I was bumbling like an idiot, and I knew I was about to lose this opportunity.

I looked back up at Victoria, and her sincere, warm eyes cut through me.

"Victoria. It's so much more money than that."

Her mouth snapped shut. She cocked her head. Then her gaze went cool and her eyes narrowed.

"How much more?" Her voice was quieter now.

I looked at the ceiling. "God, Victoria, I don't know what happened...I lost a sale to Hampton General, I was trying to get the money back -"

"How. Much. More?"

I looked down again. "It's like \$17K now."

"Now," she whispered. She sat down on the couch.

"What..?" She was shaking her head.

Her eyes were going to well up with tears. Any moment.

I couldn't stand Victoria crying. I rushed over to her and knelt by the couch. "Look, I'll get us out if it. I've been lying too long though. I can't lie to you after...I could...we can sell the car...Victoria, please don't. I know I fucked up."

She was shaking her head still. Slowly, strangely. She brought her hand to her mouth.

“It's so much money.”

“It's...it is. Victoria, it is,” I admitted finally. I hung my head. “It's so much money and I'm so fucking sorry. I just...I was so snowed under at work, I got so screwed by this sale, and Brad was making so much money, and we were in Vegas...it all went to my head. And then I couldn't bear to tell you about it.”

It felt good to be confessing. I could feel the stress evaporating out of me..

“This is my money, too. My...this...how could you not *tell me*?!”

My mouth opened up and I started gushing.

“Victoria, I thought I could get it covered up without you knowing about it. Can't you understand? And then I just got in deeper and deeper...”

Victoria wiped a tear from her eye.

“What are we going to do?” she sniffed. She was trying to put on a brave face, and I loved her for that.

I sat back on my heels. Shrugging, as though I were making a joke, I said:

“There's always Brad.”

We both laughed.

But the laugh disintegrated into a strange, tense silence between us.

“He's not serious, is he?”

She was deadly serious.

I sat here with my mouth open.

“About paying? Is he serious?” she repeated.

Victoria's eyes were hardened now, into two amber stones. She had a business-like expression on her face.

My chest got tighter as I squeaked: “I mean, I think he is. Perfectly serious.”

Victoria brought her thumb to her mouth to chew on a hangnail, a habit she had when she was nervous or over-excited.

“Is it really your fantasy?”

“I wouldn't want you to do anything-”

“Is it?”

I was hardly able to breathe now. I leaned closer to her, my hands on her knees. "It's been my fantasy for a long time."

"Like you really, actually, want to see me with Brad?"

I nodded.

"You would want it even if there wasn't money involved?"

I nodded again.

"You wouldn't get jealous?"

Tread carefully, Ryan.

"It's not so much...that I wouldn't get jealous. It's almost like...that's part of it."

She bit into her fingernail with a crack.

"And Brad would give you \$15K. That's the bet."

I nodded.

"Why would he do that?" She seemed to be asking the window, where she was looking into the street.

I lowered my head. "The bet is that he'll pay me if I can keep from having sex with Irena before he gets to you."

To my surprise, Victoria said, "Oooooohhhhhh," like she was just realizing some secret to life.

She closed her eyes.

It seemed like along time that she sat like that: still, like a cat. Then her eyes opened, and she said, in a calm, almost surreal voice:

"I have to think about it. I'm going to bed. Just..." she waved at the couch, which I took to mean, leave her alone.

I watched her go upstairs, heard her footsteps as she peeked in on Gus.

Did I really want Victoria, my pristine Victoria, who took care of my child and kissed him goodnight, to do this thing?

No matter what though, I kept circling back to the idea and knew that I did.

I lay back on the couch.

I would let Victoria make the decision, I decided. Whatever it was. I wasn't going to try and manipulate anything anymore.

CHAPTER 12

Victoria was up and making coffee long before I finally opened my eyes. Gus was standing in front of me, a huge plastic truck in his hand and poised to crash down on my head. I snatched it from him with a smile, and headed to the kitchen.

Victoria was efficiently making breakfast, tidying up, checking off lists and packing things into bags. Like she did every day.

She smiled at me.

Just an ordinary morning.

I poured myself a cup of coffee and she approached me to kiss me on the cheek.

“What time do you think you'll be home tonight?” she said. Her voice was cheerful.

It was Friday. I usually left work around 4:30. There was no point trying to sell anything on a Friday afternoon.

“Five-ish,” I said.

She leaned over the counter. “I've made a decision,” she said. “Let's go out for a nice dinner. I got a sitter.”

When and how Victoria had obtained a sitter between last night and this morning was a mystery, but I didn't argue.

“Where...?”

“You choose. Make a reservation. Someplace nice.”

And then she swept up all of her things, urged Gus to go to the car, and was out the door with a perfunctory, *goodbye, sweetie*.

12:00 pm. I was sitting in my office with the door closed, as I had been for most of the day. I had accomplished nothing, work-wise. I could only think about Victoria, the many shades of Victoria. Victoria who had always been so clear and easy to read.

Looking back on everything that had happened since the sailboat adventure with Brad, I felt like she was shedding some kind of skin. Slowly molting into the wife I had always thought I wanted.

Don't get me wrong: it had been my fantasy for a long time. A real fantasy, one that I constantly questioned. Thinking of Victoria's body, shiny

with sweat, bucking on top of Brad's muscled physique, made me so hard I got dizzy.

The excitement that it stirred in me was almost too much, though. Almost too intense.

There was also all of Victoria's teasing. Was she serious? I still couldn't tell.

The fact that she had buried some secret inside of her, and that she revealed or pretended to reveal it, was almost as much of a turn-on as the idea of Brad's fingers moving down her blouse, popping each button open, revealing her supple body inch by inch. The mischievous glint in her eyes seized me almost as much as the image of Brad's hand, moving lower, cupping her between the legs, his fingers fanning out to explore the inside of her pussy. The idea that she was just fucking with me, stringing me along, was almost as tantalizing as the idea that the smell of her cunt would be on Brad's huge fingers, that he would lift them to his nose and inhale the scent I held so dear.

My phone rattled on the desk.

[Victoria]: Did you make a reservation yet?

[Ryan]: Yes. Linden Garden.

A lie. I had been inactive like a drunk lizard, my cock nearly bursting and then my head nearly exploding with all the dirty thoughts I was having. I moved my mouse and got busy finding the number.

[Victoria]: Time?

I picked up the phone and dialed.

I looked out through the window of my office, to the hallway, looking for Brad.

[Victoria]: I need a time.

“Yes, I need to make a reservation. For two.”

A bored hostess flipped through a heavy bundle of paper. The sheets scraped together over the phone. My cellphone buzzed again. My stomach twisted as I waited.

“I don't have anything,” the hostess said.

My heart sank.

“Wait. I have a seven and an eight-thirty.”

I exhaled. “Seven, please.”

I grabbed my phone.

[Victoria]: I need a time so I can tell Brad.

The reality of it, all spelled out like that, hit me hard. It seared me through the chest, almost like the feelings I had for Victoria when we had first met. The soaring feeling of fresh, raw attraction. I typed.

[Ryan]: Seven okay?

A long pause. I was breathless, actually breathless as I waited.

[Victoria]: K see you there.

I stared at the message.

Was this really happening?

CHAPTER 13

I was nervous like it was our first date as I sat at the bar with a glass of wine, waiting for Victoria. Every time the door to the restaurant opened my heart slammed against my chest with that sweetly painful sensation of first-time excitement. A feeling that had disappeared, or maybe had transformed into something else so long ago, that I had almost forgotten what it felt like.

Outside, it had begun to rain. Everyone entering the restaurant burst in with a shake and a little squeal. All the movement that accompanies people coming in from the rain: excited, wet, movement. For some reason it only served to make me feel younger, more adventurous, more alive.

The door opened, and I almost didn't recognize her. A man held it open for her, and I had the strong illusion for a moment that she was just a stranger. A gorgeous woman, entering the restaurant, on the arm of another man.

She slid an expensive, gray raincoat from her shoulders, and beneath it her body seemed to pop into the room. A rust-colored dress, the color almost impossibly perfect for her, encased her in yards of fashionable suede-like fabric – but only just. It was a sleeveless dress that cut in a low v-shape between her breasts. The fabric wrapped around her in a complicated, figure-hugging drape that ended at her knees. Just a few inches of her legs appeared before they were swallowed by leather boots of an inexplicable color, sort of grayish and tan at the same time. High, sexy boots, completely unlike her personality.

I could almost hear the male eyes flicking in her direction. She gave a shake of her long hair, which was damp but had survived the ordeal of the rain remarkable well. Her lips were painted with a slightly redder rust color. Her eyes had picked up the deep orange in the dress, and converted to a rich brown.

I watched her walking toward me. She moved like a tigress, all orange-and-cream, toned beauty, drawing all attention to her as she moved toward me.

She sat down and crossed her legs.

The bartender had raised his eyes in appreciation, and now he gave his look of appreciation to me. A slight nod, like: *nice going*.

And it really was nice going, I realized. Victoria was a hundred cuts above me, in every way.

She flashed the bartender a smile. "Gin and tonic."

Was she aware of what she was doing to the entire room? Did she know exactly how much power she held over all of the men – even the married men, the men with girlfriends, who were giving themselves a headache right now by straining deep into their peripheral vision to see her?

She seemed to know. It was so unlike her, but she seemed to have acquired a sense of herself, and not only that, she was using it. Subtly, and with grace, but using it nonetheless.

She set her coat down on the stool next to her. "Did you get a table?"

"They're holding it for us."

"Are you really hungry?" She ended her sentence with a wicked smile.

I shook my head. I was hungry, but not for food.

She bit into the small straw from her drink, with just her front teeth.

"Let's just have a few drinks then."

I held up my finger to order myself another wine.

"You look stunning," I said.

She twisted the straw in her teeth.

"I know."

I felt her two words ripple through me.

Her eyes made a sweep over the room, taking in her power over everyone. Then she stabbed the straw back into her drink.

"I have to confess something," she said.

I tapped my fingers lightly on the table, but I said nothing. She was like a wild animal now, one that I wanted to coax in my direction, and I didn't want to make whatever was inhabiting her body get startled and flee.

She leaned over her exposed knees, and clasped them in a girlish gesture. "I think I really like being bad."

Uncertainty crawled around inside of me. There was the doubt, still alive in me, that she was really going through with this. That she was genuine.

I returned her gaze and gave a little nod.

"I told Brad I would meet him at eight."

I felt cold suddenly. Cold and hot. My hand trembled and my wine sloshed in the glass.

She lowered her chin, sharpening her gaze. “Ryan. It's time to 'fess up. This isn't a game anymore. Is this really, really what you want?”

I considered my words carefully. I had been planning them all day. “I want it if you want it.”

My voice was hoarse.

She rubbed her calf against mine. Her boot made such a thrilling, sexy shape of her leg that I thought I might burst just looking at it.

“And am I right in thinking,” she said, in a low voice, “that you give me permission to be *very naughty*?”

Victoria, I must admit, always held me captive. I loved her from the moment I saw her. But at that moment, she had me in her hand and could have made me say or do anything at all.

“Whatever you want,” I whispered.

“But the naughtier, the better. Is that right?”

“If you want.”

She grinned, and she sat back in her seat. She looked a little evil. Just a little. “Well. Then.” She set her drink down, and slid off the stool. “I'm going to go get your money back, Ryan.”

She placed her hand behind my head, and pulled me to her. Her kiss was hungry, full of desire. A real kiss, a thing we hadn't shared for a really long time.

Her eyes met mine. They were smiling.

She whipped around suddenly, and the gesture cut through me like a hot knife. She walked through the bar and out to the rain-covered street. The rust-colored dress, narrow at her waist, flared to an overturned c-shape, and her ass moved beneath the fabric, one hard cheek at a time. And then she was gone.

CHAPTER 14

I sat at the bar, a little bit stunned, for a good twenty minutes. I was unable to do much of anything. About five minutes after Victoria departed, the bartender shook his head and looked at the door in mourning. “You scare her off?” he had asked me. I can't remember how I responded.

I don't remember driving home. I felt much the way I had when I had lost all of my money in Vegas. The air filled with a dull hum, which may have been imaginary, and everything seemed to come to my senses through a haze. I must have paid the babysitter. I must have stood looking at Gus for a few minutes. I must have poured myself a drink.

Because after some amount of time, I found myself in the living room, a drink in my hand, the lights off. I was staring at the street. Everything transformed, in one swift moment, from unreal to real.

Victoria, my wife, had just agreed to let Brad fuck her.

Was that right? Was that what was happening here?

The image of Brad, in every way the superior man, swarmed in front of my eyes. Brad's strong jaw and masculine features, Brad's toned pecs and abs, Brad's strong, enormous hands.

Brad's huge cock, standing at attention between his muscled thighs.

Where would he take my wife?

Would he take her to dinner first, or at least for a drink? Would they go home to his house, where I had so recently watched Irena, Anna, and Brad engage in raw, beautiful depravity?

Would Irena watch?

I looked at the time.

It was 9:30 now.

Were they sitting together, laughing?

Or had Victoria been so overcome by her attraction to Brad that they had dispensed with any flirting whatsoever? What was the plan?

I imagined him opening the door, his confident smile plastered on his smug face. Victoria, damp from the rain, would be standing on the front porch of his expensive, chic home. Their eyes would meet, and then they would jump on each other like animals.

I imagined Brad's hands clawing at Victoria's rust-colored dress. Tearing the fabric to shreds right before he moved on to the next meal: my

wife.

It was alternating between rain in torrents and looking as though it would dry up and be a clear evening, and my feelings did much the same kind of drastic alternating. My cock was hard as stone as I pictured Brad's hands moving all over Victoria's body, but my heart took sickening dives to the depths of despair and then rose to soar high with elation.

The feeling, I noted, in a calm moment, was almost identical to that of falling in love with Victoria. The twisting, almost nauseating flashes of cold and hot, the obsessive thinking, the sweaty, aching desire. They were all feelings that had dulled long ago, and which I had resigned myself to never feeling again.

Now they were back. I felt sick, and I felt high. I was emotionally destroyed, and I was elated.

I poured and drank another drink.

I sipped slowly, because the time was passing slowly and I wanted to be awake when Victoria came home. Awake to hear every detail.

Then there was the matter of Victoria herself. So formidable now, so in possession of her sexual power. Was this what I had wanted? It was a turn-on, because it was like having a new woman in my life in some ways. But it was also frightening. Had I lost the Victoria who blushed and giggled modestly when she talked about sex, forever? Had I wanted that Victoria to completely disappear?

What was she doing, at this moment? Were her hands on Brad's back, her legs open and her pussy spread by his cock? What was she thinking as he fucked her? How good it was, to feel a real man inside of her? A man who made money, a man who was strong, a man who knew how to get things done?

There was something so sensual about the idea of Victoria getting fucked by a properly masculine man like Brad, that I shuddered.

Hours went by. I paced. I poured drinks. I threw some of my drinks down the drain, not wanting to consume them but only wanting to have the activity of making them. My balls ached.

I should have been tired, but my pulse was racing and I felt like I could run a marathon.

Every beam of light that flickered through the bushes sent streaks of electricity through me. My stomach would contort in knots as the lights moved on.

How was Victoria even getting around?

She hated cabs. She hated hailing them and calling them. I imagined her in the back of a cab, looking out the windows, a faint smile on her lips. Almost like Brad had poured his confidence right into her.

Was she in a cab right now, with her panties getting wetter and wetter with Brad's cum?

Another spike of electricity went through me as I thought of Victoria's panties. Surely she had not worn the sensible cotton ones. But what had she worn? Had she bought a new pair? What kind of panties did a woman like Victoria buy when she decided, finally, to be naughty?

I realized I had no idea. I had no idea what color or type of lingerie my wife Victoria might have chosen for this occasion.

Or maybe she *had* gone with cotton. And maybe that was precisely the thing that Brad wanted.

Was she still in a hotel, or in his house, moaning into a pillow and thinking about how she would never be satisfied by her husband again?

The street went silent and dark for a long time. Then a pair of lights stirred my excitement, and slowed in their path across the window. The vehicle had stopped. I heard the idle of a car, the slam of a door. The beams narrowed and disappeared.

My heart gave me so much pain inside my chest I almost wondered if I was having a heart attack.

Victoria opened the door and sprinkled a look that could have meant anything in my general direction. It could just have easily been disdain for some errant socks on the couch, as a tired smile after a long day at work.

But it wasn't either of those things.

She bent over to unzip her boots and step out of them. Her blond hair fell across her face and I could not see or read her expression.

She stood up, and slipped her raincoat from her shoulders.

There was something different about her. Of course, in the back of my mind, I knew that what was different about her is that she had just fucked Brad, or so that had been the plan. This difference, however, was more subtle. Only a husband, a person who spent so much time observing her, could have noticed these things: her hair was wet and it clung to her face, but she shook it instead of smoothing it away with her fingers and patting it perfectly into place. Her coat was wet but she tossed it over a chair – without folding it neatly, even – and then flopped on the couch.

And see this is the thing: she didn't give a shit about that coat, and she wasn't faking it. Fat drops of water were dropping onto the carpet, so big and fat they were making a heavy plopping sound. She flipped her air a little more and looked at me from the couch, her legs crossed, and *did not give a shit* about that coat.

She raised an eyebrow.

I wonder what expression I had on my face. My eyes were moving over her body, as if I could see something different about her, but other than her disregard for her hair, she really *looked* the same.

Except for the expression on her face.

It was almost...challenging.

She bounced her ankle lightly and slid, ever so slightly, down the couch, so that her skirt rose up past the thick band of lace at the end of her stockings.

I had no idea, from looking at her face, if she was angry, turned on, happy, or what.

“So,” she said. She uncrossed her legs, and sat akimbo, like a fashion model. She moved her hands along the outside of her thighs, her eyes locked on mine.

Was her mouth turned up in a little grin?

She cocked her head slightly. “Do you want to hear about it?”

Her fingers were nearing the lace of her stockings, tapping on her thighs playfully. Her skirt was sliding, tiniest bit by tiniest bit, so that the shadow between her legs was getting smaller, promising to reveal her snatch soon. My eyes were drawn to it, watching the shadow shrink, searching for the shiny leftovers of another man's cum.

When I returned my gaze to her face, I could see that she was eating up my expression the same way I was eating up the sight of her open legs.

“Do you?” she repeated. Her eyes dropped to my crotch, and her mouth turned up in the slightest smile.

Your cock says you do, her face said.

Her knees drifted apart, just a little wider.

Who in the hell was this woman?

What was it? What was so different about her?

Was it just that I knew what she had done?

She slipped her hands inward, placing her fingertips on her inner thighs. She was moving her legs lightly to and fro. But her eyes were locked on mine. Her lips were parted, and I could see that the pace of her breath was elevated.

I was wondering what I had done, somewhere in my mind, but when she sucked her lower lip in to her mouth to bite down on it with her teeth, my cock won out. I was so hard already that precum was squeezing out of the tip of my dick.

“Tell me,” I said. My voice sounded strange. In fact, I felt like some kind of out of control pervert, like I couldn't have stopped watching her if the house was on fire and she was underage and it was incest...I was licking her with my eyes, fucking her already in my mind, prying apart her holes in the dirtiest ways possible.

And she was scaring the hell out of me, because she was just reeling me right in.

“Why don't I show you something?” she said.

My chest was getting tight. By now I couldn't feel anything but my cock, and she was paralyzing me with her lightly twisting hips, her penetrating stare, her little smile, and her ever-rising skirt, about to reveal what was or wasn't underneath.

She spread her legs with her hands now, pushing her knees apart. Maybe it was my imagination, because I am not a man with a superhuman sense of smell, and I was more than five feet from her, but I felt like I could smell the slightly bleachy, slightly sour scent of cum from across the room.

Her skirt slid up her hips, and her flesh just kept unfolding from the darkness. Porcelain flesh, porcelain flesh, well past the place where the satin of a pair of panties should have appeared.

It took me a moment, when the dress was bunched at last around her waist, for me to realize what I was looking at.

The porcelain of her thighs met together in two small rounds of pale flesh, and then, uncovered completely – completely bare – they opened like a gash, and spilling from that gash was her engorged clitoris and her inner lips. All of it glistening with either her excitement or the leftovers of Brad's cum.

Completely. And totally. Shaved.

I stared, unable to say or do anything.

“Do you like it?” she asked, but she didn't seem interested in the answer. “Brad did it.”

It took a few seconds for the words to make circles in my blood-deficient brain, and for the meaning of the words to make any sense, for the words to conjure of the image of Brad somehow shaving her pussy bare. I couldn't really even get the picture in my mind, and then she added this:

“With a straight razor.”

A shudder went through me, as I pictured a straight razor, with all of its menacing, lethal properties, in the hand of Brad, moving toward my wife's pussy.

“How?” The question was out of my mouth before I even thought it. My throat was dry. I brief glance at my pants showed me that a stain of precum was spreading out as though I had pissed myself, and my cock was so hard it seemed twice as large as it was.

She leaned back on the couch, her legs spread. Her eyes were devouring my every movement and expression: she was really getting off on this as much as I was.

She opened her legs and lifted her arms up, as though reclining in someone's arms.

“I just relaxed against him like this,” she said. “In the bathtub, but with only enough water to rinse the razor.” She moved her hands down to her thighs, and worked her fingers in slowly. She peeled her eyes from mine to look down at herself, as though she were actually shaving.

“First he had to brush it all over with shaving cream. Get it all lathered up.”

I sucked in my breath.

“And then,” she said, but she showed me instead of describing it: then he pulled her outer lips taught, and while she stayed very still, he took a super sharp blade in his right hand, and pressed it *just so* against her skin, while she fought not to shudder and make him nick her.

Now the ache in my cock was in my balls and working its way throughout my groin and into my torso. My stomach twisted as I imagined a knife against her skin, the light blonde hairs of her pussy filling the foam and then washing away, with nothing left but her pink flesh. All of it in Brad's hands.

“I'm still not sure if I like it,” she said, moving her fingers between her outer lips, pulling it open to reveal her throbbing clit, and her wet hole.

“And after that?”

She grinned and looked up at the ceiling, as though I had asked her an idiotic question.

“And after that, he told me to stand up, and he rinsed me off with the shower head.”

I imagined shaving cream sliding down her thighs, while Brad stared right at her freshly-shaved snatch, and she stood there like a goddess for him to admire.

“And then.”

“And then he pulled me apart and made me come in almost no time at all by licking my pussy.”

“Then.”

“Then he threw me on the bathroom floor, on my hands and knees, and fucked me so hard we ended up in the next room.”

“And he came inside of you.”

She pulled her lips apart and shrugged. Then she put her thumb in her mouth and bit on the nail.

“What else did you do?”

She dropped her hands to her sides and slipped off the couch, on to her knees. She crawled toward me.

I was already freeing my cock from my pants, but she took over with her own hands and pulled me out. My dick sprang up, hard as I think it had every been in my life, almost swollen.

She grasped it at the base and squeezed, moving her hand up to the tip, where precum gushed out.

“Brad taught me some interesting things about sucking cock,” she said.

I shuddered.

She lifted her eyes to mine. “He's really a cocky bastard, isn't he? But I think I liked it better because of that.”

Her hand was moving slowly up and down my cock, and it was all I could do to keep it together for whatever she was going to do next. My mouth was open and I was panting like a dog.

“Like if you just let yourself gag, then it's over. And you can open your throat up and just get fucked in the throat no problem.”

She was looking at me now. I couldn't tell if I should take what she was saying seriously or not – as worked up as I was, as serious as I wanted

to be, there was something verging on comedy that she was saying all of this because...well, it was Victoria. Victoria did not do things like let herself gag so that someone could fuck her in the mouth. But more importantly, Victoria never used phrases like *gag*, *fucked*, or *open your throat up*.

She opened her mouth and placed her lips on the tip of my cock. “You don't believe me do you?”

I was seconds away from coming.

Victoria – my wife, Victoria, I reminded myself, because for a second I had the sensation that I had somehow ended up with a hooker – began to lick my cock, making little circles around the shaft, lapping it from base to the tip. Teasing.

Then she stopped, and sat back a little on her knees, her hand moving up and down my shaft.

“The other thing,” she said, “is that I swallowed all of his cum. Do you know why I did that?”

I shook my head. My cock had a life of its own now, and almost seemed to be spasming in her hand. There was enough precum oozing from the tip to lubricate her stroking, and I could feel my orgasm building up.

She stopped stroking me and smiled. Then she got up on her knees, and looked directly at me, hovering over my cock. “Because his cock was so far down my throat, darling, that I didn't even taste it.”

I exhaled, and it echoed loudly in the room. She seemed pleased that I was losing control.

“You don't believe me,” she teased.

I made some kind of noise, but it was too late and didn't matter – my wife opened her mouth, paused for just a moment so that I could appreciate her smirking eyes, and her gaping mouth, before she slid her lips, her tongue, and at the end, the soft part of the back of her throat, all the way down my cock, all the way to the base.

I felt her tongue move against the shaft of my cock, but I was looking down at her, and her eyes were meeting mine. Brown and steady, over her stretched lips.

She had to do nothing else. I reached for her head, but I was already coming.

And she just looked at me, my cock deep in her throat, as I filled her with my cum. I yelled as I came, because the orgasm hit me so hard.

Victoria just held me in her mouth as I thrust involuntarily, and she grasped me to press herself more tightly to the base of my cock.

“God. *Fuck!*” I said.

She very slowly slid her mouth from my cock, sucking as she went. I threw my head back because it was so intense it almost hurt.

Then she stood up in front of me and pushed her skirt down, and in a gesture that seemed to have been lifted from a movie with a very professional hooker in it, she drew her fingers along the sides of her mouth. Then she placed her knee on mine playfully.

“So?” she said.

My cock, I noticed at that particular moment, was completely cleaned off.

I was speechless. I looked up at her.

“Did you like it?”

Razors and lips and Brad's cock and bathroom floors were swarming in my mind, and my ears were throbbing so hard I could barely make out the question.

She climbed onto my lap, placing her forearms on my shoulders. She was smiling. Faintly, I could smell my cum on her breath, her pristine mouth that was *so filthy* now.

“I didn't expect to,” she said. “But I had a lot of fun. Brad is still a prick,” she added, “but before we got down to business, he explained a lot of things to me that made me understand why you wanted to do this.”

Thanks, Brad.

Then my stomach twisted with fear.

Victoria's face revealed nothing, but now she seemed like such a different person that it was hard to tell if she was playing some sort of game with me or not. I looked at her. Was she teasing me? Was she plotting something? Had Brad told her about Anna? And now, was she just seeing if I would come clean? Daring me, in a way?

I could feel her bare skin on my thigh, and it was dripping wet.

She was smiling still. It seemed like a friendly smile, but I couldn't shake the idea that she was drawing me out.

“Then he explained to me,” she said, “How I could like it, too.”

“Oh yeah?” I said, but my mind was everywhere but on what she was saying. Was she now going to exact revenge on me, and that's why she was

being so naughty?

My cock, almost impossibly, twitched against her thigh.

She smiled again and tossed her hair over her shoulder. “See? That's just it for me too.”

It took me a while to realize she meant, getting turned on.

“Because the truth is – and he asked me this – the truth is that after a while you just *can't* maintain any interest in someone you're married to, and just like: everything is totally okay in your relationship. There's no danger, no one is doing anything wrong...and at first I was like, no, that's not true. You know how I am.”

She paused now, trailing one of her hands down my chest and toward my crotch.

“But then I thought about what I was doing. How I was sitting there at Brad's house, and I was going to have sex with him. And even though he's kind of a dick, I started to think about what he was saying...like, maybe I just needed an excuse to get naughty, maybe that's what I really wanted. Secretly, You know?”

In the back of my mind I was still worrying that I was getting taken on some kind of ride. For one thing, the woman sitting on top of me was nothing like my wife, nothing like her at all, and for another – well, it would not be a stretch for Brad to tell her about Anna, have sex with her, and hang me out to dry.

But her hand was on my cock now, and to my surprise, even though I had *just come*, it was hard already.

“I think I want to do it again,” Victoria said.

I wasn't sure what she was referring to: sucking my cock or letting Brad fuck her, but either one was certainly appealing enough to send a stab of heat through my hardening dick.

“Now?”

She grinned, and her eyes were filled with a strange expression.

Mischief. Sexual mischief.

Very unlike Victoria.

She leaned forward, and she moved her lips over my ear for a moment before whispering:

“Right now, I want you to fuck me. While I tell you how Brad fucked me. That's what you want to hear, isn't it? All about his cock, how big it

was, how it felt, all the dirty, nasty things he talked me into doing?”

I grasped her ass and pushed her against me, and I just breathed heavily because I didn't want her to stop talking.

“If that's what you want,” she said, leaning back again. “Then you have to fuck me. And I'll tell you all about it.”

I stood up, finding a strength I hadn't tested in years, to lift her up with me as I got out of the chair, and I practically tossed her onto the couch. I pushed my pants off and kicked them away while she watched me, her eyes looking hungry for the first time in a long, long time.

Then, to my amazement, she flipped over, so that she was on her knees, and she perched on the arm of the couch. She tossed her hair over her shoulder and looked back at me.

I wasted no time getting onto the couch, behind her, because if this was what she wanted I was more than happy to comply. When I dropped my eyes down to her round ass, I was surprised to find her fingers between her legs, sliding between the bare lips of her snatch in this elaborate, sexy stroke. I stared at her fingers for a moment, and the scene was so foreign it almost made me dizzy. Victoria never did this kind of thing.

I let her play with herself for a moment, and then I breathed, with my eyes on her glistening fingers, her drenched pink flesh: “Tell me what else he did.”

Her pointer finger slid further down, or up, as the case may have it, toward her ass. “You can't tell?” she said, her voice sultry and teasing.

I watched her wet finger as it moved to her asshole, not comprehending for a moment.

And then I looked more carefully.

No way.

She began to move her finger around the ring of her ass, rubbing it lightly, calling attention to the fact that it was a shade pinker, and slightly distended.

And then she said this, and each word squeezed by balls like a fist and practically pumped cum right out of my cock:

“My ass is full of Brad's cum.”

But she didn't stop there.

“Do you want to see it?”

What in the actual fuck, I remember thinking, has happened to my wife?

But I was paralyzed, holding my cock in my hand with my mouth open. She moved her whole hand toward her ass, and then she slipped her pointer finger in, and then her middle finger. For a moment I just knelt there, not breathing, unable to breathe, as my wife finger-fucked herself in the ass. My cock was so hard that the pain was reaching up into my throat at this point.

That's when she spread her fingers apart, and the dull pink ring of her asshole spread open like a mouth. Beneath this oval her pink inner flesh appeared for a moment, illuminated for me at least for the first time, and then, a creamy white liquid welled up and coated her fingers.

I sucked in my breath. I was utterly hypnotized. I couldn't think straight, or of anything at all – just the cum, gushing from my wife's most intimate hole. The cum of another man. It overflowed and was dripping down between her legs, mixing with all of the wet juices and the other load of cum that was presumably in her cunt. Her fingers worked in and out of her ass, sloshing with a sticky sound.

I looked at her face. She was enjoying watching me, enjoying the pain and the eroticism that must have been splashed over my face.

I couldn't take any more. I pushed her hand down and out of my way, grabbed her hips and impaled her with my cock.

Her pussy was so wet, so stretched out, that it felt completely different to be inside her. For some reason this only turned me on more – the lack of friction would allow me to fuck her just a little longer. My balls slapped against her sopping cunt, hitting only the smooth, shaved flesh. She was soft like someone much too young, but her pussy was so incredibly dirty and full. I rammed into her, thinking about what a dirty, filthy whore she had been, and in almost no time at all I could feel my climax surging out of me.

I yelled as I came, and I felt her already soggy cunt filling to overflowing, as I added my seed to Brad's.

She was covered in a sheen of sweat, and her hair was still wet from the rain. Her appearance conjured the image of a ridden horse, which sent a final shudder through me.

I collapsed on the couch, panting.

Victoria twisted around and threw her feet over my lap.

“Holy fuck,” I breathed.

She held her hand to her mouth, and bit on her knuckles. “It wasn't too much, was it?”

I leaned back on the couch. Was it?

“Fuck, Victoria. It was so hot.”

I stroked her leg. I felt exhausted. I hadn't come twice in the same night, with the exception of coked-up Vegas, for like ten years. I was pretty sure my blood was thinned by the experience.

“I'm glad you thought so,” she said. “But really, right? Because...”

I turned to her. “What do you mean, 'really'? I'm the one who asked you to do it.”

“I know, it's just...I really ended up liking it. A lot. I just don't want you to...I don't know. You know, it's easier to do something really nasty with someone you don't care about emotionally.”

The words almost seemed to have been packed into her mouth by Brad. Was she simply saying what he wanted her to say, to manipulate me?

“I didn't think I wanted to really do anything nasty,” she continued. “But it turns out I did.” She put her arm over her forehead, and I searched for something to say.

The silence went on for a long time, and when I turned to look at her, she was asleep.

I twisted onto the couch facing the opposite way, and we fell asleep together like that, like teenagers at a party.

CHAPTER 15

I had mixed feelings about Brad. I dreaded him coming into my office. Not so much because he had fucked my wife; that had been, after all, my own idea.

I was more worried about what he would do. How it would change the dynamic of our relationship, which was no really a friendship but was at least collegial. I was also worried that he was going to back out of paying me. And that I wouldn't have the guts to stand up to him if he did.

Now don't get me wrong. It wasn't about the money. But I wanted the money. If he didn't give me the money, then it would somehow put a different spin on things than I wanted.

He was talking to one of the hot assistants as he came through the door, and I was grateful that I had some time to quell the cold feeling rolling around in my stomach and change the expression on my face.

As usual, he produced an apple and tore through it with his alpha-male jaw.

“Lunch?” he said.

He walked over to the window and looked out, much like he always did.

He picked up the picture of Victoria. He swept his thumb over her breasts. A poker of searing pain, coupled with pleasure, went straight through me.

“Look at Cruger. What a fucking idiot,” he laughed. His eyes were back on the parking lot. “Guy's gonna fucking electrocute himself.”

I spun the chair and leaned up to peek out the window, without really thinking about what he'd said: Dick Cruger was, in fact, jumping his car and did look to be about to electrocute himself. But I was too busy with my own thoughts for the image to really make its way into my consciousness.

“I think I really have to go stop him,” Brad said, his tone getting serious. “Who the hell is watching and letting him do that like this?”

I was still looking at the scene blankly, not comprehending. I was thinking about Brad, his cock stretching my wife open.

“Did you end up fucking Irena?” Brad said, like he was asking about a report.

I pushed away from the window. “I...”

Brad looked down at me and grinned. “You should. I just wanted to make sure you didn't owe *me* money. Bet's a bet.”

His eyes went back out the window. “Fuck. I really think I have to go down there. Meet me by my car.” He departed, in calm but efficient stride. A hero, going out to do good and save the world.

I sat, blinking, in my chair.

I looked at the picture of Victoria.

I had to hand it to Brad: he had, with his charm and his calm demeanor, smoothed the whole thing over in a way that had diffused the awkwardness.

All except the money.

I was feeling sick about the money. The loans were hanging over my head, payments were coming due, and I knew I should just enjoy what my wife had done for me – but I couldn't get the money out of my head.

I rose out of my chair and headed downstairs.

Brad was affixing the ground cable properly and patting a mystified Cruger on the back when I walked into the parking lot. Cruger's wife, who was as ancient as he was, was sitting in the other car, blinking.

“There you go, pops,” Brad said. “Where to?” he yelled in my direction.

I shrugged.

Naturally, we ended up at Stagecoach.

Brad had a few beers and leered at the girls, who were particularly unenthusiastic on a Friday. A thin girl moved begrudgingly in front of us, but Brad watched with rapt attention. He ordered tacos. He talked about sports.

All the time, I felt my anxiety rising up through my pores.

I could see what he was doing: controlling the conversation with his business skills. Setting up all the parameters of his own dominance. Being aloof. Waiting for me to come to him, acting as though his fucking my wife were such a trivial matter he couldn't even be bothered to remember it.

I was stewing in my jealousy, my anger, my self-loathing (because I couldn't stop any of this) and also the incredibly strong eroticism that came with knowing how thoroughly Brad had debauched my wife with his enormous cock. Brad seemed, or pretended, not to notice. He shoveled entire tacos into his mouth and gnashed his teeth until they were gone.

Then he wiped his hands with his napkin, and clapped them together.

“Down to business,” he said.

I stared at him. I didn't know what else to do.

I knew he wanted me to say, 'Hey man, I really need the money.'

But there were some things I wasn't going to stoop to.

On the other hand...my stomach flipped as I thought of Victoria's asshole, and Brad's cum welling up inside of it.

“How was it?” he asked me.

I was surprised by the question – because it was so clear he was asking about Victoria – and I struggled to think of a way to answer.

Luckily he saved me. He shook his head. “I remember my first time, man. It's a thrill, but it's kind of better in retrospect.”

I was *really* surprised by this expression of – what was it? Camaraderie? Tenderness? - on Brad's part. I had actually never even thought of him as a guy who had a 'first time' at anything. He seemed like he had been born a complete, rugged man who had experience in everything on the day of his birth.

He let his eyes go to the stage, but I think it was more to spare me the eye contact than to watch the tired redhead who had taken the previous girl's place and was, incredibly, moving with even less enthusiasm and, it seemed, to music other than what was being played at Stagecoach.

“You're probably feeling wild, man,” he said.

I looked at him. I was suddenly grateful that it had been Brad who had been the architect of this whole thing, and Brad who had taken my wife. It was almost bonding, in a way. And, when he wasn't being an ass, Brad was a pretty stand-up guy.

“I want to give you your money, but I think you should come over for dinner. Don't want to be waving it around here.” He turned back to me and rested his arms on the table. “It's Irena's idea, man.” He said it in that tone that men reserve for when their wives have told them to do something, and there is no getting out of it.

“Bring Victoria?” I asked.

Brad smiled as the syllables of her name came out of my mouth.

“Of course bring Victoria,” he answered.

Then something flashed through his eyes, and another knife of pleasurable pain cut through me.

Dinner. Irena's idea. Brad, Irena, Victoria, and I, sitting around the table.

CHAPTER 16

Victoria narrowed her eyes as she thought about the idea. I held my breath as she turned it over in her mind.

I didn't want it to come to me having to tell her that I needed the money, desperately. Because even though there were so many other enticing reasons to go to the 'dinner,' and all that it promised, the money was nagging me incessantly.

I didn't want any of that to get misinterpreted. I didn't even like it cluttering up my own mind. I wanted to enjoy seeing Victoria with Brad, perhaps next to Irena...

But after a moment of thought, while she had me hanging on the hook, she smiled.

"So, by 'dinner,' what do you think they mean?" she said, Her voice was a little coy, like the voice she had used to tease me all this time. Except that now, I knew she was for real. I was not imagining things, or thinking too much.

"I think..."

"I think we should talk about this," Victoria said, her mood changing quite suddenly. Her smile turned downward, and I had a sinking feeling.

"Uh..." I said, stupidly.

"I just mean," Victoria said, "that now that the...I guess the motive for...the money, right? Is kind of gone...now I just want to make sure we're on the same page."

I felt a little like we were moving backwards.

"What page are you on, Victoria?" I said. I decided to let her speak for herself, instead of trying to tease it out of her.

After all, it was pretty clear she had enjoyed herself.

She looked at me.

"I mean..."

She blushed again.

A swell of satisfaction rose up inside of me. Even though Victoria was a naughty girl, she was also still the same old Victoria.

"I mean, I want to go to dinner," she said. "Like...everything that 'dinner' implies."

I smiled. "Me too."

She looked down at her fingers. "Irena will be there."

"I know."

She let out a sigh. "So...I guess, like...if we're having dinner with Irena, then..."

She looked up at me, and her face was serious. She broke into a nervous giggle, and covered her mouth. "Oh my god this is such a funny conversation," she cackled.

"If we're having dinner with Irena," I coaxed, not wanting the subject to get dropped.

She closed her mouth, and her eye twinkled.

"If we're having dinner with Irena...I guess...I'm just saying that we should be...as inclusive as possible."

"And you're okay with that?"

"Are *you* okay with that?"

I nodded.

Victoria nodded.

She laughed, slightly embarrassed, and scooted upstairs. "I have to call a sitter."

Abruptly, Brad stood up. "Well," he said, almost theatrically. "I'm off to bed."

It was a cool evening, and we were outside, looking over the ravine next to a chiminea. The table was scattered with wine glasses and leftover plates. Irena had ordered some kind of magnificent catering, and dinner had proceeded almost exactly as any ordinary dinner would. Except that about ten minutes after we arrived, Brad had pulled me aside to give me an envelope with \$15,000 dollars in it. "So we can enjoy the rest of the evening," he had said, and then slapped me hard on the back.

I looked at Victoria, and watched her face for signs of what she thought of Brad's comment about going to bed. I was pleased to see a little wave of disappointment pulse on her cheeks.

Irena was smoking, and her face was impassive as always.

We all shifted our gazes from one to another. There was a lot of exciting tension in the air, but no one seemed willing to break it by making the first move.

Victoria was wearing a red dress that was really too cool for the evening, and I could see a sprinkle of goosebumps on the back of her neck. The dress plunged between her breasts, and encased them in two strips of

gauzy material. The skirt flared at the bottom, a bit like a Marilyn Monroe dress, only red. And Victoria looked better in it. I had sat on the bed, watching her get dressed. I had watched her slip satin and lace panties over her hips, and turn in them to reveal the strip of red satin that fell between her two perfect buttocks. She had dressed as though she had no idea I was watching her, but she did: she rolled her thigh-high stockings up her leg, propped on a stool, so that I could see every inch of her body being slowly wrapped up. And think about how it was all going to be unwrapped later, by other hands.

The atmosphere was strange after Brad said he was going to bed, and I couldn't take it much more, so I shifted around.

“Uh, yeah...it's kind of late.”

Brad stood up, and for some reason I moved also. It was awkward. I was just winging it. Maybe I had been confused about what this dinner invitation meant. I looked at Victoria. She looked confused and now disappointment was dripping down her face.

Brad practically yelled at me and pushed me lightly on the shoulder to keep me in my seat. “No, man. Stay and have a nice time. Keep Irena company for me. She never goes to bed this early.”

He winked in her general direction, so I was not entirely sure who the wink was for.

“Uh...” I looked at Irena. “Should I get a bottle of wine?”

Irena lifted a bottle of wine from the ground beside her. “Got it covered,” she said. And again the smile.

Then she stretched out, making me think again of a cat, and placed her feet on my lap.

Brad, meanwhile, had taken Victoria by the hand, and was lifting her out of her chair. “I have something to show you,” he said. He gave me a wink. It was definitely for me.

I wasn't sure what to do. I had envisioned something else. Something in which I got to see firsthand what Brad did with Victoria. Maybe even be part of it. I wanted to touch her, feel her, smell her, while he took her.

My cock was getting hard just thinking about it. Brad leaned in to Victoria's ear, and whispered something to her. It made her smile. She looked right at me as she smiled, and then they moved toward the door, together.

My mouth was open but no sound came out of it. I had no idea what the plan was, but I wanted the plan to include me.

Irena tipped her head to the side and looked at me. "What's problem, Ryan?" Her foot moved between my thighs, and she seemed very pleased to find my hard cock there, pressing against my trousers.

"Uh..." I mumbled.

She smiled again, and put her mouth on a beer bottle she seemed to have produced from nowhere. She blew into it, staring me in the eye. "Brad wants you to have a nice time." Her eyes were twinkling. Another cryptic message from Irena. My eyes darted to the sliding-glass door, where Brad and Victoria had just disappeared.

I cleared my throat, and I straightened up in the chair. I didn't know what to do with Irena's feet, one of which was stroking my shaft with her perfectly manicured toes while she stared at me and smiled.

"I just..." I didn't know how to end the sentence.

Irena was clad in a tight-fitting white turtleneck, which might have seemed conservative if not for the fact that it was utterly sheer and she had nothing on beneath it. Her pants were also tight-fitting and white, and there seemed to be nothing on beneath those either.

Irena pulled her feet away, and leaned forward. Her face, and her big pouty lips, were very, very close to mine now. She placed a hand behind my neck. "What, Ryan?" She bit her lip. "Hmmm? Bet is over. Now is just for fun."

My eyes went to the door again, but they were having a harder time knowing where to look or go. Irena was folding and unfolding her long body, and moving closer to me. Her blue eyes had gone dark with lust or mischief or malice. Whatever it was, it was seductive as hell. She was pulling me in to her gaze.

But my mind could not help be pulled to the bedroom, where Victoria and Brad had surely gone.

Irena was unbuttoning my shirt, though, and I didn't want to miss out on the opportunity to find out what she would do next.

Irena was smiling, a little triumphantly, because I was not offering any resistance.

"You're sure....Brad is okay...with this?" I said. I wasn't even sure why I said it.

Irena laughed. It was a strange thing to hear from her, especially because it was almost a wholesome laugh. She sounded like she was laughing at a family movie.

She opened my fly and dipped her hand in to grasp my cock while I sat in confusion. She had pulled it out and was still looking at me, but I was no longer focused on her eyes. Instead I was staring at her open mouth. It was wet and red and surrounded by those two shapely lips of her, forever turned down in a pout. Her pink tongue darted out to trace a seductive line along her upper lip.

Her mouth moved closer to the tip of my cock.

I tried to think of something to keep from coming like a thirteen-year old boy, right then and there, but my mind was unhelpfully turning to the bedroom where Brad and Victoria were probably now naked and entangled.

That thought, along with the feeling of Irena's pink tongue flicking at the tip of my cock, only served to make my cock throb closer to the edge. Precum was practically gushing out the tip of it, and Irena started lapping it up like she was eating a sundae.

I let my head fall back and I stared up at the sky, because if I watched that for another second I was going to blow my load.

I put my hand on Irena's shoulder. I was panting now, and I needed her to stop. She smiled up at me. "Hmmm," she said. "You're ready to come, aren't you? Why don't you take a little break and lick my pussy for me?"

She sat up on the table. In some deft move, she had unbuttoned her pants and they slid off her thin frame as she stood. As I had guessed, no panties. Just her bare snatch, between her long legs. She pushed tray of oysters aside and opened her thighs for me. Between them her very tight, pink pussy yawned open. She was wet, and I caught a whiff of her scent. It was darker, more like molasses.

I was sucked in. Even though the action in the next room was begging for my attention, Irena's sexy, foreign body was right in front of me, beckoning. The pull was too strong to resist.

She was right at face level now, so I only had to bend forward ever so slightly to lick her. She spread her own lips open with her fingers, and pulled her clit up so that all I had to do was taste her with my tongue. She tasted like pineapple and salt. I moved my hands to the outside of her thighs and her ass. Her skin was soft and supple and I pulled her to my face,

inhaling her sweet scent and enjoying the way that she purred and twisted in my hands as I moved my tongue in circles over her hardening clit.

She put her fingers in my hair and pressed my face closer to her, moaning softly now. Her legs were dangling and quivering next to me, and I could tell she was going to come easily and quickly, so I began to tease her, licking her until her stomach tightened and she became tense in my hands, and then pulling away.

She laughed. She was enjoying that little game.

I did this to her a few times. She pulled her shirt over her head and released her small breasts and her lithe torso. She placed her hand on her own breast and pinched her nipples.

Now, I was thinking of how I was going to make her come, and scream. And then how my cock was going to get soaked in her cum while I pushed myself as deep inside of her as I could go.

Victoria.

The thought of Brad and Victoria, so nearby, made my cock twitch painfully again.

I decided to bring her to orgasm so I could change the scene somehow. I wanted to go and watch those two, almost as much as I wanted to be inside of Irena's tiny pussy.

I wanted her to smile and toss her head and scream with my cock thrusting into her pussy, while I watched Brad's huge member sinking, inch by inch, into Victoria's lips.

I pressed hard on Irena's tight little knob, moving with a rhythm now. She squirmed in time with my lapping, and her torso grew taut and stiff in my hands. I was enjoying the hell out of getting her so worked up. She placed both of her hands on my head, and she began to mewl and then howl, like a wild animal. "Oh, *fuck*," she yelled, not trying to be quiet at all. "Fuck yes..." and then she began speaking Russian. From the sound of it, it was filthy, dirty, Russian. My cock was screaming at me now.

She came, hollering and tipping her head back. She pushed my face away from her. She *gushed* all of her sweet moisture onto my face, and I pulled away to watch it dribble from her open cunt. I held her legs, which were thrashing lightly. Her orgasm lasted what seemed like a full minute, and then I started to worry that she might decide she was done with me, she had come so hard.

But she tilted her head forward, and pushed me back toward the chair. "Take your pants off, Ryan," she said, in a seductive growl.

I obeyed, almost tripping and falling on the cement in the hurry to get them off.

But I started shaking my head.

"I want...I want to see Victoria and Brad."

She stood up and pushed me down to a seated position. She kept her eyes on my cock, watching it and licking her lips. I knew it was a cliché, even at the time, like a ridiculous scene from a porno, but it was actually happening to me. This hot, sweaty girl with a dripping pussy was looking at my cock and licking her lips. And she was another man's wife.

"Don't worry about this," she said. "My husband can go for long-long time."

I had to fight to keep myself from coming the moment she climbed up on top of me. She was naked now, with a few goosebumps splayed across her shoulders and arms. She positioned herself so that her pussy was just above the tip of my cock, so that the head of my dick was enveloped in all of that golden, sweet, hot nectar. But she didn't slide down, not just yet. Instead she gripped my cock in her hand and guided it through the wet folds of her pussy, along her clit, masturbating herself with my cock.

I looked at her face. Her eyes were on my dick, and her own hand, so I watched it, too. The desire to feel my cock submerged in her very hot, very wet cunt was starting to overwhelm me. But I gripped the sides of the chair and let her play her game. I suppose I had done the same to her.

"Now, Ryan, tell me: you want to fuck your best friend's wife?" she breathed next to my ear, her pussy still just sucking on the very tip of my cock. Her come was dripping down the sides of my shaft, glistening in the dim light.

I opened my mouth, but all I could do was breathe. The words had sent a painful-sweet jolt through my cock. *Your best friend's wife...my wife with my best friend.*

I guess it was a strange time to think about it, but Brad really was my best friend, I guessed.

"Do you want to fill your best friend's wife up with hot cum?" Irena continued.

"Oh god," I said, involuntarily. I felt like I was going to burst, and I wanted to do it with my dick immersed inside of her.

“Say it, Ryan. If you are good boy I let you go watch Brad and wife.”

“I want to fuck my cum into you,” I managed to get out. I was staring at my cock, the tip of it slowly being dipped into her pussy as she lowered herself inch by inch while she spoke.

“I want to fuck my cum,” she corrected, “into *my best friend's wife's hot pussy*.”

I looked at her. She was smiling again, her same sexy smile.

“I want to fuck my cum into my best friend's wife's hot pussy,” I repeated obediently.

“That's it. Now I'm going to let you fuck me, but!” She pulled herself up a little bit, and I started shaking with disappointment and fear that she was going to abandon me like this, I almost couldn't take any more. My cock was actually *hurting* now with all the blood pulsing through it.

She leaned close to my ear again. “In future, I want you to spend time thinking about the way your cock feels in my pussy. Can you do that? Can you remember exactly how it feels?”

I just nodded, because I needed my mouth open to pant enough to breathe. My pulse was raging in my ears and now I was getting a vague headache.

She plunged onto me, with no warning, and my dick was suddenly enveloped in her hot, slick cunt.

It almost felt like the first time I had sex. The feeling overwhelmed me, and I bent forward, my hands moving clumsily around, trying to grab anything I could find. The only thing I could actually feel was my dick.

Luckily, Irena seemed used to her effect on men, and she steadied me. Then she began to ride my cock, one hand on my shoulder, her other hand moving behind her own ass.

I shuddered when Irena's palm rubbed lightly over my balls.

From the house I heard a low moan, bringing me back to the place and time where I was, and to the fact that my own wife was also being filled with another man's cock.

Irena moved on top of me while I did everything I could to breathe and try to hold back the orgasm that was bursting inside of me. But I wasn't able to hold out for long.

“That's it,” she coaxed me. “Fill up Irena with your cum.”

I yelled as I came, and I heard the chair scraping across the cement. Over that sound, I could hear Victoria's voice. Howling, but in waves. Waves that could only be timed with the thrusting of Brad's cock.

"Whew!" Irena exclaimed, standing up and stretching out like a cat again. She smiled, kicked my foot playfully, and then turned and walked toward the house. She gave her head a jerk, like I should follow her.

My cock was still hard, and it only got harder, coming back to life almost immediately, as I followed Irena into the house and the semi-darkness. Her body moved in the shadows, all legs and arms, and as we got closer to the bedroom it seemed to get darker, and hotter. I could smell sweat, or was it my imagination? I could smell Irena on my fingers, taste her in my mouth. Everything about her seemed darker than Victoria. It was delicious, but it wasn't what I wanted.

It felt as though I was walking down the hallway forever, with Irena's nimble body skipping ahead of me playfully, like nymph. As I neared the bedroom, sounds began to solidify in the air: a grunt, Victoria's moan, panting, the slapping of skin against skin.

There was a light on by the bed, and so the dimness bleached away into a scene as clear as day.

I surveyed the scene.

Was this actually happening?

This was really *my wife*, and she was fucking another man to please me.

Victoria's beautiful body, stripped of everything but her thigh-high stockings and her red shoes, was sprawled on the bed, her face upturned. Her mouth was open, and she was panting so heavily that her breasts were bouncing on her chest.

Irena had stopped, her arms folded, her face amused.

Brad had his head between Victoria's legs.

I sucked in my breath. Even though it was all right in front of me, I had the strange thought that I couldn't wait to make her tell me all about what I couldn't see: was he rubbing his lips over her thighs, tickling her with that five-o'clock shadow? How was he different than me when he ate her pussy? Was he licking her, trailing his tongue over her lily-white skin?

My cock was actually throbbing now. I had never had an orgasm while I was awake without at least touching *something*. But I felt like I

might just ejaculate all over myself. I had followed Irena without my pants, because I had known where things were going.

I heard Victoria moan. Her eyes opened, and she was looking at me.

Her mouth turned up in a smile. She held my gaze. Looking right into my eyes as Brad pleased her.

Brad placed his big hands on her thighs, and pushed them open further. Now he was right in the sweet spot. I was sure I could smell Victoria's pussy now. Her lighter, more flowered scent.

Her body twisted beneath Brad. I wondered what he was doing: licking her clit, or diving all the way in? I couldn't see from where I was: I only had a view of his dark hair between the white thighs of my wife.

Then Irena's dark body blocked my view. She moved to where Victoria's head was lying over the bed.

Victoria watched her, and I moved to the side to get a better view. I saw Brad's eyes raise in interest, and as soon as he realized what Irena was doing he sat on his knees. His hand moved to Victoria's spread legs, and she mewled in disappointment.

Irena caressed her head. "How naughty do you want to be for husband?" she purred to Victoria.

But she did not explain the naughtiness she had in mind: instead, she showed her.

Working together again with the same surgical-team rhythm as they had demonstrated when they had corrupted Victoria with cocaine, Brad and Irena moved Victoria into position for what Irena had in mind. Brad dragged Victoria by the feet so that her head was more on the bed, and Irena straddled her.

"My pussy is all full of Ryan's cum," Irena said, spreading her legs above Victoria's mouth. "And I think you should be the one to clean it all up."

No way was Victoria going to go for...

My thoughts were silenced, and I was shocked, when Victoria reached up with two hands and grasped Irena's tiny ass. She pulled her closer to her mouth.

Then she tilted her head, backward and up, and opened her eyes to look right at me.

I almost doubled over with the pain of my erection.

Was this Victoria? It was almost impossible to believe.

Her face moved as she worked her jaw on Irena's mound. I wished I could see what she was doing: if she was licking up my cum from inside of her, or if it was just dribbling all over chin as she worked on Irena's clit.

I moved to the foot of the bed, and to the side, so I could get a better view. And see what Brad was doing.

Brad had returned to licking Victoria's sweet cunt, and the sticky sounds of Victoria and Brad's tongues inside of their respective partner's cunts was the only sound in the room other than Victoria's muffled mewls.

Brad began bobbing up and down as he put the final touches on his pussy-licking, and Victoria's legs wobbled and swung wildly as she tossed her hair around on the pillow and screamed and moaned. But all of it was done with her mouth pressed firmly to Irena's mound.

Irena was looking down at her, smiling.

I wanted so badly to feel my cock inside of Victoria's stretched pussy, full of another man's cum.

Her muffled screams crescendoed, but her jaw kept moving, sucking and lapping at Irena's wet cunt.

She was really throwing herself into the role.

Okay, I admit a stab of something like jealousy went through me here. But I liked it. I liked the danger of it. Was she acting, for me? Or was she acting for him? Or for Irena? Was she acting at all? Maybe Brad was just so good, he was actually driving her that crazy.

I heard Irena make a low, guttural moan, and whisper more Russian. She pushed herself into Victoria's face and rubbed her snatch side to side on her, almost like marking her territory. Then she rose up, and looked down at her with a smile, panting.

I had my hand on my cock now, but I didn't dare touch myself for fear I would explode and miss out on the fun.

"Oh fuck," Victoria said. "That's so good, that's so good...oh god, you're so good, that feels so good, I'm going to come, oh my god!"

And she did. I could tell it was real. He finished her off like a pro, and kept going until she pushed his face away.

Brad stood up to his full, enormous height. He was still wearing his pants. He stood looking down at Victoria as he slid his belt off, and tugged down the zipper. His mouth was moving, but his voice was deep and low, and I couldn't hear what he was saying. My ears were ringing with all the sexual energy I had pushed down inside of myself.

Victoria, perhaps following instructions, flipped over, turned her ass to him. She kicked her feet up from the edge of the bed playfully, and the sight of her red shoes dangling around in the air squeezed my cock again. She tossed her hair over her shoulder and looked back at him. She was smiling and opening her mouth and licking her lips.

She looked like such a slutty, whoreish imp.

The suit-pants dropped to the floor. Brad slid his boxers from his ass, disentangling his enormous cock.

Now that it was so close to my wife's cunt, it looked even larger than I remembered.

I stared.

Irena, smiling, moving casually with a swing of her hips, came to stand next to me and pushed me lightly toward the chair where Anna had given me the sterile hand-job.

Brad was just inches from Victoria's waiting pussy, which she was twisting around seductively in front of him.

Her eyes were focused on his cock. I couldn't see, but I imagined. They widened and she licked her lips appreciatively. She sat up a little, leaning back with her hand reaching backwards to grasp his hard flesh in her hand. She found it and she smiled devilishly. "Oh," she exclaimed. "Oh, it's so big!" She turned back so that she was facing me, and she met my eyes and smiled.

It was a line from one of my porn videos. I mean, of course it wasn't very original, this line, and it could have been in any porn video or just a thing that women actually say. But the *way* she said it, and held his cock, and looked at me, I knew she was imitating one of my favorite videos. She was doing it for me, to satisfy my fantasy.

She didn't even care that Irena was slowly lowering herself onto my lap.

Brad said something else, and again it was so low I couldn't make it out. I didn't care. I just watched Victoria's hands, moving up and down his shaft. She turned herself around again.

"Oh, you want some of that?" he said.

I heard *that*.

I wanted to wink at Victoria, to tell her how great she was doing, what a show she was giving me. She was playing it like such a pro.

And I wanted to see her suck Brad's cock. She was sitting on the edge of the bed and holding the enormous meat in her hands.

I sucked in my breath as she extended her tongue and licked at the tip of it.

He placed his hand on the back of her head, and very gently, but firmly, pushed her down onto his cock.

Victoria opened up, and kept going.

In the meantime, Irena had lowered herself, backwards, onto my lap, and her sopping wet hole was slipping onto my cock. I shuddered.

"What a dirty mouth," she whispered. "Your wife's mouth is going to be so dirty."

My eyes were wide with disbelief, though, as Brad's cock just kept disappearing into Victoria's mouth. All the way, into her cheeks, and into her throat. His cock was so big that when it filled her throat I could actually see it travel down her neck.

"That's it. You can do it," he coached, in his baritone voice.

Victoria pulled her head back, and gasped for breath. It was too big.

I couldn't fault her, but I couldn't help but feel disappointed.

She hesitated only a moment, though, before she tried again.

All the way to the base. She swallowed the whole thing, opening her mouth up as wide as she could. Her lips were spread way open, and he must have been suffocating her, but she did it because she knew it was what I wanted to see.

And then he took her head in his giant hand, and began to move her back and forth over his cock. He watched as my wife sucked her hardest and her best at his thick slab. She got it so wet, so sticky with her throat, that I could hear it across the room.

Irena squirmed on my cock. She, too, was enjoying the show, but she also seemed to have limitless energy for limitless orgasms. Her pussy was so wet that there was not enough friction to make me spew inside of her right away, but if she kept twisting her hot flesh all over me, I was going to lose it. And I didn't want to. Not yet. Not just yet.

Victoria pulled away when she felt Brad was getting close to coming, and she looked up at him. "I want you to fuck me," she said.

She turned and returned to the position she had been in earlier. I could see her now like I was watching a video, like my wife was a porn star: her pussy was glistening with sticky juices, and she was so ripe, so ready.

God, I wanted to put my cock in there and bang her senseless.

Right after Brad filled her up.

The tip of his cock was nearing her fleshy ass now, and he pulled on her hair to press her head and her back up against him – my god, he really was gigantic man. Victoria's head barely came up to his pecs. She leaned her hips forward so that she could reach under herself and find his cock with her hand again.

"That's it," I saw his mouth say, and barely heard the deep rumble of his voice. "That's it little girl. Stroke that cock just like that."

"It's *so* big," Victoria gasped, smiling at me. "It's *too* big. I can't take it all!" Word for word, the script of my favorite video.

Irena was kindly tilted so that I could have a good view.

What a show. Victoria was gasping and breathing heavy, moving her hips up and down, and that *voice*. It was as if she had a cock in her mouth and a cock in her ass and was begging for someone to fuck her more, as if she was already having an orgasm. She was squeaking and sighing and breathy and pornographic.

Brad jerked on her hair and grabbed one of her asscheeks with his enormous hand, pulling her ass towards his cock. Victoria continued to complain that it was too big, but her hand guided him to where he could slip himself right in.

"*Oh God!*" she screamed, as he began to enter her. But he was taking his time, and only a few inches of his enormous slab were between her legs already. "Oh!" she squealed. "Oh, it hurts! It's too big for me!" She smiled for me.

He released her hair and she fell forward, but she made no move to get away. Instead she pushed herself backwards, sliding onto that enormous cock and moaning as she did.

She turned her head and looked back at it, and I could see that she loved looking at it.

And then Brad echoed my thoughts, and pushed her hair out of the way. "You like that, don't you?"

Irena ground her self onto my cock. "Your wife is such a slut," she growled.

I held my breath and tried to think about basketball.

Victoria moaned, *oh yes*, and started to push herself back and forth, back and forth. She cried and mewled as she did this, biting her lip and saying over and over how big and thick his cock was, and how she just couldn't take any more.

My stomach filled with what felt like a cold liquid.

I couldn't take my eyes off Brad's meat in her pussy, sloshing in and out of her.

She knew what I wanted to hear. She knew the next line and she had saved it. She looked right at me.

“Oh! Oh! It's too big! I won't be able to walk tomorrow! Oh, fuck!”

Her eyes didn't look away from me. Brad was pounding her so hard now that her hair was flying forward and whipping back against her face, sticking to her sweat. Her mouth was open, and she was moaning. But she was looking at me.

Just then, she licked her lips, staring at where she knew I was watching, and mouthed the words.

I love you.

Very clearly. That was very clearly what she mouthed, because she took special care to mouth it clearly.

Brad was suddenly impatient, unable to wait for Victoria's movements over his cock. He grabbed her hips and began to pump at her furiously. I ripped my eyes away from her stare to watch his big snake where it entered her – sinking between her lips, then out, then in again.

“Fill me up with your hot cum,” Victoria murmured, but ever so loudly, just then – as if she were reading my thoughts. “Fill my pussy up with all that hot, hot cum!”

He lifted a hand and slapped Victoria on the ass, and the smack cracked through the room.

Irena rose and fell on my cock, watching the scene with interest, and moaning lightly. Her pussy was squeezing me tightly, and she was nearing her own orgasm.

I was worried about Victoria: spanking wasn't really her thing.

I looked back to her face. She was still smiling that complicit smile, looking right at me.

“Oh, spank me again!” she screamed.

Another slap, and she rolled her eyes in pleasure. She began screaming in breathy pants, in time with the movements of Brad's cock.

“Oh!” she kept squealing.

I felt like this went on for an eternity, the sound seeming to amplify with every passing moment, until they seemed to be screaming together through a loudspeaker.

She stopped looking at me and closed her eyes, she was off in her own world now. I couldn't tell anymore if she was acting, if she really liked being spanked. It was not like her, it was like nothing she had ever done.

Irena's pussy clenched around my cock, and she came, giving a muffled scream. Then she threw herself onto the bed, leaving me aching for release. She seemed to have gone off into her own world and no longer cared what happened to me.

I stood up and moved toward the bed. I pushed Irena's legs gently out of the way. She regarded me with amusement. I knelt in front of Victoria, whose body was rocking with Brad's hard thrusts. He barely acknowledged me, but I felt sure he smiled.

Then I took Victoria's hair in my hand, and lifted her face. She smiled at me.

I guided my cock to her mouth, and she opened wide to take me all in. My cock was coated in Irena's pussy juices, and I knew she could taste them. Again. Her soft mouth was hot and full of wet mucous at the back of her throat. She took me all the way to the base, looking up at me with her almond eyes.

The pumping was provided by Brad's hammering at her pussy. Her mouth moved forward and back as he slammed into her.

And then I heard him starting to yell. It came from deep inside of him and he started to slam even harder into her.

Victoria moaned, her voice vibrating on my cock.

And then I felt it.

A tongue, on my balls.

The sensation was so exquisite I wasn't even shocked to feel it. I gave a glance to the right, where I could see Irena had shifted to place her face underneath my cock in Victoria's mouth.

My climax burst inside of me, almost painfully. I was gone before I could pull Victoria away from me, but she let my cum fill her throat and never broke her gaze except for one second, when Brad gave his final thrust, obviously so deep inside of her it made her wince.

We all stayed where we were for a moment. Beneath me I could feel Irena panting, her breath on my balls. Only Victoria was breathing heavily through her nose, because she was still stuffed with my cock in her mouth and Brad's in her pussy.

I placed my hand on Irena's head, to indicate she should move, and she was already changing position. I leaned back on my heels, and watched my still-hard cock emerging stickily from Victoria's mouth.

Brad eased himself out of her, a similar sticky sound coming from her pussy. Victoria collapsed on the bed, turning face up. She moved her head to my thigh, and looked up at me, smiling.

There was a silence for a moment, while we all sat there, a little breathless.

A click. The smell of Russian cigarettes. Irena, as always, had managed to get comfortable, as if nothing had happened. She took a drag of her cigarette, and held it out to Victoria.

I intercepted it.

"No way," I told her.

It was too tempting, and took a drag of it before holding it back to Irena.

The smoke was brutally harsh, and I coughed loudly.

This, of all things, made Irena laugh.

Brad pulled his pants up. "I've worked up an appetite," he said. "Let's go get some eats."

The two of them hopped away playfully, slapping each other's asses and giggling.

Victoria looked up at me.

"Okay?"

"More than okay."

She stroked my arm.

"Me too."

The night was like a regular dinner party again. Where you have too much wine. Brad was waiting with a blanket for Victoria when we got outside. I can't remember what we talked about, but it was just something ordinary. Just a nice evening, a little cold for the season but too beautiful to go inside, with good friends. I didn't ruin it by thinking too much about where things would go from there. I just tried to enjoy the moment.

END

Thank you so much for reading and supporting independent authors.

I hope you enjoyed my story as much as I enjoyed writing it.

Please don't forget to leave a review...it's the best compliment I can receive, and it helps boost sales and get my stories out to the readers who want them, so I can keep writing more long works like these for you to enjoy!

Don't forget to [Sign Up For Our Newsletter and Get A Free Story](#)

[NEW! The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel \(Release Date August 24\)](#)

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their rental unit, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

You'll love [The Hotwife Summer](#)

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on

what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

I know you'll also love [The Hotwife Tattoo](#)

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

[A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos](#)

Lagos is the one place in Africa where you can make anything happen.

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “reliability” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

Other Arnica Butler titles you will enjoy – note these are shorter works from when I started as an author, but they're HOT!

(Click on the book link, or click the heading link for the newest titles in that genre):

If you're a new fan of Arnica Butler, why don't you try [Wives Gone Wild](#)?

I've put together ten of my short stories about wives on vacation, who get taken every way you can think of while their husbands watch. **Ten stories**

for \$4.99! For fans of my longer hotwife novels, these stories may not be for you (but then again...they might). These are quick or medium-length, dirty stories about men taking willing wives right out from under their husbands' noses. Most include very graphic scenes of humiliation, menage, cleanup and...well, that's all I can write about here!

Stories included in this bundle are: ***Double-Cucked; Cuckolded in Texas by The Oil Tycoon; Watching My Wife Get Trucked; St. Paddy's Day Cucktale; A Long Hard Winter; Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked; My Wife Goes Back To Black; Cuckolded On A Plane!; Cuckolded In Vegas!; and Cuckolded on My Dominican Vacation.***

All stories are available for purchase individually for \$2.99 and some are in Kindle Unlimited for free, with the exception of Cuckolded In Texas, which is only available here. I want to give readers a chance to read some of my earlier works and quickies at a discounted price.

Because sometimes, you just want to get down and dirty, right?
Enjoy!

INTERRACIAL CUCKOLDS

Black and White

(My personal favorite quickie to write!)

Danielle is a little prude, but married sex is stale and boring even for her. When she meets her husband's big, black boss, she can't control herself. Not only will she cheat on her husband, she lets Drake push her to the limits of her sexuality – and beyond. With very extended anal foreplay and BDSM, it's almost too hot to turn down!

Oh, I forgot: there's a camera in there somewhere. You won't believe what they do with the pictures.

One Night In Puerto Rico

What would you risk for it? And what could you gain, from one night to change your marriage?

When they meet and watch swingers Meg and John in action on vacation in Belize, the seeds are planted for something new in Jenny and Josh's dull

marriage, and things steam up back at home in unexpected ways. But she would never really do it, would she?

Now they're on vacation one year later, and it looks like Jenny is going to take things all the way with a big, black stud she found on the beach...but where will this lead them?

This is a 13,000-word explicit erotic story with an element of romance, and only for adults who like to imagine what could happen in just one steamy night.

First-Time Hotwife

Annie and Dave. An ordinary marriage that has gotten dull. But now Annie's made a discovery that will change their marriage completely. This story alternates between the voices of Annie and Dave as they take their marriage to the next level, and seek out a big, black stud to take Annie hard and unprotected, while her husband watches. Their marriage will never be the same...but will it be better? This story is 12,000 words and for adults only.

Cuckold Time Machine

Like any man, he's always wanted to know about his wife's ex-boyfriends, so when Mike gets his hands on a time machine, the only thing he can think of to do with it is go back in time to watch his wife with her boyfriends of the past! He starts with her big, black, athletic ex, and gets to see her take it hard and unprotected – but he's shocked by what kind of woman his wife was before he knew her! She never told him about – well, it's too dirty to write about it here, so look inside for a taste.

This story is approximately 9,000 words.

Cuckold Time Machine 2

Mike is addicted to the humiliation of watching his wife with her ex-boyfriends, and he's in for a treat when he heads back in time to watch her at Spring Break. Not only is he going to see his wife taking it hard and unprotected from two big black studs, but he's going to see a whole new side of his wife when he's discovered and she decides to humiliate him by

making him clean up afterward...look inside for a taste of what Mike gets to see when he travels back in time to see just how inadequate he really is!

BISEXUAL CUCKOLDS

What Ella Wanted

Nick has more than one secret desire, but he doesn't really know it until his best friend's gorgeous wife coaxes them both into showing each other their favorite porn videos. It looks like Ella wants to do more than just watch someone else getting pounded for another woman's pleasure. Is Nick brave enough to stick around and give Ella what she wants?

Approximately 15,000 words.

The Calendar

Adam's sexy MILF wife Nadia takes on a new project at her photography studio: a calendar full of hot firemen. Adam doesn't mind: he enjoys fantasizing about his wife taking it hard from her big, sexy models (especially the hot black bull). But Nadia has a whole different kind of cuckold adventure in mind. Will Adam be man enough to give her what she wants?

Approximately 11,500 words. Contains explicit scenes; for adult audiences only.

CUCKOLD HUMILIATION QUICKIES

*Need a **quickie**? These fun cuckold stories will get you hot fast:*

Legally Hotwife

Joanna's husband has always been inadequate and pathetic, but now he's dragged them both into a mess with the mob. It looks like Joanna will have to work off his debt with his new boss using her legal skills – and all of her assets! This story is approximately 11,500 words of alpha male domination and extreme cuckold humiliation, told from the female perspective and only for adults!

The Wife Swap Trick

[*Watching My Wife Get Jackhammered*](#)

[*Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked*](#)

[*Watching My Wife Get Trucked*](#)

[*Boss Hog Cuckold*](#)

[*St. Paddy's Day Cucktale*](#)

Watching My Wife Get Jackhammered, Lumberjacked, and Trucked are available as one bundle for non-KU customers – only \$3.99 for all three stories:

[*Three Cuckold Husbands: Watching My Wife Get...*](#)

[*Coffee In Her Cream*](#)

Mike and Christy have a mild little swinging "game" going, but Christy is taking it a little further than Mike expected with a big, black bull named Tony. Just when Mike thinks he's already had the biggest surprise when Christy starts crossing the line, Tony's wife Michelle shows up and heats things up in a way he couldn't imagine. Find out what happens in the approximately 7,000-word, explicit, interracial wife-swapping story.

[*Make Yourself At Home: My Best Friend's Wife*](#)

Sam is recovering from a messy divorce and gets kicked out of the house. What can his lifetime buddy Rick do but let him stay at his place? Except Rick just got married to quite a little number: the sexy, fun, flirtatious Michelle. One night, Rick mentions that Michelle and he have a special arrangement in their marriage. Sam isn't sure what to make of things...until Michelle helps him understand.

[CUCKOLD HUMILIATION ADVENTURES](#)

Feel like an adventuresome cuckold? Long cuckold stories with original twists and a lot of humiliation for the husband:

[*Inside My Wife \(The Series\)*](#)

Lawrence wanted to know what it felt like to be his wife while he pleased her, so he tried out his new invention. But something went terribly wrong, and now he's trapped inside her body. It turns out she is quite the naughty wife... From his best friend to the big, black pool boys, he's not only forced to watch, he'll have to go along for the ride, taking it the way his wife takes it: hard and unprotected, and every nasty way she wants it. Will Lawrence find a way out, or will he be cuckolded forever, inside his wife? This 18,000-word complete series involves scenes of strange and unusual cuckold humiliation. ***The complete series is available in three parts on KU, and as a bundle for \$3.99 for non-KU customers.***

[Double Cucked! Cuckolded On A Container Ship](#)

Carrie wanted a different kind of cruise...and she gets what she wants...all filled up! Her husband Dave is going to get cuckolded hard, by more than one member of this dirty, woman-starved crew. They're going to take his wife, hard and unprotected, and there's nothing he can do but watch! He thinks he's seen the worst after he watches her in some very dirty acts with some crew members, but it turns out he's been double-cucked! and she was doing it for the pleasure of the ship's captain! There's even more humiliation in store for him after that in this 14,000-word explicit cuckolding story. For adults only.

[A Long, Hard Winter: Cuckolded At The Antarctic Research Station](#)

Sam's wife Heidi is the only woman at the South Pole this winter, so it isn't long before he starts worrying about the rough, muscled, studs who are there to keep things running. It seems his wife has always wanted a different kind of man, and now that there's nowhere else to go, she'll get her fill right here! It's bad enough when Sam watches three big, filthy roughnecks take his wife hard, doing all the dirty things she never does with him – but what will he do when Heidi has even more humiliation planned for him?

It's going to be a long, hard winter in the Antarctic!

This story is approximately 15,500 words, for adults only, and contains explicit scenes of humiliation, light femdom, reluctant cuckolding, and menage.

Hey! Did you know...Thirteenth Line author [Ariel Lenov](#) also writes cuckold stories you're sure to love! Check out:

[A Dark Wish](#)

Kurt loves hearing about his wife Melody's past exploits. He's always had a fantasy to see her with another man and when he shares his secret, he's surprised to find out it excites her too.

Agreeing to take it slow, they both want to see what happens when Melody starts flirting with Hank, the Jamaican foreman at Kurt's job.

But things speed up when they all end up at the office party and Kurt finds himself unable to put the brakes on his wife's dark wish.

This is an 11,000+ word standalone short story.

[The Humiliation and Cuckolding of Tobias Quince](#)

Tobias Quince and his wife Jenny lead a happy, if sometimes dull life. A spontaneous act in the bedroom sparks Jenny's interest in spicing things up. Tobias is thrilled until she brings home a small metal cage and asks him to wear it. Tobias struggles with keeping his wife happy in her increasing demands that he submit to her will. By the time she brings home her new lover, Tobias' need for release outweighs any shame he feels at being a sissy

Tobias' descent from contented husband to consummate cuckold is complete with the final, ultimate act of humiliation.

Maybe You want To Try Something Else? I love writing gender swap stories. A good introduction, if you're a fan of cuckold stories (like I think you are) is [Inside My Wife](#), a combination of gender-swap and cuckold that is sure to delight you! After that...have fun!

[GENDER SWAP STORIES](#)

[Between The Sheikh And A Hard Place 1: Turned](#)

[Between The Sheikh And A Hard Place 2: Tricked](#)

[Between The Sheikh And A Hard Place 3: Trapped](#)

[Between The Sheikh And A Hard Place: Complete \(\\$3.99\)](#)

[The Dirty Pool Series](#)

[Every Blue Moon](#)

[Turned Into A Cherry And Popped!](#)

[Turned Into A Cherry And Disciplined!](#)

Check my [Author Page](#) for additional titles! And please don't forget to leave a review: it's the greatest compliment an indie author can receive!

Thank you!